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Study Material

Peacebuilding: Global Initiatives



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From the founders...



Prof. Dr. Vishwanath D. Karad

"I believe that peace would be established in the society through value based 'UNIVERSAL EDUCATION SYSTEM' which, inspires to give back to the society."



Mr. Rahul V. Karad

"With the synergy of academia with technology, technology with research, research with industry, industry with economy, economy with social innovation and social innovation with Peace, we are committed to make MIT-WPU a world class space of intellectual excellence, where reason and rationality reigns, humanism rules, and learning becomes a great adventure. With this vision, the peace component in the curriculum and yoga practices have been quite thoughtfully added to the credit system."

INDEX

Sr. No	Content
1	Origins of International Organization: League of Nations to UN
2	UN: Foundations, Charter, and Organs
3	UN Peacekeeping: Case Studies
4	Agenda for Peace
5	Peacebuilding to Sustaining Peace
6	Human Rights
7	Human Security
8	Humanitarian Intervention
9	Right to Peace
10	Women Peace and Security
11	Youth Peace and Security
12	UN Entities in Peacebuilding
13	UNESCO
14	UNESCO Chair at MIT World Peace University
15	UNDP
16	UNHCR
17	UN Women
18	Regional Organization & Peacebuilding
19	Organization of African Union (OAU) and Organization of American States (OAS)
20	European Union
21	SAARC
22	ASEAN
23	G-20
24	Role of IGO's
25	INGOs

Origins of International Organization: League of Nations to UN

World War I:

World War I, also known as the Great War, was a transformative global conflict that occurred from 1914 to 1918, involving many of the world's major powers. Its origins lay in a complex interplay of political, economic, and social factors, including militarism, imperialism, nationalism, and intricate alliance systems. The assassination of Archduke Franz Ferdinand of Austria-Hungary in June 1914 served as a catalyst, leading to a cascade of events that quickly escalated into full-scale war. The conflict was characterized by unprecedented levels of destruction and loss of life, fuelled by the implementation of modern military technologies and tactics such as trench warfare, chemical weapons, and aerial bombardment. The war's aftermath saw the collapse of several empires, the redrawing of national boundaries, and the emergence of new political ideologies. The Treaty of Versailles, signed in 1919, attempted to address the post-war settlement but sowed the seeds of resentment and instability, ultimately contributing to the outbreak of World War II. World War I thus stands as a pivotal moment in modern history, reshaping the geopolitical landscape and laying the groundwork for the tumultuous events of the 20th century.

Formation of League of Nations

The League of Nations, established in 1920 following the end of World War I, was the first international organization aimed at maintaining peace and promoting cooperation among nations. It emerged from the collective desire to prevent future conflicts through diplomacy and collective security. With its headquarters in Geneva, Switzerland, the League comprised various member states, initially including major powers such as Britain, France, Italy, and Japan. One of its primary functions was to arbitrate disputes between nations and encourage disarmament. Despite its noble intentions, the League faced significant challenges, notably the absence of the United States, whose Senate refused to ratify its participation. Additionally, the League's effectiveness was hampered by its inability to enforce decisions, as evidenced by its failure to prevent the outbreak of World War II. However, the League laid the groundwork for subsequent international organizations, notably the United Nations, emphasizing the importance of multilateral cooperation in maintaining global peace and security. The League of Nations experienced both success and failure during its existence. One of its notable successes was in humanitarian efforts and social progress. The League facilitated initiatives to combat pandemic as well as efforts to improve living conditions and

labour standards worldwide. It also played a crucial role in the resolution of several territorial disputes, including the Åland Islands dispute between Finland and Sweden in 1921.

However, the League faced significant challenges and failures, particularly in maintaining peace and preventing conflicts. Its inability to prevent acts of aggression by powerful member states, such as Italy's invasion of Ethiopia in 1935 and Japan's occupation of Manchuria in 1931, undermined its credibility and effectiveness. The League's reliance on consensus and its lack of enforcement mechanisms weakened its ability to respond decisively to international crises. Furthermore, the absence of key global powers, notably the United States, limited its influence and resources. Ultimately, the League's failure to prevent the outbreak of World War II in 1939 led to its dissolution in 1946. Despite its shortcomings, the League laid the groundwork for the establishment of the United Nations, which sought to learn from its mistakes and create a more robust framework for international cooperation and peacekeeping.

2

UN: Foundations, Charter, and Organs

Outbreak of World War II

The outbreak of World War II in 1939 was a culmination of political tensions, economic instability, and territorial ambitions that had been brewing since the end of World War I. The Treaty of Versailles, signed in 1919, imposed harsh reparations and territorial losses on Germany, leading to economic hardship and fostering a sense of resentment and nationalism within the country.

Meanwhile, the rise of aggressive totalitarian regimes in Germany, Italy, and Japan, characterized by expansionist agendas and militarization, further destabilized the international order. The invasion of Poland by Nazi Germany on September 1, 1939, marked the formal beginning of World War II, triggering a swift and coordinated response from allied nations. The war's escalation was fuelled by ideological conflicts, such as fascism versus democracy, as well as strategic alliances and geopolitical ambitions. The outbreak of World War II underscored the failure of diplomatic efforts to prevent conflict and highlighted the consequences of unresolved grievances and unchecked aggression on a global scale.

The aftermath of World War II reshaped the landscape of global politics, giving rise to a new
Peacebuilding: Global Initiatives

era characterized by the dominance of two superpowers, the United States and the Soviet Union, and the onset of the Cold War. The United Nations was established in 1945 with the aim of fostering international cooperation and preventing future conflicts through diplomacy and collective security. However, the ideological divide between the capitalist West and the communist East soon emerged as a defining feature of post-war geopolitics. The division of Europe into East and West, symbolized by the Iron Curtain, led to the formation of military alliances such as NATO and the Warsaw Pact, intensifying tensions and competition between the superpowers. The Cold War era was marked by proxy wars, nuclear arms race, and ideological struggles for influence and supremacy across the globe. The bipolar structure of world politics during this period significantly influenced diplomatic relations, regional conflicts, and the trajectory of international institutions, shaping the course of global affairs for decades to come.

Formation of United Nations

The formation of the United Nations (UN) in 1945 emerged as a response to the devastation and global upheaval caused by World War II. The idea of a successor to the League of Nations, which had failed to prevent the outbreak of the war, gained traction among Allied powers during the conflict. Representatives from 50 nations convened in San Francisco in April 1945 to draft the UN Charter, which outlined the organization's structure, principles, and objectives. The UN aimed to promote international peace and security, foster cooperation in solving economic, social, cultural, and humanitarian issues, and uphold human rights. Key provisions included the establishment of the Security Council, responsible for maintaining peace and security, and the General Assembly, where all member states could deliberate on global issues. The UN Charter was signed on June 26, 1945, and came into effect on October 24, 1945, marking the official birth of the United Nations. The formation of the UN reflected a collective commitment to preventing future conflicts and promoting multilateral cooperation in addressing the world's most pressing challenges.

UN Charter

The United Nations Charter stands as the cornerstone document of international diplomacy and cooperation, born out of the ravages of World War II with the aim of preventing future conflicts and promoting peace and prosperity for all nations. Adopted on June 26, 1945, by representatives of 50 countries in San Francisco, the Charter embodies the collective aspirations of its member states, emphasizing fundamental principles such as the sovereign equality of all nations, the peaceful resolution of disputes, and the commitment to respect

human rights and fundamental freedoms. Its preamble eloquently articulates the determination to "save succeeding generations from the scourge of war," underscoring the urgent need for international cooperation to address global challenges. The Charter not only establishes the structure and functions of the United Nations but also outlines the responsibilities and rights of member states, setting forth a framework for multilateralism and diplomacy in the pursuit of global peace and development.

At its core, the United Nations Charter serves as a guiding beacon for the international community, promoting dialogue, cooperation, and collective action to address the myriad challenges facing humanity. Through its organs such as the General Assembly, Security Council, and specialized agencies, the Charter provides mechanisms for diplomacy, conflict resolution, and the advancement of international law. Moreover, it underscores the importance of economic and social progress, affirming the need for collaboration in areas such as poverty alleviation, health, education, and environmental sustainability. Over the decades, the Charter has been instrumental in shaping the norms and institutions of the international system, adapting to evolving global dynamics while upholding its core principles. Despite the complexities and tensions of global politics, the United Nations Charter remains a testament to the enduring commitment of nations to forge a more peaceful, just, and prosperous world through collective endeavor.

UN Organs

It consists of six main organs, each with specific functions and responsibilities:

1. **The General Assembly:** Constituting representatives from all member states, the General Assembly serves as the primary deliberative and policymaking body of the United Nations (UN). Addressing a broad spectrum of issues encompassing peace and security, development, human rights, and international law, each member state holds one vote, with most decisions requiring a two-thirds majority for passage. Situated at the UN Headquarters in New York City, the General Assembly provides a forum for diplomatic discourse and consensus-building on matters of global importance.
2. **The Security Council:** Tasked with upholding international peace and security, the Security Council constitutes a vital pillar of the UN system. Comprising 15 member states, including five permanent members- **China, France, Russia, the United Kingdom, and the United States**, with veto power, and ten non-permanent members elected for two-year terms, the Security Council wields considerable authority. Operating from the UN Headquarters, its

responsibilities include authorizing peacekeeping missions, imposing sanctions, and issuing resolutions binding on member states. Despite occasional challenges in achieving unanimous agreement due to the veto power wielded by its permanent members, the Security Council remains instrumental in addressing global conflicts and advancing the UN's mission of fostering peace and stability worldwide.

3. **The Economic and Social Council (ECOSOC):** ECOSOC coordinates the economic, social, and related work of 15 UN specialized agencies, including the World Bank and the International Monetary Fund. It promotes sustainable development, fosters international cooperation on economic and social issues, and facilitates dialogue on global challenges.

4. **The Trusteeship Council:** Originally tasked with supervising Trust Territories administered by member states, the Trusteeship Council suspended its operations in 1994 after the independence of all Trust Territories. By a resolution adopted on 25 May 1994, the Council amended its rules of procedure to drop the obligation to meet annually and agreed to meet as occasion required -- by its decision or the decision of its President, or at the request of a majority of its members or the General Assembly or the Security Council (UN.org).

5. **The International Court of Justice (ICJ):** The principal judicial organ of the UN, the ICJ settles legal disputes between states and provides advisory opinions on legal questions referred by UN organs and specialized agencies. It consists of 15 judges elected by the General Assembly and Security Council for nine-year terms.

6. **The Secretariat:** Headed by the Secretary-General, the Secretariat carries out the day-to-day work of the UN, including implementing policies and programs established by the General Assembly and Security Council, providing support to UN bodies and member states, and conducting research and analysis on global issues.

3

UN Peacekeeping

United Nations peacekeeping represents a cornerstone of the organization's efforts to maintain international peace and security. Established in the aftermath of World War II, UN peacekeeping missions have evolved to address a wide range of conflicts and challenges across the globe. These missions typically involve the deployment of military, police, and Peacebuilding: Global Initiatives

civilian personnel from member states to help countries navigate transitions from conflict to peace. UN peacekeepers work to facilitate ceasefires, disarmament processes, and the implementation of peace agreements, while also providing humanitarian assistance and protecting civilians in conflict zones. Over the years, UN peacekeeping has faced numerous complexities and criticisms, including issues related to impartiality, effectiveness, and the safety of personnel. However, these missions have also achieved significant successes in preventing the escalation of violence, promoting reconciliation, and rebuilding war-torn societies. As conflicts continue to evolve and new threats emerge, UN peacekeeping remains a vital tool in the international community's efforts to resolve conflicts and foster sustainable peace.

What UN Peacekeeping does?

UN Peacekeeping helps countries navigate the difficult path from conflict to peace. It has unique strengths, including legitimacy, burden sharing, and an ability to deploy troops and police from around the world, integrating them with civilian peacekeepers to address a range of mandates set by the UN Security Council and General Assembly.

It is the largest and most visible representation of the United Nations. It is a collective investment in global peace, security, and stability. This investment has a proven track record. Over 70 years, peacekeepers have made a tangible difference in the lives of hundreds of millions of the world's most vulnerable people, creating conditions for lasting peace, but a viable political process is central to the work of our operations, as peacekeeping is meant to support and not substitute national efforts.

Peacekeeping is political act and its success depends on active and sustainable political processes or the real prospect of a peace process. Peacekeeping cannot substitute for the political will and determination of the parties to end the conflict and protect their people, nor the host state's sovereign responsibilities. The Security Council has a vital role in securing this commitment and cooperation, while providing missions with realistic and clear mandates. Peacekeepers protect civilians, actively prevent conflict, reduce violence, strengthen security, and empower national authorities to assume these responsibilities. This requires a coherent security and peacebuilding strategy that supports the political strategy. UN peacekeeping helps host countries to become more resilient to conflict, laying the groundwork to sustain long-term peace, including by addressing root causes of conflict.

A strong and effective partnership between the UN Secretariat, the Security Council and the countries that contribute uniformed personnel, has made possible for 55 peacekeeping

operations around the world to have, through the years, successfully completed their mandate. This partnership is essential as we continue to evolve, striving every day to become more agile and adapt to the volatile environments we operate in. UN peacekeeping is also committed to working smarter and using modern technology as well as other innovations.

All of this allows peacekeepers to:

- Protect civilians
- Prevent conflicts
- Build Rule of Law and security institutions
- Promote human rights
- Empower women

United Nations Peacekeeping helps countries torn by conflict create conditions for lasting peace. Peacekeeping has proven to be one of the most effective tools available to the UN to assist host countries navigate the difficult path from conflict to peace. It has unique strengths, including legitimacy, burden sharing, and an ability to deploy and sustain troops and police from around the globe, integrating them with civilian peacekeepers to advance multidimensional mandates. UN peacekeepers provide security and the political and peacebuilding support to help countries make the difficult, early transition from conflict to peace.

UN Peacekeeping is guided by three basic principles:

- Consent of the parties
- Impartiality
- Non-use of force except in self-defence and defence of the mandate

Peacekeeping is flexible and over the past two decades has been deployed in many configurations. There are currently 12 UN peacekeeping operations deployed on three continents.

Today's multidimensional peacekeeping operations are called upon not only to maintain peace and security, but also to facilitate the political process, protect civilians, assist in the disarmament, demobilization and reintegration of former combatants; support the organization of elections, protect and promote human rights and assist in restoring the rule of law.

Success is never guaranteed, because UN Peacekeeping almost by definition goes to the most physically and politically difficult environments. However, we have built up a demonstrable

record of success over our 78 years of existence, including winning the Nobel Peace Prize. Peacekeeping has always been highly dynamic and has evolved in the face of new challenges. Former Secretary-General Ban Ki-moon established a 17-member High-level Independent Panel on UN Peace Operations to make a comprehensive assessment of the state of UN peace operations today, and the emerging needs of the future.

Global partnership

UN peacekeeping is a unique global partnership. It brings together the General Assembly, the Security Council, the Secretariat, troop and police contributors and the host governments in a combined effort to maintain international peace and security. Its strength lies in the legitimacy of the UN Charter and in the wide range of contributing countries that participate and provide precious resources.

In the more than seventy years of its existence, UN Peacekeeping has evolved significantly as a tool of international crisis response. It has proven to be an essential instrument for global peace and security over the years. Our fourteen peacekeeping operations around the world today illustrate the wide range of mechanisms, strategies and resources that the United Nations marshals in support of peace and security.

In recent years, peacekeeping missions have been deployed to increasingly difficult and complex environments, even as demand for peacekeeping has increased. Our core business processes have not kept up with these demands. Mandate implementation is hindered by slow, unresponsive service delivery, micro-management by governing bodies, a trust deficit with Member States and with staff, inadequate resourcing of and ineffective implementation of mandates and a lack of transparency and accountability.

Action for Peacekeeping (A4P)

Peacekeeping is one of the most effective tools available to the United Nations in the promotion and maintenance of international peace and security. Yet peacekeeping faces several challenges that undermine its ability to deliver on its mandates. Political solutions are often absent, and missions seem to have mandates that lack focus and clear priorities. Complex threats in several environments are causing a rise in fatalities and injuries of peacekeepers, and missions have sometimes lacked the personnel and equipment to meet these threats. Peacekeeping operations have also faced challenges in delivering on protection mandates and in contributing to long-term, sustainable peace, and in achieving coherence with other actors operating in the same contexts.

To respond to these challenges, the Secretary-General launched Action for Peacekeeping

(A4P) to renew mutual political commitment to peacekeeping operations. The Secretary-General has called on Member States to join him in developing a set of mutually agreed principles and commitments to create peacekeeping operations fit for the future, with the goal of reaching a formal agreement by the end of 2018.

Future of Peacekeeping Project

Peacekeeping remains one of the most effective tools available to the UN to assist host countries navigate the difficult path from conflict to peace. Our missions operate in a constantly changing environment, impacted by – and shaping – the social, political, and economic changes in the places where we are deployed. To ensure that UN operations continue to make a positive contribution in the next five to ten years, it is critical that we examine the factors that may influence the direction of UN peace operations, to adjust and prepare for the future.

The Action for Peacekeeping (A4P) initiative, which was launched in 2018 by Secretary-General António Guterres, is focused on strengthening the peacekeeping operations of today, and remains the central framework for peacekeeping policy and reform. The Secretariat is currently developing its priorities for a next phase of A4P implementation in 2021 and beyond.

At the same time, longer-term trends in peace and conflict need to be addressed. In this regard the Future of Peacekeeping project attempts to imagine what the peacekeeping operations of the future might look like. The project draws on broad and inclusive consultations with UN and non-UN stakeholders, including discussions within and outside of the UN Secretariat as well as dozens of in-depth interviews with peacekeeping stakeholders such as representatives of Member States, academia, civil society, regional organizations, and former peacekeeping practitioners.

The objective is to produce a paper for the consideration of UN leadership, reflecting thinking on the future of peacekeeping with proposals for possible policy reorientations and changes. The project will feed into the Secretary-General's common agenda for the future. The project aims to respond to such questions as: what conflicts may the UN be called upon to respond to in the coming decade? What are some of the threats and challenges to peace and security that the United Nations should prepare for? How has the context on the ground changed and how can the Organization position and adapt its operations to continue to play a valuable and effective role in addressing future peace and security challenges?

New Horizon

The New Horizon process was initiated in 2009 to:

- Assess the major policy and strategy dilemmas facing UN Peacekeeping today and over the coming years; and
- Reinvigorate the ongoing dialogue with stakeholders on possible solutions to better calibrate UN Peacekeeping to meet current and future requirements.

A New Partnership Agenda: Charting a New Horizon for UN Peacekeeping is an internal document prepared as part of the “New Horizon” process of developing a forward agenda for UN Peacekeeping. It reflects both the perspectives of the Department of Peacekeeping Operations (DPKO) and the Department of Field Support (DFS).

The paper, which was released to Member States and peacekeeping partners in July 2009, supported a reinvigorated dialogue with the aim of forging a peacekeeping policy agenda that reflects the perspectives of all stakeholders in the global peacekeeping partnership. Building on previous peacekeeping reform efforts, the paper highlighted achievements in improving the peacekeeping tool and identified outstanding, as well as new, dilemmas that require the attention of the peacekeeping partnership.

Reform in 2017

Secretary-General António Guterres has proposed reforms in the United Nations peace and security architecture, in the UN’s management system and structures, as well as in the UN development system. His vision of the reform of peace operations places politics at the centre of our work. It has the overall objective of reducing fragmentation for better delivery, to make the peace and security pillar more coherent, nimble, and effective by prioritizing prevention, sustaining peace and delivery on Agenda 2030.

Former Secretary-General Ban Ki-moon established a **High-level Independent Panel on UN Peace Operations on 31 October 2014**, to make a comprehensive assessment of the state of UN peace operations today, and the emerging needs of the future. Announcing the decision, the Secretary-General said that “the world is changing, and UN peace operations must change with it if they are to remain an indispensable and effective tool in promoting international peace and security.” With the 15-year anniversary of the Brahimi report approaching, the Secretary-General felt that it was necessary to again take stock of evolving expectations of UN peacekeeping and how the Organization can work toward a shared view of the way forward.

The 16-member Panel was chaired by Mr. Jose Ramos-Horta (Timor-Leste) with Ms.

Ameerah Haq (Bangladesh) as Vice-Chair. It drew together a wide range of experience and expertise.

The Panel considered a broad range of issues facing peace operations, including the changing nature of conflict, evolving mandates, good offices and peacebuilding challenges, managerial and administrative arrangements, planning, partnerships, human rights, and protection of civilians. The review encompasses both UN peacekeeping operations as well as special political missions, which are referred to collectively as “UN peace operations. The Secretary-General received the Panel's report on 16 June 2015. Key elements of the paper were taken up by the Secretary-General in his Report to the Special Committee on Peacekeeping Operations [A/64/573]. These have informed formal and informal deliberations among members of the peacekeeping partnership to help crystallize a common vision of the requirements to bolster peacekeeping to fulfil its role more effectively in support of international peace and security.

UN Peacekeeping Mission cases

1.UN Peacekeeping Mission in Rwanda (UNAMIR)

In the early 1990s, Rwanda was torn apart by ethnic tensions between the Hutu majority and Tutsi minority. In response to the escalating violence, the United Nations Security Council authorized the deployment of the UNAMIR mission in October 1993 to oversee the implementation of the Arusha Accords, which aimed to end the conflict. However, the mission was ill-equipped and lacked a clear mandate to intervene forcefully in the face of mounting atrocities. When genocide erupted in April 1994, UN peacekeepers were unable to prevent the mass killings, which claimed the lives of nearly 800,000 Tutsis and moderate Hutus. The failure of UNAMIR to protect civilians and stop the genocide remains a tragic stain on the history of UN peacekeeping, underscoring the need for stronger mandates, adequate resources, and timely action in future missions.

2.UN Peacekeeping Mission in Liberia: (UNMIL)

Following years of civil war and instability in Liberia, the United Nations Security Council authorized the deployment of the UNMIL mission in September 2003 to support the implementation of a ceasefire agreement and facilitate the disarmament and demobilization of armed groups. Over the course of its 15-year mandate, UNMIL played a crucial role in stabilizing the country, assisting with the organization of free and fair elections, and supporting the reintegration of ex-combatants into society. By providing security and promoting political dialogue, UNMIL helped pave the way for Liberia's transition to peace

and democracy. The mission officially concluded in March 2018, marking a significant milestone in Liberia's post- conflict reconstruction, and demonstrating the potential of UN peacekeeping to contribute to long-term peacebuilding efforts.

3.UN Peacekeeping in Namibia: United Nations Transition Assistance Group (UNTAG)

In Namibia, UN peacekeeping played a pivotal role in ending decades of conflict and colonial rule. Before the deployment of the United Nations Transition Assistance Group (UNTAG) in 1989, Namibia had been under the control of South Africa, which administered the territory as a de facto colony. The conflict stemmed from Namibia's struggle for independence, which was fiercely opposed by South Africa. UNTAG's mandate was to oversee the transition to independence and ensure a peaceful resolution to the conflict. This involved monitoring the withdrawal of South African forces, organizing and supervising the country's first democratic elections, and assisting in the establishment of democratic institutions. Despite initial challenges and resistance, UNTAG's presence helped to prevent violence and ensure a smooth transition of power, leading to Namibia's independence on March 21, 1990. UNTAG's efforts laid the foundation for peace and stability in the newly independent nation, setting an example for successful UN peacekeeping missions worldwide.

4. UN Peacekeeping in Congo (DRC): Mission in the Democratic Republic of the Congo (MONUSCO)

The United Nations Organization Stabilization Mission in the Democratic Republic of the Congo (MONUSCO) operates in one of the most complex and volatile regions in the world. The conflict in the Democratic Republic of the Congo (DRC) has deep roots in colonialism, ethnic tensions, resource exploitation, and regional power struggles. Following the Rwandan genocide in 1994, armed groups and militias fled into eastern Congo, exacerbating existing tensions and leading to a series of conflicts known as the Congo Wars. MONUSCO was established in 1999 to address the humanitarian crisis and restore stability in the region. Its mandate includes protecting civilians, supporting the implementation of peace agreements, and assisting the Congolese government in stabilizing the country. Despite its challenges, MONUSCO has made significant contributions to peace and security in the DRC, working alongside government forces and international partners to address the root causes of conflict and promote reconciliation and development.

3.UN Peacekeeping Mission in Lebanon : United Nations Interim Force in Lebanon (UNIFIL)

UNIFIL was established in 1978 by the United Nations Security Council to confirm the withdrawal of Israeli forces from Lebanon, restore peace and security, and assist the Lebanese government in reestablishing its authority in the south of the country. The mission was prompted by the Israeli invasion of Lebanon in response to border attacks by Palestinian militants. UNIFIL initially faced challenges in fulfilling its mandate, particularly due to the complex political and security situation in Lebanon.

2006 Lebanon War:

In July 2006, conflict erupted between Israel and the militant group Hezbollah, leading to a devastating 34-day war. UNIFIL's role became critical in the aftermath of the conflict, as it worked to implement UN Security Council Resolution 1701, which called for a ceasefire, the withdrawal of Israeli forces from Lebanon, the disarming of Hezbollah, and the deployment of Lebanese Armed Forces in southern Lebanon. UNIFIL's mandate was expanded to include monitoring the cessation of hostilities, assisting Lebanese authorities in securing the borders, and facilitating humanitarian assistance and reconstruction efforts.

Current Operations:

UNIFIL continues to operate in Lebanon, with approximately 10,500 troops from various contributing countries as of early 2022. The mission conducts patrols, monitors the Blue Line (the border between Israel and Lebanon), and assists the Lebanese Armed Forces in maintaining security and stability in the south. However, UNIFIL faces ongoing challenges, including tensions along the Blue Line, violations of Lebanese airspace and sovereignty, and the presence of unauthorized weapons and armed groups in operations. Despite these challenges, UNIFIL remains committed to its mandate of promoting peace and stability in Lebanon.

4

Agenda for Peace

The "Agenda for Peace" is a seminal document authored by former United Nations Secretary-General Boutros Boutros-Ghali, released in 1992. It provided a comprehensive framework for addressing the challenges of conflict prevention, peacekeeping, and post-conflict peacebuilding in the post-Cold War era. The document emphasized the need for a more proactive and holistic approach to peace and security, advocating for early warning mechanisms, preventive diplomacy, and peacemaking efforts to address conflicts before they escalate. It also stressed the importance of strengthening the United Nations' capacity for

peacekeeping operations, including improving rapid deployment capabilities and enhancing cooperation with regional organizations. Additionally, the "Agenda for Peace" underscored the importance of addressing the root causes of conflict, such as poverty, inequality, and human rights abuses, through sustainable development and humanitarian assistance. Overall, the document served as a guiding framework for the United Nations and the international community in their efforts to prevent and resolve conflicts and promote lasting peace and security worldwide.

The "Agenda for Peace," as outlined by Boutros Boutros-Ghali in 1992, encompassed several key elements aimed at addressing the complexities of conflict prevention, peacekeeping, and peacebuilding. These elements included:

1. **Preventive Diplomacy:** The Agenda emphasized the importance of early intervention and diplomatic efforts to prevent conflicts from escalating into violence. This involved proactive engagement by the United Nations and the international community to address underlying grievances, mediate disputes, and promote dialogue among conflicting parties.
2. **Peacemaking:** Building upon preventive diplomacy, peacemaking efforts aimed to resolve conflicts through negotiation, mediation, and the facilitation of peace agreements. This element emphasized the need for impartial mediators and creative diplomatic approaches to bridge differences and reach sustainable solutions.
3. **Peacekeeping:** The Agenda highlighted the vital role of peacekeeping operations in maintaining peace and security in post-conflict environments. It called for robust and multidimensional peacekeeping mandates, including the monitoring of ceasefires, disarming of combatants, protection of civilians, and support for political transitions.
4. **Post-Conflict Peacebuilding:** Recognizing the importance of addressing the root causes of conflict and promoting long-term stability, the agenda emphasized the need for comprehensive peacebuilding efforts. This included support for governance reform, institution-building, rule of law, economic reconstruction, and reconciliation processes to address the underlying drivers of conflict and build peace.

5

Peacebuilding to Sustaining Peace

The evolution from peacebuilding to sustaining peace represents a paradigm shift in how the international community approaches the challenges of conflict prevention, resolution, and post-conflict reconstruction. Peacebuilding traditionally focused on addressing the

immediate aftermath of conflict, including rebuilding infrastructure, restoring institutions, and promoting reconciliation. However, it became increasingly clear that sustainable peace requires a more comprehensive and long-term approach that addresses the root causes of conflict and promotes resilience at all stages of the conflict cycle.

The concept of sustaining peace emerged as a response to this recognition, emphasizing the need to foster peace and prevent the recurrence of conflict through integrated and coordinated efforts. Unlike peacebuilding, which often focused on short-term interventions, sustaining peace adopts a broader perspective that encompasses prevention, conflict resolution, peacekeeping, peacebuilding, and development.

1. **Preventive Approaches:** Sustaining peace emphasizes the importance of prevention and early action in addressing the root causes of conflict before they escalate into violence. This involves investing in conflict prevention mechanisms, early warning systems, and addressing structural drivers such as poverty, inequality, and exclusion.
2. **Inclusive and Participatory Processes:** Sustaining peace prioritizes inclusive and participatory approaches that engage local communities, civil society organizations, and marginalized groups in decision-making processes. By empowering local actors and addressing their grievances, sustaining peace efforts aim to build resilience and foster social cohesion.
3. **Integrated and Coordinated Efforts:** Sustaining peace recognizes the interconnectedness of peace, development, and human rights, emphasizing the need for integrated and coordinated approaches. This involves breaking down silos between humanitarian, development, and peacebuilding actors to address the underlying drivers of conflict comprehensively.
4. **Long-Term Commitment:** Sustaining peace acknowledges that building and maintaining peace is a long-term endeavour that requires sustained political commitment, financial investment, and international support. This involves investing in institution-building, strengthening governance, and promoting inclusive and sustainable development

6

Human rights

Human rights are fundamental rights and freedoms that are inherent to all human beings, regardless of race, nationality, ethnicity, gender, religion, or any other status. These rights are

based on principles of dignity, equality, and non-discrimination and are enshrined in international human rights instruments such as the Universal Declaration of Human Rights (UDHR), adopted by the United Nations General Assembly in 1948. Human rights include the right to life and liberty, freedom from slavery and torture, freedom of opinion and expression, the right to work and education, and many more. Everyone is entitled to these rights, without discrimination.

Evolution of Human Rights

The evolution of human rights spans centuries and is shaped by historical, philosophical, political, and social developments. While the concept of rights can be traced back to ancient civilizations and philosophical traditions, the modern understanding of human rights emerged in the context of major historical events and movements. Here are key milestones in the evolution of human rights:

1. **Enlightenment and Liberalism:** The Enlightenment era in the 17th and 18th centuries saw the rise of philosophical ideas emphasizing individual freedom, equality, and natural rights. Thinkers such as John Locke, Jean-Jacques Rousseau, and Immanuel Kant laid the groundwork for the concept of human rights as inherent to all individuals by virtue of their humanity.
2. **American and French Revolutions:** The American Declaration of Independence in 1776 and the French Declaration of the Rights of Man and of the Citizen in 1789 marked significant milestones in the recognition of individual rights and freedoms. These documents enshrined principles such as liberty, equality, and fraternity, inspiring movements for democracy and human rights worldwide.
3. **Abolitionism and the Fight Against Slavery:** The 19th century saw the emergence of abolitionist movements advocating for the end of slavery and the recognition of the inherent dignity and equality of all individuals. The abolition of the transatlantic slave trade and the gradual emancipation of slaves in various countries represented important victories for human rights.
4. **International Humanitarian Law:** The atrocities of World War II prompted the international community to establish legal frameworks to protect civilians and combatants during armed conflict. The Geneva Conventions of 1949 and the subsequent development of international humanitarian law aimed to safeguard human dignity and minimize the suffering of individuals affected by war.
5. **Universal Declaration of Human Rights:** Adopted by the United Nations General

Assembly in 1948, the Universal Declaration of Human Rights (UDHR) represents a landmark document that sets out the fundamental rights and freedoms to which all human beings are entitled. The UDHR laid the foundation for the international human rights framework and inspired the development of human rights treaties and conventions.

6. **Civil Rights and Social Movements:** The mid-20th century witnessed a surge of civil rights movements advocating for racial equality, gender equality, LGBTQ+ rights, and indigenous rights. These movements led to legal reforms, such as the Civil Rights Act of 1964 in the United States and the Convention on the Elimination of All Forms of Discrimination Against Women (CEDAW) in 1979, which advanced the protection of human rights for marginalized groups.

7. **Expansion of Human Rights Norms:** In the latter half of the 20th century and into the 21st century, human rights norms expanded to encompass economic, social, and cultural rights, as well as collective rights and environmental rights. This broader understanding of human rights reflects the interconnectedness of political, economic, social, and environmental factors in ensuring human dignity and well-being.

International Human Rights Law

International human rights law lays down the obligations of Governments to act in certain ways or to refrain from certain acts, to promote and protect human rights and fundamental freedoms of individuals or groups. One of the great achievements of the United Nations is the creation of a comprehensive body of human rights law—a universal and internationally protected code to which all nations can subscribe, and all people aspire. The United Nations has defined a broad range of internationally accepted rights, including civil, cultural, economic, political, and social rights. It has also established mechanisms to promote and protect these rights and to assist states in carrying out their responsibilities. The foundations of this body of law are the Charter of the United Nations and the Universal Declaration of Human Rights, adopted by the General Assembly in 1945 and 1948, respectively. Since then, the United Nations has gradually expanded human rights law to encompass specific standards for women, children, persons with disabilities, minorities and other vulnerable groups, who now possess rights that protect them from discrimination that had long been common in many societies.

Universal Declaration of Human Rights

The Universal Declaration of Human Rights (UDHR) is a milestone document in the history of human rights. Drafted by representatives with different legal and cultural backgrounds

from all regions of the world, the Declaration was proclaimed by the United Nations General Assembly in Paris on 10 December 1948 by General Assembly resolution 217 A (III) as a common standard of achievements for all peoples and all nations. It sets out, for the first time, fundamental human rights to be universally protected. Since its adoption in 1948, the UDHR has been translated into more than 500 languages - the most translated document in the world - and has inspired the constitutions of many newly independent States and many new democracies. The UDHR, together with **the International Covenant on Civil and Political Rights (ICCPR) 1966** and **the International Covenant on Economic, Social and Cultural Rights (ICESCR) (1976)**, which are often referred to as “the International Covenants.” Together, the UDHR and these two Covenants are known as the **International Bill of Human Rights**. (<https://www.ohchr.org/en/what-are-human-rights/international-bill-human-rights>)

Economic, social, and cultural rights

The International Covenant on Economic, Social and Cultural Rights entered into force in 1976. The Committee on Economic, Social and Cultural Rights is the body of 18 independent experts that monitors implementation of the Covenant by its States parties. Its Optional Protocol entered into force in 2013. The human rights that the Covenant seeks to promote and protect include:

- the right to work in just and favourable conditions.
- the right to social protection, to an adequate standard of living and to the highest attainable standards of physical and mental well-being.
- the right to education and the enjoyment of benefits of cultural freedom and scientific progress.

Civil and political rights

The International Covenant on Civil and Political Rights and its First Optional Protocol entered into force in 1976 and the Second Optional Protocol came into force in 1991. The Human Rights Committee monitors the implementation of this multilateral treaty and its Optional Protocols.

The Covenant deals with such rights as freedom of movement; equality before the law; the right to a fair trial and presumption of innocence; freedom of thought, conscience, and religion; freedom of opinion and expression; peaceful assembly; freedom of association; participation in public affairs and elections; and protection of minority rights. It prohibits

arbitrary deprivation of life; torture, cruel or degrading treatment or punishment; slavery and forced labour; arbitrary arrest or detention; arbitrary interference with privacy; war propaganda; discrimination; and advocacy of racial or religious hatred.

Human Rights Conventions

A series of international human rights treaties and other instruments adopted since 1945 have expanded the body of international human rights law. They include the **Convention on the Prevention and Punishment of the Crime of Genocide (1948)**, the **International Convention on the Elimination of All Forms of Racial Discrimination (1965)**, the **Convention on the Elimination of All Forms of Discrimination against Women (1979)**, the **Convention on the Rights of the Child (1989)** and the **Convention on the Rights of Persons with Disabilities (2006)**, among others.

Human Rights Council

The Human Rights Council, established on 15 March 2006 by the General Assembly and reporting directly to it, replaced the 60-year-old UN Commission on Human Rights as the key UN intergovernmental body responsible for human rights. The Council is made up of 47 State representatives and is tasked with strengthening the promotion and protection of human rights around the globe by addressing situations of human rights violations and making recommendations on them, including responding to human rights emergencies.

The most innovative feature of the Human Rights Council is the Universal Periodic Review (UPR). This unique mechanism involves a review of the human rights records of all 193 UN member states once every four years. The Review is a cooperative, state-driven process, under the auspices of the Council, which provides the opportunity for each state to present measures taken and challenges to be met to improve the human rights situation in their country and to meet their international obligations. The Review is designed to ensure universality and equality of treatment for every country and takes place during the sessions of the UPR Working Group which meets three times a year. The UPR Working Group consists of the 47 members of the Council.

Special Procedures and Investigative Bodies

The Human Rights Council also has special procedures that consist of independent human rights experts who have the mandate to report and advise on human rights from a thematic or country-specific perspective. These experts are not paid and are elected for 3-year mandates that can be extended for another three years. As of November 2023, there are 46 thematic and

14 country mandates.

Since 2006, the Council has set up various investigative bodies to investigate alleged violations in specific countries. These have taken the form of fact-finding missions and commissions of inquiry. In addition, there is one thematic body, the Expert Mechanism to Advance Racial Justice and Equality in Law Enforcement

UN High Commissioner for Human Rights

The United Nations High Commissioner for Human Rights exercises principal responsibility for UN human rights activities. The High Commissioner is mandated to respond to serious violations of human rights and to undertake preventive action.

The Office of the High Commissioner for Human Rights (OHCHR) is the focal point for United Nations human rights activities. It serves as the secretariat for the Human Rights Council, the treaty bodies (expert committees that monitor treaty compliance) and other UN human rights organs. It also undertakes human rights field activities.

Most of the core human rights treaties have an oversight body which is responsible for reviewing the implementation of that treaty by the countries that have ratified it. Individuals, whose rights have been violated can file complaints directly to Committees overseeing human rights treaties.

Human Rights and the UN System

Human rights are a cross-cutting theme in all UN policies and programmes in the key areas of peace and security, development, humanitarian assistance, and economic and social affairs. As a result, virtually every UN body and specialized agency is involved to some degree in the protection of human rights. Some examples are the right to development, which is at the core of the Sustainable Development Goals; the right to food, championed by the UN Food and Agriculture Organization, labour rights, defined and protected by the International Labour Organization, gender equality, which is promulgated by UN Women, the rights of children, indigenous peoples, and disabled persons

Human Rights Day

It is observed every year on **10 December**. The Universal Declaration of Human Rights turns 75. On 10 December 2023, the UN System celebrated the 75th Anniversary of the Universal Declaration of Human Rights. The OHCHR conducted a year-long commemoration, the Human Rights Initiative, during which 150 Member States, NGOs, businesses and UN entities made pledges on a wide range of human rights issues - from advancing women's rights, and children's rights, to commitments on climate change, and empowering people

with disabilities to ensure legislative reforms.

The three main goals focus of the initiative were focused in universality, progress and engagement under the leadership of UN Human Rights, together with its partners. The 75th Anniversary culminated in a high-level event in December 2023 that announced global pledges and ideas for a vision for the future of human rights.

Human Rights Violations

Human rights face numerous challenges worldwide, stemming from various sources including governments, non-state actors, systemic inequalities, and socio-political factors. For instance, authoritarian regimes such as North Korea suppress dissent, restrict freedoms of speech, and target human rights defenders. In conflict zones like Syria and Yemen, armed groups commit widespread human rights violations, including killings, sexual violence, and forced recruitment of children. You can see the Human rights abuses in Israel and Palestine. Discrimination against marginalized groups persists in many societies; for example, the Rohingya Muslims in Myanmar face persecution and displacement, while LGBTQ+ individuals in several countries endure discrimination and violence. Socioeconomic inequalities, exemplified by the vast wealth gap between the richest and poorest individuals, hinder the realization of economic and social rights. In countries like Brazil and South Africa, indigenous communities struggle for land rights and environmental protection amid rapid industrialization and resource extraction. Impunity for human rights violations remains a challenge; for instance, perpetrators of war crimes in conflicts like the Syrian Civil War often escape accountability. Technological advancements present new challenges to digital rights, with governments in countries like China and Iran imposing strict online censorship and surveillance measures. Addressing these challenges requires collaborative efforts to uphold human rights standards, strengthen accountability mechanisms, combat discrimination and inequality, and promote inclusive development and respect for human dignity.

7

Human security

It is an approach to national and international security that gives primacy to human beings and their complex social and economic interactions. The concept of human security represents a departure from orthodox security studies, which focus on the security of the state. The subjects of the human security approach are individuals, and its end goal is the

protection of people from traditional (i.e., military) and nontraditional threats such as poverty and disease. Moving the security agenda beyond state security does not mean replacing it but rather involves complementing and building on it. Central to this approach is the understanding that human security deprivations can undermine peace and stability within and between states, whereas an overemphasis on state security can be detrimental to human welfare. The state remains a central provider of security, but state security is not a sufficient condition for human welfare.

Human security fully entered the policy and academic debates in the early 1990s. Nevertheless, despite its widespread usage within national and international policy circles, its definition remains highly contested. The holistic vision of protecting the security of people lends itself to a variety of interpretations shaped by relative understandings of what constitutes a threat to the security of individuals, how the intensity and repercussion of any given threat can be measured (i.e., historical data or forward-looking forecasts), and by what possible means the threat can be prevented or removed. The coalition of states and supranational organizations that have supported the approach can count numerous accomplishments, such as the Ottawa Convention (i.e., Mine Ban Treaty), the establishment of the International Criminal Court, and the Optional Protocol to the Convention of the Rights of the Child.

Origins and development

The idea of extending the concept of security from state security to individual human beings was first articulated by the Independent Commission on Disarmament and Security Issues in 1982. The Common Security report provided the first comprehensive criticism of the purely military approach to security while highlighting the need to devote due attention to the relation between security and the well-being of individuals. After years of latency, a crucial point in history for the development of the concept is the end of the Cold War and the revitalization of long-standing bottom-up arguments within progressive academic and policy circles, once it was realized that the disappearance of the superpowers' military threats did not necessarily entail an enhanced level of security for citizens within states. The evolution of the security discourse was also moulded by the need to address the global social problems arising within the context of a globalizing world. The potential threats to individuals' lives and well-being were therefore extended from being primarily military to broadly encompass economic, social, environmental, and health concerns.

In connection with the immediate post-Cold War period and the new development agenda,

the first authoritative definition of human security was provided in 1994 when Mahbub ul Haq drew attention to the concept in the United Nations Development Program (UNDP) Human Development Report. Beyond territorial and military concerns, the report argued that human security is fundamentally concerned with human life and dignity. For analytical purposes, UNDP disentangled its four main characteristics: it is universal, its components are interdependent, it is best ensured through prevention, and it is people-centred. On the more substantive level, the definition of human security given in the report remained broad and all-encompassing.

For UNDP, human security meant safety from chronic threats such as hunger, disease, and repression, and it meant protection from sudden and hurtful disruptions in the patterns of daily life. Understood in these terms, human security has also been encapsulated in the **“freedom from fear”** and **“freedom from want”** policy axiom. Although acknowledging the varying intensity of possible threats to human welfare, UNDP grouped these threats in seven no exhaustive and nonexclusive security categories community, economic, environmental, food, health, personal, and political. Despite the broadness and the apparent conceptual weaknesses of the definition provided by the report, the general prescriptions outlined therein provided a useful springboard for academic inquiry and remained a useful organizing concept for the work of international organizations throughout the 1990s.

Criticism and debate

The 1994 UNDP report opened an outlet for the academic redefinition of human security. Numerous scholars attempted to disentangle the dimensions of what immediately appeared to be an overly unrestrained analytical tool, which, by virtue of its all-encompassing nature, could lose its meaning. Several scholars worked toward a recategorization of what could be classified a threat to human security.

The reconceptualization of human security engaged scholars in a fierce academic debate, some in favour of narrowing the concept to a valuable essence and some wanting to preserve its holistic character. On the grounds of analytical rigour, pragmatism, and policy relevance, some experts argued that the sole denominator for the human security agenda should be a focus on violent threats. In this view, a list like description of any possible “bad thing” that could happen to individuals is a peril to conceptual clarity and renders causal analysis virtually impossible. Advocates of the broad theorization opposed this approach. They argued that once the referent of the security agenda becomes the individual, it is impossible to disentangle violent threats to individuals from other issues such as poverty, environmental

degradation, and infectious diseases that directly impinge on the safety, freedom, and self-realization of human beings. In this view, human security means not only meeting basic needs but also the realization of human dignity. Other scholars offer a middle approach, bridging the narrow and broad conceptualizations. They produced an analytical scheme including only those elements that, in their view, human beings might fight over or risk their lives for.

The debate is far from settled and remains a source of controversy. In particular, all the attempts that have been made to sharpen the definition of human security had to confront the exclusive problems of either attaching a value and a priority to possible potential threats to human life and vaguely justifying such a choice or of maintaining the undefined connotations embedded in the original proposal while losing analytical rigour.

International initiatives for Human Security

Human security has entered the policy discourse of several governments. Notable examples are Canada and Japan during the 1990s and early 2000s. Each provided a slightly different definition of the concept and customized its application to best suit its individual interests. The government of Japan subscribed to a comprehensive understanding of human security—one that covers all the aspects that potentially endanger survival, daily life, and human dignity. On the other hand, the Canadian government, led by former foreign minister Lloyd Axworthy, adhered to a narrower but still open-ended definition of human security that distinguishes “**freedom from fear**” from “**freedom from want**” while acknowledging their distinctiveness and mutual interdependence.

An attempt to institutionalize the human security agenda internationally created **the Human Security Network**, a result of a bilateral agreement between Canada and Norway in 1998; 13 other countries and one observer later joined the initiative. This intergovernmental forum was created to advance and embed further the human security agenda within global governance, with the end goal of creating a more humane world free from fear and want and where people can fully develop their human potential. The network was intended to serve as a forum for dialogue and research and, above all, as an avenue to share evolving understandings and practices to advance the development of the human security approach. Substantively, the policy proceedings resulting from yearly ministerial meetings provided general guidelines for states where the safety and well-being of citizens were endangered; they also helped legitimize the UN’s overarching framework for the human security approach. Yet beyond this “coalition of the willing,” very few states embraced the approach and used it as reference for

their domestic and foreign policies.

At the supranational level, the UN played a crucial role in defining, supporting, and translating the new security paradigm from idea into practice. Alongside the UN, other international organizations demonstrated interest in the agenda. Both James Wolfensohn, a former president of the World Bank, and Michael Camdessus, a former managing director of the International Monetary Fund, expressed a commitment to policy and institutional reforms in line with the human security paradigm by means of expanding representation within the respective institutions and by extending ownership of developmental policies to individual communities. The extent to which these people-centred reforms will have an effect in eliminating want remains questionable; having reached a certain maturity, the reforms have not resolved the gross distributional problems that lay at the heart of global inequality and individual security.

Dimension of Human Security

Economic Security: It needs to guarantee basic income, and job security and remove poverty. It signifies that a person is free to choose his job interest and gets his basic income. Globally, many people feel insecure because jobs are scarce and therefore it is not easy to find and keep. The developing countries, as well as advanced countries, face this experience. There is a gradual increase in unemployment in the world in the last twenty years.

Food security is a critical dimension of human security, encompassing access to sufficient, safe, and nutritious food for all individuals. Efforts to address food insecurity may include agricultural development programs, food assistance initiatives, and policies to improve access to land and resources for small-scale farmers.

Health security focuses on protecting individuals from health threats such as disease outbreaks, pandemics, and inadequate healthcare access. This includes investments in public health infrastructure, disease surveillance, healthcare systems strengthening, and access to essential medicines and vaccines.

Environmental security addresses the risks posed by environmental degradation, pollution, natural disasters, and climate change to human well-being and livelihoods. Strategies to enhance environmental security may include conservation efforts, disaster preparedness and response measures, and sustainable development practices.

Political security: involves safeguarding individuals' rights to political participation, freedom of expression, and protection from political repression and violence. This includes promoting democratic governance, rule of law, human rights protections, and conflict

prevention efforts.

Community security: Involves the protection of a group of individuals (usually the minority group) from the loss of their traditional culture, habits, relationships, and values, as well as from sectarian (religious) and ethnic violence (<https://humansecuritycourse.info/module-1-the-concept-of-human-security/un-approach/>).

Challenges to Human Security

Human security faces numerous challenges worldwide, arising from a combination of factors including political, economic, social, environmental, and technological dimensions. Some of the key challenges against human security include:

1. **Armed Conflict and Violence:** Armed conflicts, whether between states, within states, or involving non-state actors, pose significant threats to human security. They result in widespread human rights violations, displacement of populations, destruction of infrastructure, and trauma for affected communities. The ongoing conflict in Syria has resulted in widespread human rights violations, displacement of millions of people, destruction of infrastructure, and loss of livelihoods, threatening the security and well-being of affected populations.
2. **Terrorism and Extremism:** Terrorism and extremist ideologies undermine human security by instilling fear, disrupting social cohesion, and destabilizing societies. Acts of terrorism target civilians, infringing upon their rights to life, safety, and freedom from fear. Terrorist attacks, such as the bombing of mosques in Afghanistan by extremist groups like the Taliban, have instilled fear, disrupted social cohesion, and undermined the safety and security of civilians.
3. **Poverty and Inequality:** Persistent poverty and socioeconomic inequalities limit access to necessities such as food, water, healthcare, education, and housing, undermining human security. Inequitable distribution of resources exacerbates social tensions and can lead to social unrest and conflict. In countries like Nigeria, high levels of poverty and income inequality contribute to social unrest, violence, and insecurity, as marginalized communities struggle to access necessities and opportunities for socio-economic advancement.
4. **Humanitarian Crises and Displacement:** Humanitarian crises, including natural disasters, pandemics, and refugee flows, threaten human security by disrupting livelihoods, straining resources, and exacerbating vulnerabilities. Displaced populations are particularly vulnerable to exploitation, abuse, and violations of their rights. The refugee crisis in the

Mediterranean, driven by conflicts in the Middle East and North Africa, has resulted in thousands of deaths at sea, exploitation by human traffickers, and inadequate reception conditions in host countries, threatening the human security of displaced populations.

5. **Environmental Degradation and Climate Change:** Environmental degradation, pollution, deforestation, and climate change pose significant threats to human security. They result in loss of livelihoods, displacement of communities, food and water scarcity, and increased frequency and severity of natural disasters, affecting the well-being and safety of populations. Rising sea levels and extreme weather events, such as hurricanes and floods, pose significant threats to human security in vulnerable regions like Bangladesh, where millions of people are at risk of displacement, food insecurity, and loss of livelihoods due to environmental degradation.

6. **Cybersecurity and Digital Threats:** Rapid technological advancements and increased connectivity have given rise to new threats to human security in the digital domain. Cyberattacks, data breaches, online harassment, and surveillance infringe upon individuals' privacy, freedom of expression, and right to information. Cyberattacks targeting critical infrastructure, such as the WannaCry ransomware attack that disrupted healthcare systems worldwide, undermine the security and privacy of individuals, businesses, and governments, highlighting the vulnerabilities in the digital domain.

7. **Human Rights Violations:** Violations of human rights, including restrictions on freedom of speech, assembly, and association, political repression, arbitrary detention, and torture, undermine human security and erode trust in institutions. Authoritarian regimes suppress dissent, limit civic engagement, and perpetuate impunity for abuses. The crackdown on dissent and political opposition in countries like Belarus, where peaceful protesters are subjected to violence, arbitrary detention, and torture by security forces, threatens the human security and rights of citizens seeking to exercise their freedoms.

Addressing these challenges requires concerted efforts to promote peace, inclusive development, respect for human rights, and environmental sustainability. Multilateral cooperation, political will, and investment in preventive measures are essential to safeguarding human security and building resilient and equitable societies.

Humanitarian Intervention

The actions undertaken by an organization or organizations (usually a state or a coalition of states) that are intended to alleviate extensive human suffering within the borders of a sovereign state. Such suffering tends to be the result of a government instigating, facilitating, or ignoring the abuse of groups falling within its jurisdiction. This abuse often takes the form of deliberate and systematic violations of human rights, including forced expulsions, ethnic cleansing, and, in the most extreme cases, genocide. Humanitarian intervention can apply also in situations where there is no effective government and civil order consequently has collapsed.

Humanitarian intervention constitutes a calculated and uninvited breach of sovereignty (state rights) in the name of humanity (individual rights). Though humanitarian interventions do not necessarily require the employment of military force—as they could include, for example, the imposition of sanctions—the term refers normally to situations in which force (or the threat of force) is used. Humanitarian intervention has become a major focus of debate within governments, international organizations, and think tanks and across a variety of academic fields, including international and comparative law, international relations, political science, and moral and political philosophy.

Humanitarian intervention and state sovereignty

The language and practice of humanitarian intervention is far from new. It has been the source of incessant argument by lawyers, theologians, and philosophers for generations, even centuries. But the recent debate has its origins in the Cold War and was motivated by several controversial military actions. Three in particular stand out: India's intervention in the Bangladesh War of 1971; Vietnam's intervention in Cambodia in 1978, which resulted in the overthrow of the genocidal Khmer Rouge regime; and Tanzania's intervention in Uganda in 1979, which ousted the dictator Idi Amin. These interventions were all condemned throughout the world. This criticism tended to be based on the contention that they undermined the notion of state sovereignty enshrined in Article 51 of the United Nations (UN) Charter. As such, these interventions offered a fundamental challenge to the stability of the post-World War II international system.

In the post-Cold War era, however, this conception of sovereignty as sacrosanct came under sustained attack. It was argued that despotic leaders should not be able to hide behind the

shield of state sovereignty and that the international community had an obligation to intervene to stop the widespread abuse of human rights. This contention garnered widespread support. It was an important theme, for example, in the writings of UN Secretary-General Boutros Boutros-Ghali. The 1990s was a decade of interventions: Iraqi “no-fly zones,” Somalia, Bosnia, Sierra Leone, East Timor, and Kosovo. The Iraq War (2003–11) was classified as a humanitarian intervention by some of its advocates, demonstrating how wide the embrace of the term had become.

Criticisms of humanitarian intervention

The doctrine of humanitarian intervention has been widely criticized. For many detractors, it represents a mode of liberal imperialism. Likewise, humanitarian intervention has been censured for coercively imposing Western ideas about rights onto other cultures. For others, humanitarianism is simply rhetorical cover either for the implementation of traditional geopolitical policies or for powerful economic interests. In particular, it is argued, the failure of the Western powers to intervene during the 1994 genocide in Rwanda, where there were no obvious economic or political interests at stake, demonstrated their hypocrisy. Indeed, Rwanda has become a lightning rod for the debate. For critics of interventionism, it proved that interventions were linked to self-interest. For advocates, Rwanda was a catastrophic failure and a spur for future action.

Legal and practical issues

Numerous contentious issues frame the debate. Some are theoretical, others practical. Probably the most intractable relate to the question of legitimacy (both legal and moral). Who is to judge an intervention legitimate, and on what grounds? Much of the legal debate stems from the tension between Article 51 of the UN Charter and the provisions of Article 24(1) and Chapter VII, which grant the Security Council powers to take whatever measures it regards as necessary to reestablish international peace and security. If an act is deemed to threaten peace and security, the UN can empower agents to rectify this, as occurred in the Bosnian conflict (1992–95). However, legal, and moral obligations have clashed. In Kosovo, the North Atlantic Treaty Organization (NATO) intervened without UN authorization, claiming that although such authorization was unlikely to be granted, there was nevertheless an overwhelming ethical imperative to act.

Aside from questions of legitimacy, there are other problems to be confronted. There is a

practical issue. Even if interventions were regarded universally as legitimate, there exists no consensus about whether they actually work, or whether they delay or even exacerbate the problems they seek to resolve. The question of motivation is also problematic. Is it ever really possible to act solely for humanitarian reasons? Moreover, should motivation matter? This all depends on what ethical system is employed. If it is simply a matter of consequences, as a utilitarian might argue, then an intervention conducted purely in the name of national self-interest that resulted in a “humanitarian” outcome (for example, the overthrow of a genocidal leader) could be classified as a humanitarian intervention. Likewise, an intervention conducted out of concern for human rights, if it failed in its primary goal, could not be classified as such. Such issues continue to drive the debate.

Evolution of the Humanitarian Intervention

1. **Early Roots and Colonialism:** Humanitarian intervention has historical roots dating back to colonial powers intervening in other regions under the pretext of protecting or civilizing indigenous populations. However, these interventions often served imperialistic interests rather than genuine humanitarian concerns.
2. **Post-World War II Period:** The concept of humanitarian intervention gained traction in the aftermath of World War II, particularly with the establishment of the United Nations and the adoption of the Universal Declaration of Human Rights. The UN Charter affirmed the principles of sovereign equality and non-interference in the internal affairs of states but also recognized the responsibility of the international community to protect human rights.
3. **Cold War Constraints:** During the Cold War, superpower rivalry and concerns about sovereignty limited the scope for humanitarian intervention. The principle of non-intervention became a cornerstone of international relations, with interventions often perceived as acts of aggression or imperialism.
4. **Shift Towards Humanitarian Intervention:** The end of the Cold War witnessed a shift towards a more permissive environment for humanitarian intervention. The United Nations Security Council authorized several interventions in the 1990s, including in Somalia, Bosnia, and Kosovo, in response to humanitarian crises and mass atrocities.
5. **R2P Doctrine:** The concept of the Responsibility to Protect (R2P) emerged as a framework for justifying and guiding humanitarian intervention. Adopted by the UN General Assembly in 2005, R2P asserts that states have a responsibility to protect their populations from genocide, war crimes, ethnic cleansing, and crimes against humanity. It also acknowledges the international community's responsibility to assist states in fulfilling this

obligation and to intervene when states fail to protect their populations.

6. **Controversies and Debates:** Humanitarian intervention remains controversial, with debates over its legality, legitimacy, and efficacy. Critics argue that interventions are often driven by geopolitical interests, lack clear mandates and exit strategies, and can exacerbate conflict and instability. Others raise concerns about the erosion of state sovereignty and the potential for abuse or misuse of intervention powers.

7. **Focus on Prevention and Capacity Building:** There is increasing emphasis on preventive measures and capacity-building efforts to address root causes of conflict and prevent the escalation of violence. This includes early warning mechanisms, mediation and conflict resolution, peacebuilding initiatives, and strengthening institutions to protect human rights and uphold the rule of law.

Several examples of humanitarian intervention

Humanitarian intervention has occurred in recent history, each with its own context, motivations, and outcomes. Some notable examples include:

1. **Kosovo Intervention (1999):** NATO's intervention in Kosovo, known as Operation Allied Force, was launched in response to the humanitarian crisis unfolding as a result of ethnic cleansing by Serbian forces against ethnic Albanians. The intervention aimed to halt the violence, protect civilians, and facilitate the return of refugees. Despite controversy over the legality of the intervention, it ultimately led to the withdrawal of Serbian forces and the establishment of international administration in Kosovo.

2. **East Timor Intervention (1999):** Following a referendum in which East Timorese voted for independence from Indonesia, pro-Indonesian militias carried out widespread violence and atrocities against civilians. In response, an international peacekeeping force, led by Australia and authorized by the United Nations, was deployed to East Timor to restore order, protect civilians, and facilitate the transition to independence.

3. **Libya Intervention (2011):** The NATO-led military intervention in Libya was launched in response to the government's violent crackdown on pro-democracy protests during the Arab Spring. The intervention aimed to protect civilians from atrocities and enforce a no-fly zone to prevent further violence. However, the intervention was controversial and resulted in significant civilian casualties and a protracted conflict with destabilizing consequences for the region.

4. **Syria Crisis (ongoing):** The Syrian civil war, which began in 2011, has resulted in widespread atrocities, including the use of chemical weapons, indiscriminate bombings, and

attacks on civilians by various parties to the conflict. While there have been calls for humanitarian intervention to protect civilians and alleviate suffering, interventions have been limited, with the international community facing challenges such as geopolitical rivalries, proxy conflicts, and the complexities of the conflict.

5. Yugoslav Wars (1990s): The wars that followed the breakup of Yugoslavia in the 1990s resulted in widespread human rights abuses, including ethnic cleansing and genocide. International interventions, including UN peacekeeping missions and NATO airstrikes, aimed to protect civilians, enforce ceasefires, and facilitate peace negotiations in Bosnia, Croatia, and Kosovo.

6. Somalia Intervention (1992-1995): The United Nations Operation in Somalia (UNOSOM) was established in 1992 to provide humanitarian assistance and restore order in Somalia, which was plagued by civil war, famine, and lawlessness. The intervention aimed to protect civilians, facilitate humanitarian aid delivery, and support the establishment of a stable government. However, the mission faced significant challenges, including armed opposition, factional fighting, and the infamous "Black Hawk Down" incident in 1993, resulting in the withdrawal of international forces by 1995.

7. Sierra Leone Intervention (1999-2000): In response to a brutal civil war characterized by widespread atrocities, including mutilations, massacres, and child soldiers, the United Nations Mission in Sierra Leone (UNAMSIL) was deployed to restore peace and stability. The intervention helped disarm rebel groups, protect civilians, and support the implementation of a peace agreement, contributing to the end of the conflict and the establishment of democratic governance.

8. Central African Republic (CAR) Intervention (2013-present): Following a coup and outbreak of sectarian violence in the CAR in 2013, the United Nations Multidimensional Integrated Stabilization Mission in the Central African Republic (MINUSCA) was deployed to protect civilians, support political transition, and facilitate reconciliation efforts. The intervention aims to address human rights abuses, disarm armed groups, and promote stability and development in the country.

9. Bosnia and Herzegovina Intervention (1992-1995): The United Nations Protection Force (UNPROFOR) was deployed to Bosnia and Herzegovina during the Yugoslav Wars to protect civilians and facilitate humanitarian aid delivery. Despite facing challenges and limitations, including a lack of clear mandate and coordination issues, the intervention helped mitigate some of the worst atrocities and contributed to peace negotiations that led to the

Dayton Accords in 1995.

10. Iraq Kurdistan Intervention (1991): In the aftermath of the Gulf War, a coalition of Western and regional forces established a safe zone and no-fly zone in northern Iraq to protect Kurdish populations from reprisals by Saddam Hussein's regime. The intervention provided sanctuary for Kurdish refugees, enabled the return of displaced persons, and contributed to the establishment of an autonomous Kurdish region within Iraq.

11. Rwanda Intervention (1994): The international community's response to the genocide in Rwanda, where an estimated 800,000 people were killed in just 100 days, was widely criticized for its failure to intervene effectively to stop the violence. Despite calls for action, the United Nations peacekeeping mission (UNAMIR) was unable to prevent the genocide due to a lack of political will, inadequate resources, and the failure of the international community to recognize and respond to the unfolding crisis.

12. Darfur Intervention (2003-present): The conflict in Darfur, Sudan, which began in 2003, has resulted in widespread atrocities, including mass killings, rape, and displacement of millions of people. While the international community has condemned the violence and called for action to protect civilians, humanitarian intervention has been limited, with challenges including political complexities, sovereignty concerns, and insufficient resources for peacekeeping and aid delivery.

13. South Sudan Intervention (2013-present): The United Nations Mission in South Sudan (UNMISS) was established in 2011 following South Sudan's independence to support peacebuilding and state-building efforts. However, the country descended into civil war in 2013, characterized by ethnic violence, displacement, and humanitarian crisis. UNMISS has played a role in protecting civilians, facilitating peace negotiations, and supporting efforts to address the root causes of the conflict.

14. Myanmar Rohingya Crisis (2017-present): The persecution of Rohingya Muslims in Myanmar has led to a massive humanitarian crisis, with hundreds of thousands of Rohingya fleeing to neighbouring Bangladesh to escape violence and persecution. While the international community has condemned the atrocities and called for accountability, humanitarian intervention has been limited, with challenges including sovereignty concerns, political complexities, and lack of access to affected areas.

15. Venezuela Crisis (ongoing): The political, economic, and humanitarian crisis in Venezuela has led to widespread suffering, including food and medicine shortages,

hyperinflation, and mass migration. While the international community has provided humanitarian aid and called for a peaceful resolution to the crisis, military intervention has been ruled out, with efforts focused on diplomatic solutions and support for democratic governance and human rights. Humanitarian intervention is a complex and contentious issue with significant importance, challenges, and criticisms.

Importance:

1. **Protection of Civilians:** Humanitarian intervention plays a crucial role in protecting civilians from widespread atrocities, including genocide, war crimes, ethnic cleansing, and crimes against humanity. It aims to alleviate human suffering, save lives, and uphold the principles of human rights and human dignity. In the case of the Kosovo intervention in 1999, NATO's Operation Allied Force aimed to protect ethnic Albanian civilians from widespread atrocities perpetrated by Serbian forces. The intervention helped to halt the violence and create conditions for the return of displaced populations.
2. **Promotion of International Norms:** Humanitarian intervention reinforces international norms and legal frameworks, such as the Responsibility to Protect (R2P), which assert the responsibility of states and the international community to prevent and halt mass atrocities. The Responsibility to Protect (R2P) principle was invoked in the intervention in Libya in 2011. The international community intervened to prevent widespread atrocities by the Gaddafi regime against civilians protesting for political reforms during the Arab Spring.
3. **Conflict Resolution and Peacebuilding:** In some cases, humanitarian intervention can contribute to conflict resolution, peacebuilding, and the restoration of stability by facilitating negotiations, disarmament, and reconciliation efforts. The intervention in Sierra Leone in 1999, led by the United Nations Mission in Sierra Leone (UNAMSIL), helped to end a brutal civil war marked by widespread atrocities, including mutilations and child soldiers. The intervention facilitated disarmament, peace negotiations, and the establishment of democratic governance.
4. **Prevention of Spillover Effects:** Addressing humanitarian crises through intervention can help prevent the spillover effects of conflict, such as refugee flows, regional instability, and transnational threats, which can have far-reaching consequences. The intervention in East Timor in 1999 prevented further violence and instability following a referendum for independence from Indonesia. International peacekeeping forces, including Australian troops, helped restore order, protect civilians, and facilitate the transition to independence.

Challenges

1. **Sovereignty and Non-Interference:** One of the primary challenges of humanitarian intervention is the tension between the principle of state sovereignty and the imperative to protect civilians. Intervening in the internal affairs of sovereign states raises questions of legality, legitimacy, and the potential for abuse or misuse of intervention powers. The intervention in Iraq in 2003, led by the United States and its allies, was controversial due to concerns about violating Iraq's sovereignty and the lack of authorization from the United Nations Security Council. The intervention led to protracted conflict and instability in the region.
2. **Geopolitical Considerations:** Humanitarian interventions are often influenced by geopolitical interests, power dynamics, and strategic calculations, which can complicate decision-making and undermine the impartiality and effectiveness of interventions. The ongoing conflict in Syria has been marked by geopolitical rivalries, with interventions by various external factors supporting different factions. The involvement of regional and global powers has complicated efforts to address the humanitarian crisis and find a political solution to the conflict.
3. **Complexity of Conflict Dynamics:** Humanitarian crises are often characterized by complex political, ethnic, religious, and socioeconomic dynamics, which can make it challenging to assess the root causes of conflict, identify appropriate interventions, and achieve sustainable solutions. The intervention in Somalia in the 1990s, led by the United Nations, faced challenges due to the complex clan politics, factional fighting, and humanitarian crisis in the country. The mission struggled to achieve its objectives amid ongoing violence and resistance from armed groups.
4. **Unintended Consequences:** Interventions can have unintended consequences, including civilian casualties, displacement, exacerbation of conflict, and unintended political, social, or economic consequences, which may outweigh the intended benefits of intervention. The intervention in Libya in 2011, while aimed at protecting civilians, resulted in unintended consequences, including the destabilization of the country, the rise of armed militias, and the spread of weapons across the region. Libya descended into a protracted conflict with devastating humanitarian consequences.
5. **Resource Constraints and Capacity Limitations:** Humanitarian interventions require significant resources, including military personnel, logistical support, funding, and expertise, which may be limited or insufficient to address the scale and complexity of humanitarian crises.

Criticism:

1. **Selective Intervention:** Critics argue that humanitarian intervention is often selective and driven by geopolitical interests, with powerful states intervening in some crises while ignoring others, undermining the credibility and legitimacy of intervention efforts. Critics argue that humanitarian intervention is often selective and influenced by geopolitical interests. The lack of intervention in conflicts such as the Rohingya crisis in Myanmar has been attributed to political calculations and strategic considerations, undermining the principle of equal protection for all civilians. The intervention in Kosovo in 1999 was criticized for bypassing the United Nations Security Council and violating Serbia's sovereignty. Critics argued that the intervention set a dangerous precedent for future interventions without international legal authorization.

2. **Violation of Sovereignty:** Some view humanitarian intervention as a violation of state sovereignty and an infringement on the principle of non-interference in the internal affairs of states, raising concerns about the erosion of international law and norms. The intervention in

Kosovo in 1999 was criticized for bypassing the United Nations Security Council and violating Serbia's sovereignty. Critics argued that the intervention set a dangerous precedent for future interventions without international legal authorization.

3. **Imperialism and Neocolonialism:** Humanitarian interventions are sometimes criticized as manifestations of imperialism or neocolonialism, with powerful states using intervention as a pretext to pursue their own interests, exploit resources, or assert dominance over weaker states. Some view humanitarian intervention as a form of imperialism or neocolonialism, with powerful states using intervention as a pretext to pursue their own interests. The intervention in Iraq in 2003 was seen by many as an example of Western interventionism driven by geopolitical ambitions rather than genuine humanitarian concerns.

4. **Failure to Address Root Causes:** Critics argue that humanitarian intervention often focuses on addressing immediate symptoms of conflict rather than addressing underlying root causes, such as poverty, inequality, governance failures, and historical grievances, which perpetuate cycles of violence and instability. Critics argue that humanitarian intervention often focuses on addressing immediate symptoms of conflict rather than addressing underlying root causes. The intervention in Afghanistan following the 9/11 attacks aimed to dismantle terrorist networks but failed to address systemic issues such as governance failures,

poverty, and corruption.

9

Right to Peace

Peace is not just the absence of conflict and violence, however: it is a way of living together so that all members of society can accomplish their human rights. Although not formally codified as a human right, peace is recognized as an essential element to the realization of human rights and belongs to the third generation of human rights or so-called solidarity rights. These are rights that affect whole societies or groups of people rather than just individuals, such as the right to a healthy environment, to sustainable development, to communication or to share in the common heritage of humankind. Peace is also a product of human rights: the more a society promotes, protects, and fulfils the human rights of its people, the greater its chances for curbing violence and resolving conflict peacefully. Thus, the peace is considered the greatest good in the world today and is the greatest need of the contemporary world. Recognizing the significance of peace in society, the international community had taken various initiatives for developing a binding legal framework for right to peace.

Concept of Right to Peace

The concept of 'Peace', like many other terms, is difficult to define. Generally, the term peace refers to an end to war, reconciliation, and the establishment of civil order. A peaceful society is considered as a society in which conflict is resolved through negotiation and compromise and where the rule of law is effective, thus providing the conditions for stability. Racial and cultural homogeneity is also seen as a prerequisite for a peaceful nation-state.

The origin of the word peace can be traced from an English word 'pees. The term pax (akin to Latin pacisci to agree) is the Latin feminine noun from which the English word "peace" is derived. The word has varied meanings the reaching of agreement between two parties; respect for others; quality of life; peaceful time; civil safety and security; etc. The Webster's dictionary defines peace as, "a state of tranquillity or quiet; freedom from civil disturbance; a state of security or order within a community provided for by law or custom; specifically, absence or cessation of war; a state of reconciliation after strife or enmity; etc."

President Kennedy was the first politician to introduce the right to peace and in doing so he defined peace as more than just the absence of war. John F Kennedy, in his address at

American University in 1963 stated that, ‘the kind of peace he was promoting was genuine peace, the kind of peace that makes life on earth worth living, the kind that enables men and nations to grow and to hope to build a better life for their children-not merely peace for Americans but for all men and women-not merely peace in our time but peace for all time’. Albert Einstein once said, peace is not merely the absence of war but the presence of justice, of law, of order- in short of government.

The concept of peace has been interpreted by many ways by different authors. Most importantly Johan Galtung, proposed a distinction between “positive” and “negative” peace. According to him “Positive” peace denotes the simultaneous presence of many desirable states of mind and society, such as harmony, justice, equity, and so on. Positive peace requires the absence of structural violence and emphasizes the promotion of human rights to ensure a comprehensive notion of social justice. The “Negative” peace denotes the “absence of war” and other forms of large-scale violent human conflict. Thus, the term negative peace can be defined as the absence of direct, organized, physical violence; efforts to promote negative peace include disarmament and peacekeeping initiatives. Therefore, peace can be found wherever direct violence is absent. According to Johan Galtung, peace is much more than just the absence of direct war and violence. He concludes his analysis by developing a new term positive peace and he states that “Positive peace is the best protection against violence”. Thus ‘peace’ in a society means when exploitation is minimized or eliminated and when there is neither direct violence nor structural violence. Many philosophical, religious, and cultural traditions have referred to peace in its positive sense. In Chinese, for example, the word heping denotes world peace, or peace among nations, while the words an and mingsi denote an “inner peace,” a tranquil and harmonious state of mind and being, akin to a meditative mental state. Other languages also frame peace in its “inner” and “outer” dimensions.

The right to peace as a human right includes both negative and positive peace. From an analysis of various literatures about peace, the word right to peace can be defined as a claim for a society which is devoid of physical violence, war, conflict, and injustices and where the notion of harmony and integration is fully a reality. Martin Luther King Jr., once said, “One day we must come to see that peace is not merely a distant goal we seek, but that it is a means by which we arrive at that goal. We must pursue peaceful ends through peaceful means.” However, living in a peaceful society is remaining as a distant dream.

The practice of discrimination based on racial, gender, economic and ecological injustices as

barriers to peace. The realization of right to peace means the reduction and elimination of violence, conflicts and all forms of discrimination and injustices. Hence, the right to peace can be achieved only if the social injustices are reduced or eliminated and cooperative group relations are pursued. Moreover, the realization of right to peace requires both the absence of violence as well as the positive features of peace including absence of discrimination, cooperation, brotherhood etc. It is generally stated that right to peace is a basic and essential right binding together the entire system of human rights and freedoms because the right to peace is the prerequisite of all other rights. The Supreme expression of the right to live is the right to live in the totally emancipated and genuinely free environment.

Elements of right to Peace

The Human Right to Peace is recognized as a Universal Right regardless of “race, decent, national, ethnic, social origin, colour, gender, sexual orientation, age, language, religion or belief, political or other opinion, economic status or heritage, diverse physical or mental functionality, civil status, birth or other consideration”. This right is considered as bundle of right which composed of various interrelated rights such as right: to Education on and for Peace and Human Rights; to Human Security to live in a Safe, Healthy Environment; to Development and to a Sustainable Environment; to Disobedience and Conscientious Objection; to Resist and Oppose Oppression; to Disarmament; to Freedom of Thought, Opinion, Expression, Conscience and Religion; to Refugee Status; and to Freedom of Movement. Among all these important component rights the most important are:

Right to human security: This right includes the right to have the material instruments, means and resources which enable him fully to enjoy a life worthy of human dignity and, to that end, the right to have essential food and drinking water, primary health care, basic clothing and housing and a basic education. It also includes the right to enjoy fair conditions of employment and trade union participation, and the right to the protection of the social services, on equal terms for persons having the same occupation or providing the same service.

Right to live in safe and healthy environment: The content of this right is that the human beings have the right to live in a private and public environment which is safe and healthy, and to receive protection against acts of unlawful violence, irrespective of whether they are perpetrated by state or non-state actors.

Needs for Right to Peace

The right to peace is very important as it transcends all other rights and enables their exercise;

and offers the innovation needed to lift society and allow it to achieve its full potential in an interconnected world. Moreover, without basic security of the person, and an opportunity to live in peaceful environment other human rights are illusions. In recent years the incidents of violence were very widespread all over the world and the nature of such violent conflicts has changed dramatically. The predominant form of violent conflict has evolved from national armies fighting each other (inter-state wars); to armies fighting for independence, separation or political control (intra-state or civil wars); to various forms of violence, involving non-state actors such as rebels, gangs and organized crime. These kinds of conflicts are not easily addressed with traditional instruments, such as diplomacy or military means. The drivers of violence often include a wide range of factors, including political, economic, social, and environmental issues. They can include socio-economic inequalities, injustice, joblessness, natural resources management, human rights abuse, political exclusion, and corruption. In many cases, it is difficult to define clear causes and the different factors are interrelated and might change over time.

Peace allows people to live a life full of dignity and purpose. If a country is in war torn, then the right to education is breached as young children are used as child soldiers; the right to food is violated as officers take food from civilians to feed their armies; and the right to be free from torture and unlawful imprisonment is infringed upon as states arrest people accused of working against the state. The right to peace guarantees that people will be able to pursue the rights necessary to live as they choose, thus fulfilling all the rights they are granted in the various human rights conventions and covenants. Peace allows countries the opportunity to pursue a democratic government and work towards development to make their lives and the lives for future generations better. Without peace there is no hope for the future. This is why the right of propels to peace should be a recognized right.

Right to Peace as Group Rights

The right to peace “concerns not only an individual’s right to live in peace, but the greater right of societies to enjoy a common peace.” An individual cannot claim it as a right because the realization of this right requires a group of people or in other words a society is the real holder of this right. The elevation of a human right to peace as a group right would have a profound significance in legal and political discourse. The elevation of right to peace as a group right further expands its reach; because third generation rights create duties that inhere in everyone, outcomes that limit liability for those who merely threaten or promote aggression would be avoided. If this right achieves the real status of group right, it will act as

a control mechanism for the use of military as well as domestic intervention by military powers. This will ensure the realization of sovereign equality. So, it is argued that the right to peace is constitutive of a truly universal international community.

Various ways to protect Right to peace

1. **Prevention of War and Conflict:** It emphasizes the importance of preventing armed conflicts and violence through peaceful means, such as diplomacy, dialogue, mediation, and conflict resolution mechanisms. This includes efforts to address root causes of conflict, such as poverty, inequality, discrimination, and grievances.
2. **Protection of Human Rights:** The right to peace entails the protection and promotion of human rights and fundamental freedoms for all individuals, regardless of race, ethnicity, religion, gender, or other characteristics. It emphasizes the importance of upholding principles such as non-discrimination, equality, and the rule of law to build peaceful and inclusive societies.
3. **Disarmament and Arms Control:** It advocates for disarmament, arms control, and non-proliferation measures to reduce the risk of armed conflict and promote international peace and security. This includes efforts to regulate the production, trade, and use of conventional weapons, as well as nuclear disarmament and prohibition of weapons of mass destruction.
4. **Promotion of Peaceful Coexistence:** The right to peace involves promoting peaceful coexistence, tolerance, and respect for diversity among individuals, communities, and nations. It emphasizes the importance of dialogue, cooperation, and mutual understanding to build trust and resolve conflicts peacefully.
5. **Sustainable Development:** It recognizes the interconnection between peace, development, and human rights, emphasizing the importance of sustainable development strategies that address socio-economic inequalities, promote social justice, and empower marginalized groups to reduce the risk of conflict and build resilience to violence.

The evolution of the concept of the "right to peace" reflects changing global dynamics, emerging threats to peace and security, and evolving understandings of human rights. While the idea of a specific right to peace is not explicitly enshrined in international law, it has evolved through various legal instruments, declarations, and initiatives aimed at promoting peace, preventing conflicts, and upholding human dignity. Here's an overview of its evolution:

1. **Post-World War II Period:** The aftermath of World War II saw the establishment of the United Nations and the adoption of the Universal Declaration of Human Rights in 1948,

which affirmed the inherent dignity and equal rights of all human beings. While the declaration did not explicitly mention a right to peace, its principles laid the foundation for subsequent developments in international human rights law.

2. Cold War Era: During the Cold War, tensions between the East and West and the threat of nuclear war underscored the importance of peace and disarmament. The United Nations played a central role in promoting peacekeeping, conflict resolution, and arms control efforts, contributing to the prevention of large-scale conflicts and the peaceful resolution of disputes.

3. Emergence of Peace Movements: The 1960s and 1970s witnessed the rise of global peace movements, driven by concerns about the Vietnam War, nuclear proliferation, and human rights abuses. These movements advocated for the recognition of peace as a fundamental human right and called for disarmament, diplomacy, and nonviolent conflict resolution.

4. United Nations Declarations: The United Nations has adopted several declarations and resolutions affirming the importance of peace as a fundamental human right. In 1984, the UN General Assembly adopted the Declaration on the Right of Peoples to Peace, which recognized the right of individuals and peoples to live in peace and called for international cooperation to promote peace and disarmament.

5. Recognition in International Law: While the right to peace is not codified as a standalone right in international law, it is recognized implicitly in various legal instruments and treaties, including those related to human rights, disarmament, and conflict prevention. For example, the International Covenant on Civil and Political Rights and the International Covenant on Economic, Social and Cultural Rights recognize the right to life, security, and freedom from fear as essential components of human dignity and well-being.

6. Contemporary Developments: In recent years, there has been renewed attention to the right to peace in response to ongoing conflicts, humanitarian crises, and global security challenges. Civil society organizations, human rights advocates, and peacebuilders continue to promote the concept of peace as a human right and advocate for its integration into international law and policy frameworks.

Other Efforts

1. Regional Initiatives: In addition to global efforts, regional organizations have also taken steps to promote the right to peace. For example, the African Union adopted the African Charter on Human and Peoples' Rights in 1981, which recognizes the right to peace

as a fundamental human right and calls for the promotion of peace, security, and stability on the continent.

2. **Civil Society Advocacy:** Civil society organizations and grassroots movements play a crucial role in advancing the right to peace agenda. Organizations such as Peace Brigades International, Amnesty International, and Human Rights Watch advocate for peace, disarmament, conflict resolution, and the protection of human rights in conflict-affected areas around the world.

3. **Educational Initiatives:** Education is recognized as a key tool for promoting a culture of peace and nonviolence. UNESCO's Global Action Programme on Education for Sustainable Development emphasizes the importance of integrating peace education into school curricula and promoting values such as tolerance, empathy, and respect for diversity to foster a culture of peace from an early age.

4. **International Days:** Several international days and observances highlight the importance of peace and nonviolence. The International Day of Peace, observed on September 21st each year, provides an opportunity for individuals, communities, and governments to promote peace through activities such as peacebuilding, dialogue, and mediation.

5. **Peacebuilding and Conflict Resolution:** The United Nations and other international organizations support peacebuilding and conflict resolution efforts in conflict-affected regions through initiatives such as peacekeeping missions, mediation, and reconciliation programs. These efforts aim to address the root causes of conflict, build trust between parties, and promote sustainable peace and stability.

6. **Gender Perspective:** The promotion of gender equality and the empowerment of women are integral to the realization of the right to peace. Women often play a critical role in peacebuilding, conflict prevention, and post-conflict reconstruction efforts, and their participation is essential for sustainable peace and inclusive development.

7. **Youth Engagement:** Young people are increasingly recognized as important agents of change in promoting peace and preventing violence. Youth-led organizations and initiatives, such as the United Network of Young Peacebuilders and the Youth, Peace, and Security agenda, advocate for youth participation in peace processes and the implementation of policies that address the needs and aspirations of young people in conflict-affected areas.

Challenges against Right to Peace

While the concept of the "right to peace" is widely embraced, there are significant challenges

to its realization. These challenges stem from various sources, including geopolitical dynamics, structural inequalities, and the complexities of conflict resolution. Here are some key challenges against the right to peace:

1. **Conflict of Interests:** One of the primary challenges is the clash of interests among states and other actors, which often prioritize their own strategic goals over peacebuilding efforts. Geopolitical rivalries, resource competition, and power struggles can hinder cooperation and undermine collective efforts to promote peace. The conflict in Syria exemplifies how competing interests among international and regional actors have hindered efforts to resolve the crisis and promote peace. Various stakeholders, including the Syrian government, opposition groups, and their respective allies, pursue conflicting objectives, leading to prolonged violence and instability.
2. **Armed Conflicts and Violence:** Ongoing armed conflicts and violence pose significant obstacles to the realization of the right to peace. Conflict dynamics, including political grievances, ethnic tensions, and competition for resources, perpetuate cycles of violence and make it difficult to achieve sustainable peace and stability. The conflict in Yemen demonstrates the devastating impact of armed violence on the right to peace. The ongoing civil war, fuelled by regional rivalries and external military support, has resulted in widespread civilian casualties, displacement, and humanitarian suffering, with no immediate prospects for a peaceful resolution.
3. **Weapons Proliferation and Militarization:** The proliferation of weapons, including conventional arms and weapons of mass destruction, fuels conflict and exacerbates insecurity. Militarization, arms races, and the spread of illicit arms undermine peacebuilding efforts and divert resources away from development and humanitarian needs. The proliferation of arms in conflict-affected regions, such as the Democratic Republic of Congo (DRC), exacerbates insecurity and undermines peacebuilding efforts. Armed groups and militias in the DRC have easy access to weapons, perpetuating cycles of violence and impeding efforts to achieve lasting peace.
4. **Human Rights Violations:** Widespread human rights violations, including arbitrary detention, torture, extrajudicial killings, and violations of freedom of expression and assembly, undermine the foundations of peace and security. Authoritarian regimes and repressive measures suppress dissent and stifle efforts to promote peace and reconciliation. The crackdown on pro-democracy protests in Belarus highlights the challenge of human rights violations undermining peace and stability. The government's use of violence, arbitrary

arrests, and repression of dissent have fuelled social unrest and eroded trust in institutions, exacerbating tensions and hindering prospects for peaceful resolution of the crisis.

5. **Inequality and Marginalization:** Structural inequalities, including economic disparities, social exclusion, and discrimination based on ethnicity, race, religion, gender, or other factors, contribute to social tensions and conflict. Addressing root causes of inequality and marginalization is essential for building inclusive societies and fostering lasting peace. The Israeli-Palestinian conflict underscores the role of structural inequalities and marginalization in perpetuating conflict and hindering the realization of peace. The ongoing occupation, discriminatory policies, and unequal access to resources exacerbate grievances and fuel resentment, undermining efforts to achieve a just and lasting peace.

6. **Climate Change and Environmental Degradation:** Environmental factors, such as climate change, resource scarcity, and environmental degradation, are increasingly recognized as drivers of conflict and displacement. Competition over water, land, and natural resources can exacerbate existing tensions and contribute to conflict escalation. The conflict in Darfur, Sudan, has been exacerbated by environmental factors, including climate change and desertification. Competition over scarce resources, such as water and land, has fuelled ethnic tensions and conflict between pastoralists and farmers, leading to widespread violence and displacement.

7. **Lack of Political Will and Leadership:** Despite international commitments to peace and security, there is often a lack of political will and leadership to address conflicts and invest in preventive measures. Short-term interests, electoral politics, and competing priorities can impede sustained efforts to promote peace and reconciliation. The lack of political will and leadership to address the Rohingya crisis in Myanmar has perpetuated violence and undermined efforts to promote peace and reconciliation. Despite international condemnation and calls for accountability, the Myanmar government has failed to address the root causes of the conflict, including discrimination and persecution of the Rohingya minority.

8. **Fragmentation of International Norms and Institutions:** The fragmentation of international norms, institutions, and mechanisms for conflict resolution and peacebuilding undermines collective responses to global security challenges. Disagreements over principles, approaches, and priorities hinder cooperation and coordination in addressing conflicts. The inability of the United Nations Security Council to agree on a unified response to conflicts, such as the crisis in Syria, illustrates the fragmentation of international norms and institutions

for conflict resolution. Competing interests among major powers have led to deadlock and inaction, prolonging suffering, and impeding efforts to restore peace and stability.

Conclusion

Today millions of people are starving or dying from curable diseases and too many are highly exploited. True peace is not possible in the face of massive poverty, hunger, discrimination, inequality, exclusion, and intolerance. Thus, to realize the right to peace there is a need for cooperation and holistic implementation by states and non-state actors, including individuals, groups within civil society, NGOs, TNCs, and international organizations that recognize duties and responsibilities in this regard.

10

Women Peace and Security (WPS)

Increasing the full, equal, and meaningful participation of women in peacemaking, conflict prevention and peacebuilding efforts is a key priority for the United Nations Department of Political and Peacebuilding Affairs (DPPA). Women, Peace, and Security (WPS) first made it on to the Security Council's agenda in 2000, with the adoption of Security Council Resolution 1325 on WPS. However, despite many global and regional commitments and initiatives, the number of women included in formal peacemaking processes remains low; and many peace agreements do not include gender provisions that sufficiently address women's security and peacebuilding needs.

In line with the Secretary-General's forward-looking goals for the decade (S/2019/800, para 120) and his directives on women, peace and security (S/2020/946, para 113), DPPA is supporting multi-track efforts that increase the involvement of women at all levels, integrate gender equality, and shape strategies based on the priorities of women's rights constituencies. This includes working with Special Envoys and Special Representatives of the Secretary-General to design and support strategies for inclusive peace processes. From Colombia to Syria, the Department is also using new pathways for participation through digital inclusion strategies and virtual consultations and engagements.

In DPPA's special political missions (SPMs) in the field, Gender Advisers or Gender Focal Points provide advice and support to the mission's leadership - the Secretary-General's Special Envoys and Special Representatives - on ways to promote women's political participation, make peace processes and prevention efforts more inclusive, and include gender perspectives in the UN's political work.

In contexts where the UN is supporting a peace process, DPPA and its SPMs work to promote women's direct participation through advocacy and by providing advice on inclusive mediation strategies. We also organize consultations with civil society and women's groups and provide advice on effective ways to include women and their views in the process. Furthermore, the Department promotes women's political participation in elections, for example through advice on Temporary Special Measures, including electoral quotas, during electoral support. To assist mediation actors and Member States in their efforts to make peace processes more inclusive and gender-responsive, DPPA (then DPA) developed two Guidance documents for mediators and mediation experts; one on Addressing Conflict-Related Sexual Violence in Ceasefire and Peace Agreements (2012); and one on Gender and Inclusive Mediation Strategies (2017).

In 2016, the Department established a stand-alone Gender, Peace and Security Unit (GPS), which oversees its implementation of the WPS agenda. GPS has the responsibility to develop policy, build the capacity of DPPA staff involved in peacemaking and support DPPA's mission and headquarters staff in implementing Security Council resolutions on WPS and Conflict- Related Sexual Violence. DPPA's WPS Policy was first issued in June 2019, to ensure that gender relevant issues and perspectives are integrated into all the Department's activities. The Policy outlines five priorities for the implementation of the WPS agenda: a) Gender sensitive political and conflict analysis; b) Promoting inclusion and women's meaningful participation in all peacemaking and peacebuilding efforts; c) Women's participation in electoral and political processes; d) Preventing and addressing conflict-related sexual violence as a priority for peace; and e) Programmatic – ensuring gender mainstreaming in all projects through resource allocations, gender markers and tracking. Following a review, in 2023, GPS issued a revised DPPA WPS Policy (2023). The new Policy maintains the same priority areas, but with updates to reflect key developments and new areas of work, including digital technology and climate, peace, and security. The Department continues to develop policy on the intersection of WPS and other relevant issues, such as Youth, Peace, and Security, and to consider the gendered implications of evolving technologies and the risks of hate speech and mis- and disinformation.

The Department's approach to implementing the WPS agenda is to ensure that gender is mainstreamed throughout DPPA's work – beyond the specific focus on WPS and WPS initiatives – and that WPS work is not only the responsibility of gender advisers, but the responsibility of all leadership, managers and every staff member in DPPA and its field

presences.

Security Council Resolutions

Security Council resolution 1325 (2000) on WPS was backed by a diverse and geographically- representative coalition of Member States, and pushed by a strong global constituency of women civil society organizations. This was the first Security Council resolution to link women to the peace and security agenda, looking at the impact of conflict on women and women's contribution to conflict resolution and sustainable peace.

The resolution consists of four pillars: 1) The role of women in conflict prevention, 2) women's participation in peacebuilding, 3) the protection of the rights of women and girls during and after conflict, and 4) women's specific needs during repatriation, resettlement and for rehabilitation, reintegration, and post-conflict reconstruction.

Why Is Gender and Women Included in the UN Peace and Security Agenda?

There is no internationally agreed definition of the term 'gender', however, gender is understood to be a social and cultural construct that assigns different roles, behaviours, norms and traits to men and women in a society. As a social construct, gender varies from society to society and can evolve over time. In most societies, gender is hierarchical and produces political, social, and economic inequalities. When gender intersects with other forms of discrimination such as socioeconomic status, ethnicity, religion, disability, age, geographic location, sexual orientation and gender identity, the impacts can compound and lead to intersectional marginalization and discrimination. Because conflict affects people of different gender identities differently, an intersectional approach to peacemaking is needed to respond to different groups' security and peacebuilding needs.

Men who predominantly occupy roles in both armed groups and public decision-making, have long been considered the only relevant actors in conflict and its resolution. However, women have always been involved in conflict in different roles, be it as peacemakers, combatants, dependents, politicians, or activists, and are greatly – often disproportionately – affected by conflict. Women have a fundamental human right to participate in decision making processes that affect them, but women's inclusion in peace processes is also a strategic imperative, as adding a broader range of perspectives can lead to more sustainable peace. For these reasons, and to answer to its responsibilities stemming from the human rights agenda, the United Nations is strongly committed to include women in its peace and security work.

11

The Youth, Peace, and Security Agenda

Since 2015, young people's essential role in peace and security has been increasingly recognized and documented. Following several years of advocacy by over 11,000 young people from over 110 countries, the United Nations Security Council unanimously adopted a historic resolution, UN Security Council Resolution 2250 on Youth, The Youth, Peace, and Security Agenda Peace and Security (2015), recognizing young peoples' positive role in international peace and security. This landmark resolution identifies five key pillars for action: participation, protection, prevention, partnerships, and disengagement and reintegration. It urges Member States to give young people a greater voice in decision-making at the local, national, regional, and international levels and to consider setting up mechanisms that would enable young people to participate meaningfully in peace processes.

Youth, Peace, and Security at the Peacebuilding Support Office

DPPA, through the Peacebuilding Support Office (PBSO), together with UNFPA and the Secretary-General's Youth Envoy, have been instrumental in the development of the Youth, Peace, and Security (YPS) agenda and the main entities at the United Nations working toward this agenda. PBSO with UNFPA co-leads the UN YPS Secretariat that provides backstopping support to the UN focal points system on YPS. The work of the joint secretariat focuses on

1. Increase the awareness of key stakeholders of the YPS agenda through enhanced advocacy.
2. Strengthen the capacities of key stakeholders to implement YPS.

Youth, Peace, and Security (YPS) is an imperative agenda within the sphere of international peace and security, highlighting the pivotal role of young people in conflict prevention, resolution, and peacebuilding endeavours. Emerging in acknowledgment of the demographic significance of the global youth population, particularly in conflict-affected regions, the YPS framework underscores the agency and potential of young individuals as transformative agents within their communities and beyond. By recognizing the multifaceted contributions of youth to peace processes, ranging from advocacy and activism to innovative approaches fostering reconciliation and social cohesion, the YPS agenda addresses the specific challenges faced by young people in conflict contexts, including susceptibility to recruitment, displacement, marginalization, and limited access to education and economic opportunities. Amplifying the voices of young people and ensuring their meaningful participation in decision-making processes related to peace and security are central tenets of the YPS agenda.

By harnessing the agency and resilience of youth, the YPS framework seeks to unleash their potential as drivers of sustainable peace and development on a global scale.

12

UN Entities in Peacebuilding

Ref: Entities In Peace Work: Innovative Practices and Instructive Examples At the sharp end of peacekeeping in Long Walk of Peace: towards a culture of Prevention <https://unesdoc.unesco.org/ark:/48223/pf0000262885>

UN peacekeeping, a pivotal peace and security tool, has evolved over time in line with the mandates provided by the UN Security Council in response to evolving peace and security challenges across the world. During past decades, peacekeepers popularly known as ‘Blue Helmets’ have experienced successful outcomes as well as disappointments. Currently, 15 UN peacekeeping missions are deployed in different parts of the world, overseen, and supported by the DPKO-DFS. The following examples, drawn from five current peacekeeping operations, illustrate some of their expanding activities and challenges.

The UN Mission in Liberia (UNMIL) has disarmed more than 100,000 combatants and provided support for two presidential elections, with presidential and legislative elections that took place in October 2017. UNMIL is now helping to build national security institutions, having handed over responsibility for security to Liberian national forces in June 2016. Considering the largely successful implementation of its mandate, the mission has begun to draw down in preparation for a full exit in 2018. The UN Multidimensional Integrated Stabilization Mission in the Central African Republic (MINUSCA) halted a potential genocide amid severe challenges and created space for peaceful and credible elections. Under its multidimensional mandate, the UN Stabilization Mission in the Democratic Republic of the Congo (MONUSCO) has been engaged proactively in providing support for the political process, protecting civilians, and neutralizing armed groups in support of the national armed forces, as well as undertaking stabilization tasks.

The UN Mission in the Republic of South Sudan (UNMISS) has stepped up measures to protect civilians through engagement, deterrence, and the facilitation of humanitarian assistance for some 2 million civilians displaced by widespread and systematic violence since 2013. Notably, the mission is providing physical protection to over 200,000 civilians

sheltered in its six Protection of Civilians sites (PoC).

The United Nations Multidimensional Integrated Stabilization Mission in Mali (MINUSMA) has played a key role in supporting the implementation of the peace agreement, including through support for the establishment of interim authorities in the five northern regions and support for the launch of the first mixed patrols in Gao.

Over the years, UN peacekeeping has made efforts to improve and adapt its approaches and practices to current challenges and contexts. For example, considerable efforts have been invested in improving approaches for the protection of civilians, community engagement, support for the extension of state authority, human rights monitoring and so forth. Initiatives are also underway to enhance the performance of uniformed components in partnership with troop-contributing countries. Meanwhile, the management of missions has provided opportunities to foster sustainable environmental practices by limiting the negative environmental impact of missions.

Early warning: identifying the root causes of conflict.

With growing competition over natural and other resources essential to an adequate standard of living, denial of economic and social rights is increasingly becoming a cause and predictor of violence, social unrest, and conflict. In keeping with the UN's renewed focus on conflict prevention, the Office of the High Commissioner for Human Rights explored this issue in a thematic report on early warning and economic, social, and cultural rights for the 2016 session of the Economic and Social Council. The report pointed out that violations stemmed from factors such as unequal power distribution, discrimination, and inequality (OHCHR, 2016).

Future opportunities for OHCHR to promote peace lie in continued and strengthened efforts to implement and support the effective implementation of all human rights. The Declaration on the Right to Development addresses the root causes of poverty, inequality and conflict, systemic issues, and structural challenges, in its quest to build a world order in which all rights and freedoms can be realized for all people everywhere, as envisioned in the Universal Declaration (UN, 1986).

It calls for an enabling environment for realizing peace, human rights, and development, as well as disarmament and the use of released resources for comprehensive development. Grounded in the human rights framework, the 2030 Agenda and Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs) provide new momentum to promote peace through human rights and development, with the aim of leaving no one behind. SDG 16, which aims to 'Promote

peaceful and inclusive societies for sustainable development, provide access to justice for all and build effective, accountable, and inclusive institutions at all levels’, alongside the other SDGs, offers renewed potential to achieve the purposes and principles of the UN Charter, through a human rights framework, environmental protection and strengthened international cooperation.

Human rights must be integral both to ‘sustaining peace’ and sustainable development. They play a pivotal role in preventing conflict and violent extremism and are included in the UN Secretary-General’s ‘integrated way of thinking and acting’ to consolidate the UN’s capacities to meet the ‘prevention challenge’. The Office of the High Commissioner for Human Rights will build on the Human Rights Up Front Initiative to reinforce the accountability and effectiveness of the UN. This initiative aims ‘to strengthen the UN system’s ability to effectively prevent and respond to serious human rights violations and complex crises’ and inter alia involves human rights education, including mandatory courses for all UN staff. Human rights-based implementation of the SDGs with the right to development at the core will enhance efforts to sustain peace. Effective, integrated and coordinated implementation of the economic, social, human rights and environmental components of sustainable development alongside the pursuit of progress, peace and security will serve to nurture lasting peace for all humanity.

Increased women’s participation as uniformed personnel in peacekeeping

Despite the ambitions of the WPS agenda, women still only account for around 3 per cent of UN military peacekeepers deployed around the world. However, their participation has been recognized as a critical component of mission success, leading to greater credibility for peacekeeping forces and a lower incidence of sexual exploitation and abuse in those settings. Women and children are often the main victims of violence in conflicts, particularly sexual violence, and it is often difficult for male soldiers to cross social and cultural boundaries and build their trust. Evidence has shown that women peacekeepers are more likely to provide victims with a sense of security, obtain their trust, and in the process gather the information needed to obtain justice. Women are also distinguishing themselves in leadership roles in UN peacekeeping. Sgt. Felicite Mujawamariya, a Rwandan peacekeeper serving with UNAMID, was awarded a UN medal of excellence in 2015 for her exceptional performance in implementing reform and restructuring as a UN Team Site Commander.

To incentivize troop-contributing countries to deploy more women, UN Women runs training courses for female military officers and supports the DPKO in training military peacekeepers

to prevent and respond to conflict-related sexual violence. UNITAR, the training arm of the UN, also delivers pre-deployment training to female and male peacekeepers. For example, several hundred Rwandan women have received training from UNITAR in collaboration with the African Contingency Operations Training and Assistance (ACOTA) Programme at the Rwanda Military Academy in Gako. In May 2016, Platoon Commander Marie Gorrette Ingabire became the first female staff officer to participate in pre-deployment training before leading her platoon in the UNAMID AU/UN Hybrid Mission in Darfur, Sudan. UNAMID is the UN mission with the largest number of women peacekeepers, while Rwanda contributes the largest number of female peacekeepers. With more than 5,136 uniformed peacekeepers and 520 police currently serving, Rwanda is Africa's second largest contributor to UN and African Union peace operations, and the fifth largest contributor globally.

Reframing the youth and conflict question

The more common approaches to 'Youth, Peace and Security' have been dominated by theories that focus on young people – especially young men – as potential perpetrators of violence. At a time when humanitarian crises and disasters are becoming increasingly salient in the contemporary health and development landscape, and in the context of rapid demographic transitions brought about by the largest ever generation of young people in history, the UN Population Fund (UNFPA) and the Peacebuilding Support Office are coordinating a Progress Study on Youth Peace and Security, mandated by UN Security Council Resolution 2250, that will recommend ways to end the marginalization and political exclusion of youth and foster their participation in sustaining peace. Many other UN entities such as UNDP, UNESCO, and UN Volunteers (UNV) have been collaborating with UNFPA in this pursuit.

Facilitating political crisis resolution

The Department of Public Affairs (DPA) mediation work is conducted out of public view, but often plays a decisive part in the peaceful resolution of political crises. For example, in late 2013, Burkina Faso's ruling party tried to abolish constitutional term limits to enable President Blaise Compaore to run for another term of office, a move that stirred tensions within the country. Early in 2014, the DPA's regional office in West Africa and the Sahel (UNOWAS) deployed a joint UN-ECOWAS early-warning mission and worked at leadership level to try to persuade President Compaore to abandon his efforts to change the constitution. By the end of

October 2014, mass demonstrations had triggered Compaore's precipitous departure from

office. When Compaore fled the country, the Special Representative of the Secretary-General, Mohammed Ibn Chambas, the head of UNOWAS, led a joint UNOWA-ECOWAS-African Union mission to engage with national and international stakeholders and facilitate a peaceful solution. Intensive consultations led to a new Constitutional Charter and the appointment of transitional authorities in the capital Ouagadougou until fresh elections could be held. However, a year later, in September 2015, a month before the country was due to go to the polls, the former presidential guard mounted a coup d'état.

In the wake of the coup attempt, ECOWAS and SRSGB Chambas strove to secure the release of the transitional president and ministers, restore the transitional authorities, and obtain the coup leaders' surrender. Mission officials repeatedly condemned the coup, worked with other partners for the transitional government's return, and called for an end to the violence and the protection of the civilian population. This was achieved within a few days by working together with regional leaders and intervening with the coup leaders. The coup leaders surrendered power and on 29 November, Burkina Faso held post-transition elections and voted in a new democratically elected administration.

Factors that contributed to the success of the UN's preventive engagement in Burkina Faso include the presence of a dedicated regional political office with a highly respected and connected leadership, timely and extended deployment, unrelenting effort from the UNOWA leadership and its staff, engagement with all actors and the perceptible neutrality of the UN's involvement, and highly effective partnership with key regional organizations and the broader diplomatic community.

Eradicating illicit small arms and light weapons

Put simply, where weapons are available, violent conflict is more likely to occur. The Programme of Action to Prevent, Combat and Eradicate the Illicit Trade in Small Arms and Light Weapons in All Its Aspects (PoA) and its International Tracing Instrument (ITI), adopted by consensus by the UN General Assembly, are central to international efforts to combat illicit weapons, one of the explicitly peace-related targets of Sustainable Development Goal 16 on 'peaceful and inclusive societies'.

The Office for Disarmament Affairs (ODA) has assisted the PoA/ITI process through the provision of substantive support to global meetings, capacity-building for governments, awareness-raising and advocacy. Constant monitoring of data on SDG indicators will be critical to ensure the SDGs are met. The ODA will be centrally involved in efforts to gather

data, for SDG Target 16.4, most notably through the work of its regional centres in Africa, Asia and the Pacific, and Latin America and the Caribbean. To the same end, the ODA has provided legal, policy and technical assistance to Member States of the Central African sub-region on drafting the ‘Kinshasa Convention’, the Central African Convention for the Control of Small Arms and Light Weapons, their Ammunition and all Parts and Components that can be used for their Manufacture, Repair and Assembly, which entered into force in March 2017. The Convention was signed by 11 Central African states and aims to prevent and eradicate the illicit trade in small arms and reduce the human suffering they cause in the sub-region and Africa as a whole.

The Kinshasa Convention and other sub-regional small-arms instruments such as the Nairobi Protocol and the Southern African Development Community (SADC) and Economic Community of West African States (ECOWAS) Conventions create a mutually reinforcing African disarmament and arms control network that provides a framework for achieving the African Union’s ‘Silencing the Guns by 2020’ objective, as well as the SDGs. The United Nations Regional Office for Central Africa (UNOCA) of the Department of Political Affairs (DPA) acts as the Secretariat of the United Nations Standing Advisory Committee for Security Questions in Central Africa (UNSAC), which negotiated the terms of the Convention.

The UN Institute of Disarmament Research (UNIDIR) has actively worked on the topic of illicit small arms and light weapons for over 25 years, supporting negotiations, producing policy-relevant studies and developing tools. UNIDIR’s current small arms and light weapons work focuses on weapons and ammunition management in fragile settings, addressing the illicit global arms trade, and providing support for the implementation of global instruments and guidelines on small arms and light weapons. These activities are carried out through the development of targeted tools (e.g. an arms and ammunition management software tool to assist practitioners in conducting storage assessments at the field level), capacity-building and the design of improved processes and better methods of stakeholder cooperation and collaboration (e.g. supporting the Government of Somalia to establish systems for import, storage, marking and recordkeeping, and the distribution of small arms in line with the relevant UN Security Council resolutions).

Coordinating counter-terrorism efforts

To draw the different strands of the UN together to tackle terrorism in a coherent manner, the Counter-Terrorism Implementation Task Force (CTITF) has developed an ‘All-of-UN’

coordination framework, which functions through twelve CTITF Inter-Agency Working Groups on priority areas of the Global Counter-Terrorism Strategy (GCTS). These include foreign terrorist fighters (FTF), preventing violent extremism (PVE), human rights, gender and strategic communications. CTITF is also strengthening the delivery of UN capacity-building support to Member States and regional organizations tailored to the needs and priorities of each country. This is achieved through a strategic ‘All-of-UN’ Integrated Assistance for Counter-Terrorism (I-ACT) tool, currently being implemented in Burkina Faso, Nigeria, Mali and the G5-Sahel countries. At the request of the UN Security Council, comprehensive UN system-wide capacity-building efforts involving more than 200 tools are being implemented by 17 UN entities, with over 140 PVE projects implemented by 13 UN entities around the world.

The UN Counter-Terrorism Centre (UNCCT) also delivers capacity-building support through an ‘All-of-UN’ approach at national, regional and global levels across all four pillars of the UN Global Counter-Terrorism Strategy. In response to the growing need for impact-driven capacity-building for Member States, the Centre developed a five-year programme, which was endorsed by its Advisory Board in 2015, that ensures strategic guidance for the Centre’s work in 2016–2020. The programme outlines four key outcomes in line with the four pillars of the Global Strategy covering areas such as border security and management, countering the financing of terrorism, strategic PVE communications, addressing the foreign terrorist fighter threat, and ensuring respect for human rights when countering terrorism.

Preventing violent extremism through Education (PVE-E)

Violent extremism knows no boundaries and affects every society. However, young people are most at risk as the victims of extremist violence and the main targets of recruitment strategies. The United Nations Plan of Action to Prevent Violent Extremism (A/70/674) expands on the first Pillar of the United Nations Global Counter-Terrorism Strategy (A/RES/60/288), which addresses conditions conducive to the spread of terrorism. The PVE Plan of Action provides over seventy strategic recommendations to Member States and the UN to address the drivers of violent extremism. In Resolution 70/291, adopted on 1 July 2016, the UN General Assembly recommends that ‘Member States consider the implementation of relevant recommendations of the Plan of Action, as applicable to the national context’, and invited ‘Member States and regional and sub-regional organizations to consider developing national and regional plans of action to prevent violent extremism as and when conducive to terrorism, in accordance with their priorities and taking into account, as

appropriate, the Secretary-General's Plan of Action.'

A growing number of Member States and regional and sub-regional organizations are now developing national and regional PVE plans to address the drivers of violent extremism, drawing on the United Nations PVE Plan of Action, and are requesting the United Nations to support them in their efforts. A High Level PVE Action Group, chaired by the UN Secretary-General and consisting of the Heads of 21 UN Agencies, Funds and Programmes is spearheading UN efforts to support Member States in implementing the PVE Plan of Action, at their request.

The Office of Counter-Terrorism acts as Secretariat to the UN Secretary-General's High Level PVE Action Group. It works through a dedicated CTITF Inter-Agency Working Group on Preventing Violent Extremism to coordinate the 'All-of-UN' approach to preventing violent extremism across the seven priority areas of the PVE Plan of Action. These UN efforts already encompass 223 projects and initiatives by 14 United Nations entities around the world. UNESCO is at the forefront of UN system-wide efforts to prevent violent extremism through education, as stated in the UN Secretary-General's Plan of Action to Prevent Violent Extremism and Security Council Resolution 2354 (UN, 2017f) on Countering terrorist Narratives. This work is conducted through UNESCO's Global Citizenship Education (GCED) programme, which aims to empower learners to face and resolve global challenges and contribute to a more peaceful, tolerant, inclusive, and secure world.

It also complements other key UNESCO actions to promote intercultural understanding, such as the protection and transmission of cultural heritage and inclusive education on information and communication technologies (ICTs), with a specific focus on young people. To this end, UNESCO co-organized the conference 'Internet and the Radicalization of Youth: Preventing, Acting and Living Together' with the Government of Quebec in 2016. The result of this conference was the Call of Quebec, which encourages all governments to elaborate national policies or action plans dedicated to preventing radicalization leading to violence. UNESCO also published A Teacher's Guide on the Prevention of Violent Extremism in 2016 and Terrorism and the Media – A Handbook for Journalists in 2017, which take a holistic approach to fighting violent extremism. UNESCO's activities to prevent violent extremism through education (PVE-E) focus on awareness-raising and advocacy, the development of guidance, capacity-building for educators and policy-makers, and partnerships and projects. Senior policy-makers were among 200 participants who met to discuss educational

interventions and approaches to PVE-E at the first International Conference on the Prevention of Violent Extremism through Education: ‘Taking Action’, co-organized by UNESCO and the UNESCO Mahatma Gandhi Institute of Education for Peace and Sustainable Development

(MGIEP) and held in New Delhi in September 2016. In cooperation with the Asia-Pacific Centre of Education for International Understanding (APCEIU), UNESCO has been expanding its Clearing House on GCED with the addition of resources on PVE-E. It has also developed two key normative tools to assist Member States – a guide on managing classroom discussions on PVE and radicalization for the upper primary/lower secondary level, and a guide to help policy-makers prioritize, plan, and implement PVE-E actions.

In 2016, UNESCO conducted capacity-building for educators in Albania, Central Asia and West Africa. A seminar also took place in February 2017 in Addis Ababa, Ethiopia, organized by the UNESCO International Institute for Capacity Building in Africa (UNESCO-IICBA), UNESCO Headquarters and the UNESCO Asia-Pacific Centre for International Understanding (APCEIU), which brought together 40 representatives from Djibouti, Ethiopia, Kenya, Nigeria, Somalia, South Sudan, Uganda and Tanzania. National capacity-building workshops on PVE-E for West and East Africa are under discussion as a follow-up to sub-regional workshops. UNESCO Field Offices and Institutes are also involved in PVE-E. The Office in Dakar is supporting the UNCCT-led Integrated Assistance for Counter Terrorism (I-ACT) capacity-building initiative for the G5 Sahel Region.

The UNESCO Office in Venice is supporting teacher capacity-building and curriculum review in Albania to promote intercultural and interreligious understanding as a contribution to PVE. A second phase of capacity-building is currently ongoing in partnership with Albania’s Ministry of Education, Sports and Youth. The UNESCO Office in Almaty is cooperating with the Organization for Security and Cooperation in Europe (OSCE) in Tajikistan and contributed to PVE-E capacity-building in July 2017. UNESCO’s Office in Rabat is supporting a ‘Schools as actors of PVE’ programme in Morocco and Global Citizenship Education and PVE through literacy and non-formal education in Mauritania. The UNESCO Office in Beirut has developed an agreement with the Ministry of Education in Lebanon and the Lebanese University to mainstream GCED and PVE into national teacher preparation programmes. It is also collaborating with a consortium of Arab State universities to develop a Massive Open Online Course (MOOC) on intercultural dialogue competences.

The UNESCO International Bureau of Education in Switzerland launched a project entitled

‘Addressing Intolerance and Extremism through Universal Values in Curricula’ to guide curricular reform. In partnership with the Centre for the Prevention of Radicalization Leading to Violence (CPRLV) in Montreal, Canada, the UNESCO Mahatma Gandhi Institute of Education for Peace, and Sustainable Development (MGIEP) held a global PVE event in September 2017 with around 15 countries to test PVE training modules on critical inquiry, empathy, and compassion. UNESCO is currently conducting a study on pedagogical measures and approaches in PVE.

Scientific cooperation for peace

UNESCO has done much to promote international cooperation in the field of science. During the Cold War, it was one of the few places in the world where scientists from both sides of the Iron Curtain could come together to discuss and share their knowledge. Today, UNESCO works with scientists who are tackling challenges such as climate change and natural resource management. For example, a project to improve scientific knowledge and management of Lake Chad and its ecosystems, organized in cooperation with the Lake Chad Basin Commission and other partners, is helping to promote sustainable development and build a culture of peace. Another example is the SESAME (Synchrotron-light for Experimental Science and Applications in the Middle East) Laboratory, which opened in Jordan in 2017, largely thanks to the determination of scientists to overcome the region’s political tensions and work together.

Culture and Heritage for peace

The idea that cultural and natural heritage in all their diversity belong to all of humanity is a powerful message, and one that UNESCO promotes to foster mutual understanding and peace. The first large-scale campaign for cultural heritage, the Nubia campaign to safeguard the Abu Simbel temples following the construction of the Aswan Dam, was launched in the same area where the very first UN Blue Helmets intervened, a few years earlier, following the Suez crisis. Protecting cultural heritage has become an increasingly important challenge as symbolically and historically important sites are often targeted during conflicts, including most recently in Afghanistan, Iraq, Mali and Syria. In this context, UNESCO leads the implementation of UN Security Council Resolution 2347 (2017) on protecting cultural heritage for the maintenance of peace and international security, and fights against the illicit traffic of cultural property as a source of financing for terrorist groups, thereby spearheading implementation of UN Security Council Resolution 2199 (2015).

Through activities such as its #Unite4Heritage campaign, UNESCO works to mobilize both

governments and civil society for the protection of shared heritage. Multinational nominations to the World Heritage List and the Representative List of the Intangible Cultural Heritage, as well as UNESCO's Histories series of pedagogical publications, including its General History of Africa, also aim to facilitate dialogue, overcome prejudice and enhance the idea of diverse but shared histories.

Engendering conflict sensitivity

Working in complex conflict, post-conflict or latent conflict settings poses special challenges beyond logistical and security considerations, a topic that UNICEF addressed in its 'Conflict Sensitivity and Peacebuilding in UNICEF: A Technical Note'. A central concern is that interventions should be designed and conducted in such a way that they do not make matters worse – the 'do no harm' principle. The realization that development and humanitarian interventions could have a negative impact on the population they were intended to help became apparent in the 1990s when it was observed that introducing resources into environments of scarcity could exacerbate competition and inter-group tensions. If development actors poorly understand local realities and the political context, humanitarian aid deliveries can end up being diverted to combatants and inadvertently fuel conflict.

Among other factors, 'conflict sensitivity' incorporated into the design of an intervention seeks to ensure that it does not legitimize or support systems that promote violence and conflict or create tensions over access to services. Crucially, it is understood that any intervention becomes a part of the context and is never seen as neutral by the people in that context. While conflict sensitivity is the 'minimum standard' for interventions in conflict-affected contexts, peacebuilding also attempts to address the root causes of conflict and violence. It therefore intervenes in the dynamics of a conflict and involves a much greater degree of social transformation. New ways of addressing the challenges of fragile situations through peacebuilding have been the

focus of much attention in recent years. Fragility has multiple underlying causes both chronic and acute, which can include low state legitimacy, insecurity and conflict, porous borders and organized crime. When conflict and high levels of violence are present in a fragile situation, peacebuilding plays a critical role in developing resilience and supporting transition out of fragility. The notion underpins the approach to working in fragile states that was agreed by the UN, OECD members and the 17-member G+7 Group of fragile states in 2011 to improve development outcomes.

Members of the UN system is not alone in developing conflict sensitivity programmes;

governments, civil society and international cooperation partners are increasingly developing conflict sensitivity and peacebuilding policies, frameworks, and tools, as well as carrying out assessments to evaluate their assistance at different stages of planning or implementation. One key methodology increasingly used by development partners is the Peace and Conflict Impact Assessment (PCIA).

Peacebuilding through education

In conflict-affected or fragile settings, education may serve both as a driver of conflict and as a platform for peacebuilding. Education is often complicit in creating the conditions for armed conflict through, for example, inequitable provision, biased curriculum, or teaching methods that reinforce existing exclusion and stereotypes. On the other hand, education can make many contributions to social cohesion and managing conflict and can also provide major peace dividends. As children grow older, schools offer the means to learn how to think critically, resolve conflict non-violently, and provide a venue where students can develop positive relationships across conflict divides. Teaching young children, the values of respect, tolerance, and empathy, and equipping them with the necessary skills to resolve even daily conflict among peers in a non-violent manner, provides them with the tools they need, now and in the future, to foster peaceful relations at home, school and in their communities and beyond.

Schools are also unique hubs for multi-sectoral programming that reaches into communities. The promotion of peace through education is the objective of ‘Learning for Peace’, a new four-year peacebuilding, education and advocacy programme being implemented by UNICEF in partnership with the Government of the Netherlands, the national governments of 14 participating countries and other supporters.

The programme will focus on five key outcomes: increasing the inclusion of education in peacebuilding and conflict reduction policies, analyses and implementation; increasing institutional capacity to supply conflict-sensitive education; increasing the capacity of children, parents, teachers and other duty bearers to prevent, reduce and cope with conflict and promote peace; increasing access to conflict-sensitive education that contributes to peace; and generating and using evidence and knowledge on policies and programming related to education, conflict and peacebuilding. It will be implemented in 14 countries in East Asia and the Pacific, Eastern and Southern Africa, the Middle East and North Africa, South Asia, and West and Central Africa. Another example of education being harnessed to foster peace is ‘Back to School’ campaigns, which have been implemented in Afghanistan, Cote d’Ivoire,

Gaza, Somalia and Southern Sudan, and have been shown to provide massive peace dividends.

During campaigns, UNICEF encourages community-level engagement, distributes essential school materials, and provides temporary learning spaces to keep children in school during and after a conflict or crisis. UNICEF also strengthens the capacity of education ministries by providing technical assistance on policies, guidelines, system development and programme planning. ‘Back to School’ campaigns employ intense advocacy, communication and social mobilization efforts. They are informed by the principle of risk reduction, underpinned by a human right-based approach to local ownership, and serve as platforms for communal dialogue and social cohesion. UNICEF’s efforts to harness education for peace are not confined to the classroom.

For example, the Organization’s Youth, Peacebuilding and Leadership Training, which has been implemented in Guinea and Liberia, has been shown to contribute to reconciliation and the reduction of mob violence and violence against women, as well as an increased awareness of civic rights and responsibilities. In Liberia, a leadership and peacebuilding-skills programme used interactive and participatory techniques to address self-awareness, trust-building, cooperation, information-seeking, managing emotions, leadership, discussion about human rights, the causes of conflict, and nationalism and patriotism.

Employment for refugees

Within the framework of the Regional Refugee Response and Resilience Plan (3RP), the International Labour Organization (ILO) has adopted a development-focused, employment-driven strategy to support host communities and refugees. The strategy builds on the ILO’s core mandate to promote employment, social dialogue, social protection and rights at work through three key pillars: contributing to building the resilience of host communities and refugees by enhancing access to employment opportunities and livelihoods; strengthening institutional capacities and coordination to eliminate child labour; and supporting evidence-based policy development to ensure an employment-rich national response based on the principles of decent work. The strategy is anchored in the ILO’s 2016 ‘Guiding Principles on the Access of Refugees and other Forcibly Displaced Persons to the Labour Market’.

The ILO has allocated US\$40 million in response to the crisis, including its own resources and project funding from partners. Under the 3RP, the ILO is seeking an additional US\$37.7 million for 2017–2018 to deliver on livelihoods, jobs and skills, child labour and labour

market governance. In April 2016, Jordan's Ministry of Labour introduced a new model de-linking work permit applications from specific employers in the agricultural sector and allowing cooperatives to apply for Syrian refugee work permits. Over a nine-month period, the number of work permits issued to Syrian refugees grew practically tenfold to almost 37,000.

The ILO is now collaborating with the National Employment and Training Company to provide testing and certification for Syrian and Jordanian workers in the construction sector to improve their employability. The Organization will also build on its Better Work Programme in the garment sector to provide third-party monitoring for a compliance programme for factories exporting under the trade agreement between Jordan and the European Union. In Lebanon, the ILO has been pursuing a resilience-based approach, an example of which involves demonstrating how farmers can produce different varieties of potatoes and crops in accordance with Global Good Agriculture Practices (Global GAP) standards. In Turkey, it has delivered an array of vocational and technical skills development and entrepreneurship training to Syrian refugees and Turkish citizens. It has also supported the integration of Syrian refugees and host communities into the labour market by assisting with the implementation of Turkey's Regulation on Work Permits of Foreigners under Temporary Protection and the new International Labour Force Law that came into effect in August 2016.

Strengthening national capacity for Conflict Prevention

UNDP (United Nations Development Programme) and DPA have been working together for more than a decade on a flagship joint programme to strengthen national capacities for conflict prevention. The programme was joined in 2016 by the Peacebuilding Support Office, which is co-funding a growing cadre of Peace and Development Advisors (PDA) deployed in the field to help Resident Coordinators (RC) and UN Country Teams (UNCT) adapt and respond to complex political situations and develop and implement strategic conflict prevention initiatives and programmes. In 2016, the programme provided support to 45 countries, engaging in a variety of contexts. Notable results were achieved in strengthening peace architectures and mediator capacity-building in Bosnia and Herzegovina and Togo; establishing early warning systems in Cameroon and the Caribbean; and engaging with women and youth groups in Burundi, Malawi, and the Maldives. In many instances the approach has opened new entry points for conflict-prevention initiatives and facilitated the integration of conflict-sensitive perspectives into development programming.

PDAs wear two ‘hats’: while they provide strategic guidance and implement conflict-prevention initiatives with national counterparts from government and civil society, they also support RCs through political and conflict analysis and the UNCT with the design and implementation of conflict-sensitive programming. The Joint Programme’s support is intended to be catalytic, shaping the UN’s work on conflict prevention in-country and strengthening the capacity of both UNCTs and national partners to sustain efforts going forward. The average PDA deployment is two years, with an emphasis on recruiting nationals of the country to promote ownership and sustainability. A standout example of a positive contribution made by the programme concerns Malawi, which went through the most contentious and violent electoral process in its history in 2014. The PDA supported the UN’s preparedness ahead of the elections, working closely with the Resident Coordinator, the UN Country Team, UNDP and DPA Headquarters on the development of election scenarios. In the lead up to the polls, the PDA worked alongside DPA-deployed Standby Mediation Experts and UNDP specialists to boost the Public Affairs Committee’s (PAC) efforts to serve as ‘inside mediators’ before, during and after the elections. A series of planned peace initiatives and the mobilization of a critical mass of ‘peace voices’ across all sectors of Malawian society played a key role in limiting violence and ensuring calm after the results were announced. The PAC benefitted from simulation and mediation training facilitated by the mission and went on to become an effective intermediary between presidential candidates, securing their commitment for peaceful elections. Another example concerns the deployment of two PDAs to Kyrgyzstan and Tajikistan to alleviate cross-border tensions.

The PDAs have led UN efforts to develop peacebuilding initiatives, designing immediate responses to the current situation to build confidence and reduce tension, as well as longer-term programmes linking peacebuilding and sustainable development. In order to respond quickly to emerging conflict dynamics, UNDP plans to enhance its conflict-monitoring capacity in cross-border areas through the implementation of a pilot MPRD (Measuring Political Risks for Development) project, which is currently being tested in Tajikistan. If successful, the MPRD will also be considered by Kyrgyzstan using the capacities of two PDAs in close collaboration with the United Nations Regional Centre for Preventive Diplomacy (UNRCCA), DPA, two UNCTs and other UN partners. Under the leadership of the respective RCs, the PBSO and PBF offices have been engaged through an additional allocation that is expected to augment peace-building activities.

‘Asset creation’ as Peacebuilding

In addition to its better-known humanitarian relief role, the World Food Programme (WFP) also engages in peacebuilding activities in the field and is currently implementing elements of peacebuilding policy in countries including the Central African Republic, Colombia, Kyrgyzstan, Mali, Somalia, South Sudan, and Syria. A project in the Kyrgyz Republic, jointly implemented by UNDP, UNICEF, FAO, WFP, and UN Women as part of an 18-month PBSO-funded activity, includes both ‘hard’ elements such as infrastructure and ‘soft’ elements such as trust-building, mediation, collaboration, awareness-raising, early warning and information-sharing. WFP is concentrating on asset creation under its Food for Work (FFW) and Food for Training (FFT) activities and collaborates on other ‘soft’ interventions. The WFP’s Food Assistance for Assets (FFA) projects in conflict-affected areas increasingly focus on the construction of infrastructure such as bridges, dams, or community centres. The WFP includes participants from all sides in FFA programmes to promote dialogue.

Participants in the FFA programme in the Kyrgyz Republic reported that the work they had been involved in fostered inter-ethnic cooperation and helped to break down mistrust and negative stereotypes.

In Somalia, the WFP promoted the incorporation of food security and livelihood assistance into national peacebuilding plans, including the three-year New Deal Compact for Somalia (2014– 2016), the United Nations Integrated Strategic Framework (ISF), peacebuilding priority plans for PBF funding and the new three-year National Development Plan. The objectives include enhancing the resilience of communities through food assistance-for-assets interventions and strengthened partnerships, rebuilding household food and nutrition security with preventive and therapeutic nutrition interventions and school meals and protecting livelihoods during shocks and seasonal vulnerability through blanket supplementary feeding and targeted relief assistance.

Capacity-building through Food and Agriculture.

FAO has collaborated with the Peace Building Fund since 2009 to support emergency projects in conflict-affected or post-conflict countries including Burundi, the Central African Republic, Colombia, Cote d’Ivoire, Guinea-Bissau, Kyrgyzstan, Niger, Somalia, South Sudan, Tajikistan, Uganda and Yemen. It provides training, education and capacity-building; implements infrastructure rehabilitation projects; distributes seeds and agricultural kits; and provides veterinary care for livestock. As part of wider early action efforts, FAO has been working with 11 partners to build a technical consensus on food insecurity through the

Integrated Food Security Phase Classification (IPC). The IPC includes implications for responses, thus helping decision-makers to prioritize actions. The IPC has helped to mitigate the humanitarian impact of the conflicts in the Central African Republic and South Sudan and is currently being used in more than 20 countries. In another example of capacity-building, FAO has established pastoralist field schools to help the cross-border pastoralist communities of Kenya and Uganda, which are frequently involved in inter-tribal conflicts, to cope more effectively with drought risks.

To contribute to peacebuilding efforts, FAO has also conducted exchange visits between communities on each side of the border to help mitigate negative attitudes and promote peaceful co-existence. FAO often works in extremely sensitive contexts in post-conflict countries, where local people have unequal bargaining power and marginalized actors, such as women and ethnic groups, and are not fully aware of their territorial rights. In keeping with the notion that the settlement of disputes must be inclusive and participatory to produce lasting results, FAO has employed a Participatory Negotiated Territorial Development (PNTD) approach to promote equitable access to and management of natural resources in countries including Burundi, Ghana, the Democratic Republic of Congo and Senegal. In March 2016, the Director-General of FAO addressed the UN Security Council for the first time at an Arria-formula meeting on food security, nutrition, and peace, indicating that links between peace and development are strengthening within the UN. FAO has since provided quarterly technical updates to the UN Security Council on the state of food security in countries in conflict. The information will contribute to a forthcoming in-depth analysis of the relationship between peace and food security.

Environmental Cooperation for Peacebuilding

The Environmental Cooperation for Peacebuilding (ECP) programme, led by UN Environment, was established in 2008 to help countries, regional organizations, UN entities and civil society understand and respond more effectively to the conflict risks and peacebuilding opportunities presented by natural resources and the environment. The programme is divided into three pillars:

1. Building an evidence base on environmental peacebuilding, for instance through the Environmental Peacebuilding Knowledge Platform.
2. Providing strategic advocacy and joint policy analysis including through reports on the role of environment and natural resources in conflict and peacebuilding, disarmament, demobilization, and reintegration (DDR), and international law.

3. Promoting the uptake of good practices and pilot projects, such as the work carried out in Afghanistan, the Democratic Republic of Congo, Haiti, Mali and Sudan. Through the ECP, UN Environment has also assisted the United Nations International Law Commission with its ongoing review of the international legal framework for protecting the environment before, during and after armed conflict. The review aims to establish guidelines that can better support environmental protection and preservation, for example, in protected areas and environmentally sensitive sites, such as drinking water aquifers, which are of critical environmental and cultural importance and can be severely affected by warfare.

In May 2016, the UN Environment Assembly adopted a resolution on ‘Protecting the Environment in Areas Affected by Armed Conflict’ with the consensus of all 193 Member States. The resolution includes a provision on collaborating with UNESCO to protect conflict-affected World Heritage Sites.

Preventing conflicts over natural resources

Conflict prevention and peacebuilding in connection to the environment and natural resources concerns many UN entities, with UN Environment serving as the pivotal body. For instance, Environment has collaborated with the UN Department of Peacekeeping Operations (DPKO) and the UN Department of Field Support (DFS) to decrease the overall consumption of natural resources and the production of waste of peacekeeping operations, thereby reducing potential conflicts with local communities, protecting local environmental health, and establishing the UN as a role model for sustainable practices. In June 2009, DPKO and DFS adopted their ‘Environmental Policy for UN Field Missions’, drawing on technical support from UN Environment. The policy provides a set of minimum standards to be implemented across all UN field missions on energy, water, waste, wildlife, fauna, the management of cultural and historical resources, and environmental management and assessment. An important milestone of this partnership was the landmark policy report, *Greening the Blue Helmets: Environment, Natural Resources and UN Peacekeeping Operations* (2012).

Building on this collaboration, DFS and UN Environment established the UN Peace Operations Rapid Environment and Climate Technical Assistance Facility (REACT) partnership in 2016. REACT serves to promote the mainstreaming of environmental sustainability in the UN system, focusing on peacekeeping operations, by supporting DFS in their efforts to improve their own environmental and energy performance. The illegal exploitation of natural resources is another dimension of concern that has elicited the attention of several UN entities. Since 1990, more than 18 violent conflicts have been fuelled

by the exploitation of natural resources. Civil wars such as those in Angola, the Democratic Republic of Congo and Liberia have been fought over high-value resources such as timber, diamonds, gold, minerals, and oil, while others, including those in Darfur and the Middle East, have involved the control of scarce resources such as fertile land and water. An expert report published in 2015 by UN Environment in conjunction with DPKO and other partners highlighted the extent to which transnational criminal groups are engaged in illicit natural resources exploitation. Research suggests that, globally, at least 40 per cent of internal conflicts are linked to the exploitation of natural resources.

In addition, conflicts linked to natural resources are more likely to relapse in the first five years after a peace agreement has been signed (UN Environment, 2015). UN Environment has an active partnership with INTERPOL to assess and address environmental crime, including financing provided to armed groups and criminal networks. Two recent reports, *The Rise of Environmental Crime and Environment, Peace, and Security: A Convergence of Threats*, have been published in this context. Armed conflict can thus inflict direct and indirect environmental damage, coupled with the collapse of institutions, and threats to people's health, livelihoods, and security.

However, transparent natural resource governance can help to maximize peace dividends, minimize the risk of social grievances and violent conflict, and serve as a vehicle for durable peace, confidence-building and poverty reduction. To address this key governance issue, which has a direct impact on peace and stability, UN Environment is currently working on a partnership with the World Bank to understand how improved information management and stakeholder engagement in the extractive sector can help contribute to SDG targets to reduce corruption and bribery, develop effective, accountable, and transparent institutions, foster inclusive decision-making and ensure public access to information. The 'MAP-X' (Mapping and Assessing the Performance of the Extractive Industries) geospatial platform aims to help stakeholders improve monitoring, compliance, and performance of concessions across the extractive industry value chain using economic, social and financial criteria.

Cooperating for Climate Change

While the threat posed by climate change has galvanized international cooperation in recent years, there is a long history of nations coming together to better understand and cope with the weather and climate. The transformation of the International Meteorological Organization (IMO) into the World Meteorological Organization (WMO) in 1950 was a major milestone in strengthening global cooperation in this area. From its inception, the WMO built bridges

between the scientific communities of different countries, including during the Cold War, with cooperation flourishing during those politically difficult years. Observational networks were extended to cover practically the entire globe. The World Weather Watch (WWW), which was established in 1963 at the initiative of the United States of America and the Soviet Union, represents an outstanding landmark in international cooperation. It combines observing systems, telecommunication facilities, and data-processing and forecasting centres operated by Member States and provides meteorological and related environmental information needed to ensure efficient services in all countries. WMO has remained at the forefront of early warning on weather and climate-related risks that affect all nations, regardless of politics. The WMO technical document on the possible climatic consequences of a major nuclear war, published in 1986, will remain a historic reference for future generations. In 1976, WMO released its authoritative statement on the accumulation of carbon dioxide in the atmosphere and the potential impacts on the Earth's climate. This helped to focus attention on global warming and climate change, which are today understood as a major threat to sustainable development and even to human survival.

Addressing the challenges of Climate Change

Addressing climate change and its effects is the foremost challenge of the present era. The Fifth Assessment Report of the Intergovernmental Panel on Climate Change (IPCC) and reports of the WMO on the global climate and greenhouse gases are unequivocal: the temperature of the atmosphere and the ocean are continuing to rise, ice caps and glaciers are receding, and sea levels are rising. Human influence on the climate is beyond any doubt: 2016 was the warmest year on record, with global average temperatures 1.1 °C above pre-industrial levels, while the global concentration of CO₂ and other greenhouse gases in the atmosphere continues to rise. IPCC scenarios show that continued reliance on fossil fuels will definitively lead to a warmer planet (IPCC, 2013–14; WMO, 2016a; WMO, 2016b). Limiting global warming to less than 2°C as mandated by the Paris Agreement can be achieved but requires a rapid and significant reduction in greenhouse gas emissions. Climate change is exacerbating extreme weather events and pressure on vital resources such as water, food, and energy.

If not adequately addressed, these effects will continue to exacerbate tension, conflict, and displacement, and undermine peace and security, as well as efforts to transition towards a greener economy and more sustainable development. A recent report published by WMO (2014) and the Centre for Research on the Epidemiology of Disasters (CRED) of the

Universite Catholique de Louvain states that, between 1970 and 2012, 8 835 disasters, 1.94 million deaths and US\$ 2.4 trillion of economic losses resulted from droughts, floods, windstorms, tropical cyclones, storm surges, extreme temperatures, landslides and wildfires, or climate or weather-linked health epidemics and insect infestations. Water stress is already high, especially in developing countries, and climate change is exacerbating the situation. Poor water resource management will jeopardize progress on poverty reduction, sustainable development, and food security and nutrition targets across all economic, social and environmental dimensions, including as a result of forced displacement in situations where basic human rights are weakened or threatened.

With the increased decline of the Arctic and Greenland ice sheet mass, the possibility of a sea level rise of 1 metre or more by 2100 cannot be excluded. As a recent article in the IOM Environmental Migration Newsletter stated, Small Island Developing States (SIDS) such as Kiribati, Tuvalu or the Maldives face the prospect of submergence and complete abandonment during this century (Camus, 2014). Countries in Asia and Africa with low levels of development and rapid population growth in coastal areas are also threatened.

In 2011 and 2012, drought and famine in the Horn of Africa led to an influx of Somalis into Kenya's Dadaab refugee camp. Occurrences of this kind highlight important challenges for the UN High Commissioner for Refugees (UNHCR) and the broader international community about how climate change affects and will continue to affect displacement, security and peace. What happened in Kenya underscores the difficulty of attributing causality, or determining the primary driver of displacement, particularly when persons are fleeing slow onset hazards such as droughts since there is no identifiable sudden trigger, but rather changes that occur over a prolonged period. There is currently a gap in international law concerning persons displaced across international borders in the context of disasters including climate change impacts. According to the 1951 Convention Relating to the Status of Refugees, such individuals do not usually qualify as refugees, although their status may change in circumstances where the disaster is linked to armed conflict and violence (UNHCR, 2017).

Another issue relates to the question of displaced persons unable to return to their country of origin because of climate-related impacts, such as droughts. In an example that illustrates how the issue can be mainstreamed, the High-Level at the Third Conference on Disaster Risk Reduction held in Sendai, Japan, in March 2015, the UN stressed the need to 'substantially increase the availability of and access to multi-hazard early warning systems and disaster risk

information' by 2030. The Climate Risk and Early Warning Systems (CREWS) initiative was launched in 2015 at the Paris climate change negotiations to strengthen risk information and early warning systems in vulnerable countries and to leverage financing to protect populations exposed to extreme climate events.

The CREWS coalition is led by France, with support from Australia, Canada, Germany, Japan, Luxembourg and the Netherlands, and the initiative is being implemented by the World Meteorological Organization (WMO), the UN Office for Disaster Risk Reduction (UNISDR), and the World Bank's Global Facility for Disaster Reduction and Recovery (GFDRR). The initiative aims to mobilize US\$100 million by 2020 to fill the gaps in existing bilateral and multilateral cooperation programmes. At the Marrakech talks in November 2016, it was announced that the Democratic Republic of Congo, which has been affected by significant coastal erosion, would be one of the countries to receive assistance in upgrading their national meteorological and hydrological service forecast capabilities, along with Burkina Faso and Mali.

Making cities safer

Enhancing the safety of cities makes a crucial contribution to peace and security. The application of UN-Habitat's Safer Cities approach in more than 30 countries over the past two decades has shown that the prevention of urban crime and violence promotes more equitable, socially integrated, and inclusive cities, and represents a critical contribution towards peace. The programme promotes an urban planning, management, and governance model of enhancing safety in which local authorities play a decisive role, fostering closer UN engagement with local decision-makers.

UN-Habitat has also launched the Global Partnership Initiative on Safer Cities, which advances knowledge management and the development of tools, training, capacity development and networking in cooperation with the associated Global Network on Safer Cities (GNSC) and the Regional Forums for Urban Safety in Europe, Africa, Asia and Latin America. In partnership with the government of Canada, UN-Habitat and the UN Office on Drugs and Crime (UNODC) have prepared UN system-wide Guidelines on Safer Cities. UN-Habitat's Safer Cities Programme and the Geneva Peacebuilding Platform held the first biennial conference on 'Reviewing the State of Safety in World Cities' in Geneva in June 2017. Committee on Programmes (HLCP) is developing a UN strategy on climate change in the context of the 2030 Agenda, under which UNHCR is contributing to the thematic area on the nexus of climate change, displacement, and security. From 2013–2016, UNHCR

coordinated the Advisory Group on Climate Change and Human Mobility composed of UNHCR, IOM, UNDP, Norwegian Refugee Council/Internal Displacement Monitoring Centre, Refugees International, Arab Network for Environment and Development (RAED) and the University of Liege.

At the 2016 Climate Change Negotiations (COP22), UNHCR also organized and was a panellist at the ‘Delivering as One’ UN side event on Climate Change and Human Mobility, anchored in SDG 10 on ‘Addressing inequalities’, which brought together diverse perspectives from across the UN family. The panel included representatives from the Office of the UN High Commissioner for Human Rights (OHCHR), UN Women, the Food and Agriculture Organization (FAO), the Platform on Disaster Displacement (PDD), the International Organization for Migration (IOM), the UK branch of the United Nations Children’s Fund (UNICEF UK), the UN University Institute for Environment and Human Security (UNU-EHS) and the Norwegian Refugee Council (NRC), and was moderated by the UNFCCC Secretariat. There is also a need for a shift in mentality towards prevention, rather than solely reaction to these issues, for instance through the integration of early warning systems, disaster risk reduction and preparedness measures into national policies to build communities’ resilience and prevent displacement. Such a forward-looking perspective will enable the UN family to ensure no one is left behind and to promote and foster peace.

International cooperation on early warning systems

The number of weather and climate-related disasters has more than doubled over the past 40 years, claiming lives, forcing people from their homes, and threatening peace and stability. From 1970 to 2012, close to 2 million deaths and US\$2.4 trillion of economic losses were reported globally due to extreme weather events. Countries that have successfully built early warning systems have benefitted from a dramatic reduction in deaths related to weather extremes as well as obtaining additional economic benefits. However, over 80 per cent of the world’s 48 least developed countries and many SIDS, which are particularly affected by such hazards, have only the most basic early warning systems, while weather observation networks the foundation of early warning systems – are inadequate in many African countries.

Building peace through communication and information

The free flow of ideas by word and image is an essential component of lasting peace. In 1957, UNESCO in cooperation with the French government enabled the creation of the first

regional centre for the training of journalism teachers – the International Centre for Higher Education in Journalism, hosted at the University of Strasbourg in France. By fostering freedom of expression, promoting the expression of pluralism and cultural diversity in the media, and ensuring access to information and knowledge through ICTs, UNESCO is actively contributing to promoting fundamental rights and freedoms. UNESCO's efforts in this area have led to continuous cooperation between tertiary educational establishments across Libya with a view to opening up access to scientific research and education resources. In South Sudan, UNESCO organized a series of workshops through its Youth Mobile Initiative, teaching young girls and boys how to design mobile applications and build a 'PeaceApp', which offers practical steps towards peace and reconciliation, and has allowed users to share information and make personal commitments to the peacebuilding process. Among many other interventions, UNESCO has also launched a Massive Open Online Course on media and information literacy (MIL MOOC) for young girls and boys in English and Arabic. Over 500 young people have been trained to verify information online, to recognize how information influences their beliefs and attitude, and to use ICTs to promote equality and tolerance to tackle online misinformation, which is one of the leading causes of radicalization.

Building confidence and capacities in cyberspace

Over the past decade, the Global Cybersecurity Agenda (GCA) (2007) of the International Telecommunication Union (ITU) has guided the ITU's work around building confidence and security in the information society. Achievements include the existence of a growing number of national Computer Incident Response Teams (CIRTs) to respond to cyber-attacks and protect critical infrastructure from cyber-threats. ITU aids Member States with initial assessment and design through to the establishment and enhancement of their CIRT. ITU and its partners also organize regular regional cyber-drills to improve coordination between national CIRTs. To help improve international cooperation on cyber security, national governments also need effective national cyber security frameworks. The development of a comprehensive national cyber security strategy is the first key step. ITU has partnered with 14 entities with experience in devising models and implementing cyber security strategies to produce one single reference guide, which is currently at the finalization stage.

In 2015 and 2017, the ITU published a Global Cybersecurity Index (GCI) report, a tool aimed at providing an incentive for countries to identify areas for improvement in their cyber security measures and actions, and to harmonize their practices with those of other countries.

The Index measured countries' commitment to cyber security based on a set of legal, technical and organizational criteria including levels of capacity-building, and national and international cooperation.

Child online protection is another aspect of the ITU remit. In 2008, ITU launched the Child Online Protection (COP) initiative as a multi-stakeholder effort within the GCA framework. The initiative is designed to create a safer and more empowering online experience for children. ITU has also been providing guidance and building capacity in countries in cooperation with other stakeholders.

Tackling unemployment and building a global health workforce

The global demand for health workers will double by 2030, as populations grow and change. Investing in the necessary training and sector development will not only contribute to health goals, it will also provide an opportunity to tackle what the UN Secretary-General considers to be 'probably one of the worse threats to global peace and security' (Guterres, 2017) – youth unemployment. Under the five-year 'Working for Health' action plan, which resonates with the UN focus on prevention to advance peace and development, the World Health Organization (WHO), the International Labour Organization (ILO), and the Organisation for Economic Co-operation and Development (OECD) are working with governments and key stakeholders to address the global health and social workforce shortfall and to contribute to international efforts to achieve the Sustainable Development Goals.

The plan calls on countries to view the health and social workforce as an investment rather than a cost, and to take advantage of the economic benefits of growth in the health and social sector. It outlines how ILO, OECD and WHO will take intersectoral action on five fronts: galvanizing political support; strengthening data and evidence; transforming and scaling up the education, skills and decent jobs of health and social workers; increasing resources to build the health and social workforces; and maximizing the multiple benefits that can be obtained from international health worker mobility. It also focuses on maximizing women's economic empowerment and participation, and addresses occupational health and safety, and the protection and security of the health and social workforce in all settings. In addition, the plan covers the reform of service models towards the efficient provision of care, particularly in underserved areas. The action plan supports the WHO Global Strategy on Human Resources for Health: Workforce 2030 and will facilitate implementation of the recommendations of the United Nations Secretary General's High-Level Commission on Health Employment and Economic Growth (WHO, 2017b).

According to the Commission, ageing populations and increasing rates of non-communicable diseases are projected to generate demand for 40 million new health workers worldwide by 2030 – double the current global health workforce. Most of those jobs will be created in the wealthiest countries. Without action, there will be a shortfall of 18 million health workers needed to achieve and sustain universal health coverage, affecting primarily low and lower-middle income countries.

Reconciliation and peacebuilding through land and property reparations

Land, property and reparations issues play an ever-increasing role in reconciliation, peace-building and reconstruction efforts, and represent an important rehabilitation tool for countries in transition. The contribution of such programmes to durable solutions for conflict-affected populations is substantial. As part of its global mandate on migration, the International Organization for Migration (IOM) Land, Property and Reparations (LPR) Division, under the Department of Operations and Emergencies (DOE), assists governments to address severe human rights violations in the aftermath of natural disasters and protracted conflict situations. It gives technical support on land and property issues, including the resolution of disputes and increasing and protecting access to land and land tenure security for vulnerable populations in rural and urban settings.

The IOM also sensitizes international and national actors to the importance of land issues in post-conflict and post-natural disaster environments. With respect to reparations for victims of conflict or serious human rights violations, IOM provides technical support to governments and other stakeholders on locally sensitive programme design and the transparent delivery of individual or collective reparations, such as compensation payments, the provision of in-kind benefits such as vocational training, access to health care and education, and the implementation of symbolic reparations. IOM's range of services in this area extends from programme design to direct implementation, and includes activities such as field surveys, consultations and technical assessments, policy advice and recommendations, institutional design, capacity-building for implementing bodies, provision of IT support, and the development of strategies, standard operating procedures, or guidelines.

The LPR division relies on its extensive network of field missions, as well as its strong relationships with other international agencies and academic institutions. The division was formed in 2002 when the Remembrance, Responsibility and Future German Compensation Foundation tasked the IOM with implementing the German Forced Labour Compensation

Programme (GFLCP). This was the first large-scale reparations programme of its kind and it incorporated a property restitution component as well as the Holocaust Victims Assets Programme (HVAP). Since then, it has developed and implemented several initiatives relating to land and property, reparations, and transitional justice across the globe.

In Africa, LPR supported the design and implementation of the still ongoing Sierra Leone Reparations Programme (SLRP), which has provided material and symbolic reparations to over 32,000 victims of the 1991–2002 war. In 2014, it produced a technical assessment study for the International Criminal Tribunal for Rwanda on possible reparation options for survivors of the 1994 genocide in Rwanda. In Asia, the division is supporting Nepal's efforts to develop a national transition plan for implementation of a land reform and property return, as well as a comprehensive and transparent reparations policy, both of which lie at the heart of the country's peace process. It is also providing technical support for implementation of the 2013 'Compensation Act' to Victims of Human Rights Violations under the Marcos regime (1972– 1982) in the Philippines. It has provided technical support to enable the comprehensive implementation of Colombia's 2005 Justice and Peace Law and the 2011 Victim's Law for more than 7 million victims of Colombia's protracted conflict. It has supported the work of the Commission for the Resolution of Real Property Disputes in Iraq (CRRPD), now the Iraqi Property Claims Commission (IPCC), which collects and adjudicates Iraqi real property claims.

A cornerstone and increasingly popular feature of the division's capacity-building work is its training programmes, which bring together practitioners and policymakers confronted with handling land and property issues in post-conflict settings around the world.

Anti-corruption initiatives for peaceful societies

As corruption decreases, prospects for peace improve, yet in many parts of the world levels of corruption have been on the increase globally, while violence has also been increasing. There is a link between violence and corruption in the police and judicial systems, which encourages a vicious cycle of low trust, low crime reporting and increased incentives for criminals to erode the rule of law (UNODC, 2011). Globally, the cross-border flow of proceeds from criminal activities, corruption and tax evasion is estimated at between US\$1 trillion and US\$1.6 trillion per year. Corrupt money associated with bribes received by public officials in developing and transition countries is estimated at US\$20 billion to US\$40 billion a year – a figure equivalent to 20–40 per cent of official development assistance (Institute for Economics and Peace, 2015).

The United Nations Convention against Corruption (UNCAC) is the sole comprehensive international legally binding anti-corruption instrument. Together with the United Nations Convention against Transnational Organized Crime (UNTOC), it provides a platform to combat corruption, especially in the context of transnational crime. The United Nations Office on Drugs and Crime (UNODC) supports the implementation of UNCAC by States Parties seeking to develop and implement anti-corruption reforms. The UNCAC Implementation Review Mechanism, established to provide a systematic and comprehensive peer-review process, respects the principles of equality and sovereignty of States Parties and may not serve as an instrument for interfering in their domestic affairs. Since 2007, UNODC and the World Bank have cooperated through the Stolen Asset Recovery Initiative, a joint programme that works with developing countries and financial centres to prevent the laundering of the proceeds of corruption and facilitate the return of stolen assets. A global programme was launched after the adoption of the Doha Declaration at the 13th United Nations Congress on Crime Prevention and Criminal Justice aimed at helping countries improve criminal justice, corruption prevention and the rule of law; elements inherently connected with peaceful societies.

Strengthening indigenous peacemaking capacities

Participating in a training programme organized by the UN Institute for Training and Research (UNITAR) was a ‘major catalyst and source of inspiration’ for prominent international constitutional and human rights lawyer Megan Davis, who then went on to become chair of the UN Permanent Forum on Indigenous Issues, serve as Acting Commissioner of the New South Wales Land and Environment Court and a Solicitor of the Supreme Court of the Australian Capital Territory. Ms. Davis, an Aboriginal of Australia’s Cobble Cobble clan, was an Indigenous Fellow of the Office of the High Commissioner for Human Rights in Geneva when she attended in 2000 UNITAR’s first intensive training programme to strengthen the capacities of indigenous peoples to negotiate, engage in dialogue and promote their rights. She later went on to share her knowledge and expertise with the next generation of UNITAR trainees.

UNITAR’s programme, which responds to growing calls for capacity-building to foster more inclusive and participatory decision-making, provides indigenous representatives with the opportunity to analyse the root causes of conflict, learn about interest-based negotiation theory, and practice negotiation based on real cases. The 2016 Report of the UN Permanent

Forum on Indigenous Issues praises the UNITAR programme as: ‘One of the most important human rights training programmes in the UN system that examines the root causes of conflict’. The training is provided as part of UNITAR’s Peacemaking and Conflict Prevention (PMCP) Programme, which addresses the strategic need for skills in negotiation and mediation for the prevention and resolution of conflict. Intensive training sessions are organized for mid and senior-level officials from Member States, regional organizations, and the UN, as well as among representatives of indigenous peoples.

Connecting peace and development

The UN’s renewed focus on the links between peace and development augurs a closer relationship between the Economic and Social Council (ECOSOC), one of six main organs of the UN, and the UN Security Council. Article 65 of the UN Charter states that ‘ECOSOC may furnish information to the Security Council and shall assist it upon its request’. Although such collaboration has been historically limited, the situation started to change in the 1990s when the UN Security Council, the UN General Assembly and ECOSOC saw the need for a more comprehensive approach to conflict prevention and peacebuilding. In its resolution on the ‘Prevention of Armed Conflict’, the General Assembly supported ‘the more active involvement of ECOSOC about the prevention of armed conflict, considering the relevant recommendations of the Secretary-General and the need to promote socio-economic measures, including economic growth, in support of poverty eradication and development, as a core element of Council strategy in that regard’.

In line with the Security Council’s resolution inviting ECOSOC to contribute to a long-term programme of support for Haiti (Resolution 1212 (1998)), ECOSOC established the Ad Hoc Advisory Group on Haiti in 1999, which would be the forerunner of the ECOSOC Ad Hoc Advisory Groups on African countries emerging from conflict. Two pilot groups were established on Guinea-Bissau in 2002 and Burundi in 2003, to assess humanitarian and economic needs, prepare long-term programmes to integrate relief, rehabilitation, reconstruction, and development, and provide advice on timely, adequate, and coordinated development assistance. However, these pioneering groups had to contend with political and security issues beyond their mandate and had limited ability to mobilize resources, until the establishment of the Peacebuilding Commission (PBC), when the groups’ mandates were terminated. For a certain period, ECOSOC worked closely with the Security Council on Guinea-Bissau and Burundi, conducting joint missions to both countries, while the chairs of the groups and the ECOSOC President were invited to address the Security Council. In recent

years, ECOSOC has followed the development situation in South Sudan under its agenda item ‘African countries emerging from conflicts’.

Over the years, the Council and ECOSOC have established a working relationship, holding joint meetings on the Millennium Development Goals (MDGs), peace and development in Sudan and South Sudan, and job creation for young people in countries emerging from conflict. Recent meetings include the ‘2030 Agenda for Sustainable Development and Sustaining Peace’, which took place in June 2016, and the ‘Situation in the Sahel’, which took place in June 2017. Interaction between the Council and the Commission has developed around the institutional ties of both bodies. Seven members of the Council are on the Commission’s organizational committee and the Commission establishes its agenda based inter alia on requests for advice from the Council with the consent of a concerned Member State, in exceptional circumstances, on the verge of lapsing or relapsing into conflict and with which the Security Council is not seized, and the Council can act on recommendations by the PBC Commission. The recent review of the United Nations peacebuilding architecture calls for closer cooperation between ECOSOC and the PBC, and emphasizes the centrality of development to sustaining peace (UN, 2016d and 2016e). It also stresses the importance of ‘enhanced dialogue in support of promoting coherence and complementarity between the United Nations peace and security efforts and its development, human rights and humanitarian work’, and ‘encourages the Peacebuilding Commission to draw on the expertise of relevant Economic and Social Council subsidiary bodies’.

In the same vein, the recently adopted GA resolution on the Quadrennial Comprehensive Policy Review (QCPR) calls upon the UN development system to enhance coordination with humanitarian assistance and peacebuilding efforts at the national level in countries facing humanitarian emergencies, and countries in conflict and post-conflict situations, and calls upon ECOSOC ‘to provide overall coordination and guidance to the United Nations development system’ (UN, 2017g). The resolution recognizes ‘the positive role that sustainable development can play to mitigate drivers of conflicts, disaster risks, humanitarian crises, and complex emergencies, and that a comprehensive whole-of-system response, including greater cooperation and complementarity between development, disaster risk reduction, humanitarian action and sustaining peace, is fundamental to most efficiently and effectively addressing needs and attaining the SDGs’.

The inclusion of peaceful societies in the 2030 Agenda for Sustainable Development (A/RES/70/1) is a significant step towards enhancing the peace and development nexus. The

ECOSOC system can contribute significantly to each dimension of sustainable development, whether economic, social or environmental, and their contribution to peace. It is working with the PBC to find ways to enhance collaboration and break down silos at the intergovernmental level for a stronger peace and development nexus.

Conflict analysis and researching for peace.

The work of the United Nations Research Institute for Social Development (UNRISD) has informed and had an impact on the UN's approach to 'sustaining peace' as well as the 2030 Agenda for Sustainable Development. Research on social policy and poverty reduction over more than two decades has demonstrated inter alia the importance of strategic state interventions to protect the vulnerable, and to promote social cohesion and nation-building. The Institute's research also contributed to the explicit inclusion of inequality, social protection, and unpaid care work in the 2030 Agenda for Sustainable Development. Furthermore, UNRISD's evidence-based analysis, knowledge and ideas can assist governments and other stakeholders as they work to achieve the SDGs.

One vehicle for this contribution is the UNRISD 2016 flagship report Policy Innovations for Transformative Change. The key message of the report is that 'transforming our world' – as the title of the 2030 Agenda states – will require attacking the root causes that generate and reproduce economic, political, environmental, and social problems and inequities, not merely their symptoms. In other words, tackling the same structural causes as those underlying conflict, and integrating efforts more effectively. There are notable examples of UNRISD research that fit a narrower, more traditional concept of peace and security. Work from the early 2000s on ethnic diversity and development looked at policies and mechanisms to prevent, contain or resolve ethnic conflicts and build pluralist public sector institutions in multi-ethnic societies. It concluded that devolution of power and power-sharing, as well as pluralist electoral systems, cultural policies and education, all help to promote a healthy system of ethnic relations, thus promoting the process of peace in cohesive societies.

One action-research project on rebuilding war-torn societies evolved into Interpeace, an independent, international peacebuilding organization whose methods build on and operationalize the results of this UNRISD research. The project looked at laying the foundations for sustainable development on the premise that development is a difficult enough challenge for peaceful countries, and that for war-torn societies the problems are amplified many times. To be sustainable, it suggested, rebuilding must proceed on many fronts simultaneously – political, social, judicial, moral, psychological, and economic – using

an integrated and inclusive approach that can help to prevent inequalities along ethnic, religious or regional lines. UNRISD has also researched gender equality and women's roles in conflict resolution and peacebuilding.

Intercultural innovation to promote peace.

The Intercultural Innovation Award is a global venture between the UN Alliance of Civilizations and the BMW Group, which identifies and provides monetary and in-kind support to highly innovative grassroots initiatives working to alleviate identity-based tensions and conflicts around the world. The projects selected by the scheme promote intercultural dialogue and understanding, thereby making vital contributions to prosperity and peace. The award is given annually to ten not-for-profit organizations active in the fields of migration and integration, intercultural awareness, or education for intercultural citizenship, or to organizations addressing the needs of specific groups in promoting intercultural understanding (e.g. faith-based, youth, women, media, etc.). The selected organizations must have a track record of managing intercultural projects and show a willingness to expand their range of action. The award has benefited more than 600,000 individuals in dozens of countries around the world since its establishment in 2011. Winners have included a Berlin-based project that brings migrants together with host country populations through volunteering to help the elderly.

Tourism for peace

Tourism is one of the most viable and sustainable economic development options and a main source of foreign currency revenue in many developing and least developed countries (LDCs). Today, international tourism accounts for as much as 6 per cent of all exports in the 49 LDCs. To capitalize on potential tourism offers with a view to improving the lives of the world's poorest, the UN World Tourism Organization (UNWTO) launched the ST-EP (Sustainable Tourism – Eliminating Poverty) initiative at the World Summit for Sustainable Development in Johannesburg in 2002, in partnership with other UN entities, governments, donor agencies, NGOs and stakeholders. Since its launch, the initiative, which predominantly targets those living on less than a dollar a day, has built up a portfolio of some 120 projects in Africa, the Americas, Asia, Europe and the Middle East. In March 2016, members of UNWTO agreed to transform the ST-EP Foundation into an international organization hosted by the Government of the Republic of Korea, which was instrumental in establishing the

Foundation and has contributed to many of its projects.

ST-EP projects provide business and financing services to micro, small and medium community-based tourism enterprises, establish links between local producers and tourism enterprises, train local guides and tourism workers, and facilitate the development of tourism around natural and cultural heritage sites. They create employment for local people in tourism, ensure the supply of local goods and services to tourism enterprises and tourists, establish locally run tourism operations, levy tourism income or profits to benefit communities, encourage voluntary donations by tourism operators, and invest in infrastructure that benefits tourism and the host community.

These efforts have enhanced UNWTO's longstanding work to encourage sustainable tourism – social, economic and environmental – with activities that specifically alleviate poverty, deliver development and jobs. The ST-EP Initiative has organized over 25 regional and national training seminars on tourism and poverty alleviation with the participation of over 2,000 officials, and has also set up 180 small libraries for communities around the world under the Thank You Small Library (TYSL) initiative.

Fostering youth leadership through sport

To date, some 800 young men and women have participated in the flagship 'Youth Leadership Programme' (YLP), launched by the UN Office of Sport for Development and Peace (UNOSDP) in 2012 to train young community workers, coaches and volunteers from disadvantaged backgrounds to use sport to effect positive change in their communities. UNOSDP has held 23 YLP camps in eight countries. In 2014, the YLP camp held in Gwangju in the Republic of Korea was attended by participants from both North and South Korea. Participants explored how sport can contribute to strengthening relationships between the opposing sides of a conflict. Youth and officials from both Koreas were again invited to the 'Imagine PEACE Youth Camp' held in Olympia, Greece. The Office will continue to play a facilitation role between the two Koreas using upcoming sporting events such as the 2018 PyeongChang Winter Olympics.

In February 2016, the UNOSDP also welcomed three young refugees from Syria to its YLP camp in Hamburg. In another project to empower young people, the UNOSDP supported the building of an indoor sports hall extension in Palestine for refugee children, providing a safe sports environment for them as part of 'Sport for Resilience', a project implemented by the United Nations Relief and Works Agency for Palestine Refugees in the Near East (UNRWA).

In 2014, the Office supported the Diyar Women Sports Centre, a project implemented by the Diyar Consortium, which provides women in Palestine with skills and education to enhance their employment prospects.

Women at the Peace Table

There is growing evidence that the presence of more women at the peace table leads to longer-lasting and more effective peace deals, an outcome that was highlighted in the Global Study on the Implementation of **Security Council Resolution 1325** (2000).

The report concluded that far from being symbolic, the presence of female negotiators produces ‘a shift in dynamics, a broadening of the issues discussed, increasing the chances of community-buy in and addressing root causes, and greater pressure on the parties to reach an agreement or go back to the negotiating table when the talks had faltered’ (UN, 2015d). A key message of the report was that the international community tended to neglect ‘track 2’ negotiations at the local or sub-national level, where many women are already brokering peace or shoring up community resilience needed to sustain peace, while investing narrowly in ‘track 1’ negotiations with predominantly male political and military elites.

The UN has been working to change this state of affairs. UN Women has successfully championed the participation of women in negotiations on the conflicts in Colombia, Mali, Myanmar, South Sudan, and Syria, where it helped to ensure that women made up a third of peace table participants, half the participants in consultations, and more than 60 per cent of the victims and experts addressing the peace table. UN Women also made gender expertise available during negotiations and strengthened women’s capacity to influence and engage in the peace process. In another example, with support from the UN Peacebuilding Fund, over the past few years UN Women has also helped to develop a network of 534 women community peace mediators in Burundi, who tackle issues that threaten to destabilize communities during the present tense political context. Disarmament is another area where women could play a fuller role.

In Gender, Development and nuclear weapons, a report that resonates with the Women, Peace and Security agenda, the UN Institute for Disarmament Research (UNIDIR) contended that progress on achieving nuclear disarmament is being hampered by the limited participation of women in negotiation processes. In an analysis of 26 nuclear security meetings over the past 35 years, including the five-yearly review of the Treaty on the Non-Proliferation of nuclear weapons (NPT) and meetings of the UNGA First Committee, which considers security issues,

fewer than 30 per cent of the participants were women. In meetings of the Third Committee, which deals with ‘softer’ development issues, the number of women averaged 48.1 per cent over the same period.

It is necessary to go back more than two decades to 1995, to find such a small number of women on the Third Committee. More recently, at the Open-Ended Working Group (OEWG) on Disarmament in 2016, only 10 per cent of the nuclear-alliance states’ speakers were women, compared with 40 per cent of the speakers representing other states. The UNIDIR report contends that gender imbalance in nuclear disarmament matters notably because it reduces ‘collective intelligence’ by limiting the range of perspectives on the issue. More specifically, there may also be a link between the under-representation of women and the dominant discourse on nuclear weapons as legitimate instruments of statecraft. The report cites independent research suggesting that states are less likely to be peaceful if their family laws favour men or when, despite equality under the law, gender discrimination is prevalent in practice. Providing more food for thought, gender equality is reportedly a stronger predictor of a state’s peacefulness in comparison to its level of democracy, predominant religion or gross domestic product.

13

UNESCO

Ref: <https://www.unesco.org/en>

UNESCO, the United Nations Educational, Scientific and Cultural Organization, is a specialized agency dedicated to strengthening our shared humanity through the promotion of education, science, culture, and communication. It set standards, produce tools and develop knowledge to create solutions to some of the greatest challenges of our time, and foster a world of greater equality and peace. Protecting biodiversity, responding to artificial intelligence, advancing quality education, safeguarding heritage, and ensuring access to reliable information are some examples of the work that UNESCO does with its 194 Member States across the globe.

UNESCO governance

UNESCO is led by three key bodies: the General Conference, the Secretariat and the Executive Board. The General Conference, with representatives from all Member States,

determines UNESCO's main lines of work. The Secretariat executes the Organization's programme under the authority of the Director-General. The Executive Board monitors the implementation of the Organization's programme. Together, these bodies drive UNESCO's efforts in education, science, culture, and communication.

Its values

#SharingHumanity

Its #SharingHumanity campaign reminds us of our global values, culture, and knowledge. By strengthening these ties, we build the foundations of peace between people and nations.

General Conference

Pursuant to Article IV of the Constitution, the General Conference determines the policies and main lines of work of the Organization, and takes decisions on its programmes. It may summon international conferences and adopt conventions and recommendations in the fields of education, science and culture, as well as communication and information. The General Conference consists of the representatives of all States Members of the Organization and meets in ordinary session every two years.

The General Conference shall determine the policies and the main lines of work of the Organization. It shall take decisions on programmes submitted to it by the Executive Board.

Executive Board

Pursuant to Article V of the Constitution, the Executive Board prepares the agenda for the General Conference and examines the programme of work and budget estimates for the Organization, submitting recommendations to the General Conference. It is responsible for the execution of the programme adopted by the General Conference and takes all necessary measures to ensure its effective and rational execution. The Executive Board consists of representatives of 58 Member States elected by the General Conference and meets in regular session at least four times each biennium.

In accordance with the decisions of the General Conference and having regard to circumstances arising between two ordinary sessions, the Executive Board shall take all necessary measures to ensure the effective and rational execution of the programme by the Director-General.

Secretariat

The Secretariat, led by the Director-General, M. Khaled El-Enany and other key related institutions and groups, is responsible for managing the organization and representing it globally. As the chief executive, the Director-General ensures the effective implementation of decisions made by the General Conference and the Executive Board. They oversee the Secretariat's staff, who carry out UNESCO's international programs in key areas like education, science, culture, and communication.

Functioning as the administrative backbone of UNESCO, the Secretariat manages day-to-day operations, coordinates meetings, and supervises the execution of global projects. It transforms policy decisions into actionable programs, facilitates communication among member states, and ensures the efficient functioning of UNESCO's field offices worldwide. Through these efforts, the Secretariat helps UNESCO advance its mission of fostering peace, education, and sustainable development globally.

Education transforms lives and is at the heart of UNESCO's mission to build peace, eradicate poverty and drive sustainable development. It is a human right for all throughout life. The Organization is the only United Nations agency with a mandate to cover all aspects of education. It has been entrusted to lead the Global Education 2030 Agenda through Sustainable Development Goal 4.

UNESCO provides global and regional leadership in education, strengthens education systems worldwide and responds to contemporary global challenges through education with gender equality as an underlying principle. Its work encompasses quality educational development from pre-school to higher education and beyond.

Creating knowledge and understanding through science equips us to find solutions to today's acute economic, social and environmental challenges and to achieving sustainable development and greener societies. As no one country can achieve sustainable development alone, international scientific cooperation contributes, not only to scientific knowledge but also to building peace.

In a complex world confronted with major societal transitions (climate, digital, demographics, inequalities), UNESCO's Social and Human Sciences Sector leverages the contributions that these sciences can make to build inclusive and sustainable economies and societies.

This is done through the management of social transformations and strengthening the science-policy nexus, the ethical governance of emerging technologies, particularly artificial

Peacebuilding: Global Initiatives

intelligence, neurotechnology and climate engineering, and by fostering trust in science and the safety of scientists. The Sector also addresses racism and discrimination, forges intercultural dialogue, empowers youth and women, and deploys the ethical and social impact of sports.

From cherished historic monuments and museums to living heritage practices and contemporary art forms, culture enriches our lives in countless ways and helps build inclusive, innovative and resilient communities.

Protecting and safeguarding the world's cultural and natural heritage and supporting creativity and dynamic cultural sectors are fundamental to addressing the challenges of our time, from climate change to poverty, inequality, the digital divide and ever more complex emergencies and conflicts. UNESCO is convinced that no development can be sustainable without a strong culture component. Indeed, only a human-centred approach to development based on mutual respect and open dialogue among cultures can lead to lasting peace.

UNESCO's Communication and Information Sector (CI Sector) empower key actors to safeguard fundamental human rights, both in online and off-line spaces.

Ocean Science for Sustainable Development

The Intergovernmental Oceanographic Commission (IOC) of UNESCO promotes international cooperation in marine sciences to improve management of the ocean, coasts, and marine resources. The IOC enables its 152 Member States to work together by coordinating programmes in capacity development, ocean observations and services, ocean science, tsunami warning, and ocean literacy. The work of the IOC contributes to the mission of UNESCO to promote the advancement of science and its applications to develop knowledge and capacity, key to economic and social progress and the basis of peace and sustainable development. The IOC is the entity in charge of coordinating the UN Decade of Ocean Science for Sustainable Development 2021-2030 (The Ocean Decade).

Since its inception, UNESCO has recognized Africa's vital role in global peace, security, and prosperity. Priority Africa emphasizes education, culture, science, and communication as key tools to tackle challenges, strengthen national capacities, and celebrate the continent's rich cultural heritage.

By fostering strong partnerships, inclusive policies, and equitable access to knowledge and technologies, UNESCO aims to create an environment that supports innovation and

resilience, empowering African societies to unlock their full potential for a sustainable and prosperous future.

UNESCO and its partners work to provide solutions to reduce inequalities in and through education, to empower women in science and technology for environmental action, to promote inclusion and combat gender-based violence, to bridge the digital gender divide and to support women's empowerment in crisis, emergency and early recovery contexts.

UNESCO is committed to gender equality as a human rights issue and a precondition for sustainable people-centered development. It is at the core of UNESCO's conviction of how to build lasting peace.

Note : *For more information about UNESCO please refer section 12 on UN Entities in Peacebuilding*

14

UNESCO Chair at MIT-WPU for Peace, Human Rights and Democracy

UNESCO has established a chair at MIT World Peace University (MIT WPU) dedicated to promoting peace, human rights, and democracy through interdisciplinary approaches. This Chair holder is revered Prof. Dr. Vishwanath Karad and it is the oldest of its kind in India, embodies a commitment to fostering collaboration between science, culture, education, and peace. Through initiatives such as Peace Studies, Human Rights Education, Democratic Governance research, and Interfaith Dialogue facilitation, the Chair seeks to enhance understanding, promote inclusive governance, foster peace, and encourage tolerance. It offers courses and research projects spanning peace studies, conflict resolution, post-conflict reconstruction, and human rights principles, while also engaging in activities like Heritage Management to preserve shared spaces among diverse communities.

MIT WPU's UNESCO Chair operates at the intersection of various disciplines including leadership, conflict management, engineering, public health, science, pharmacy, computer science, liberal arts, design, media, and photography. Through international conferences, research projects, training programs, and collaborations with other UNESCO Chairs and organizations, the Chair addresses contemporary challenges related to peace, human rights, and democracy. Additionally, it organizes events like the Bhartiya Chhatra Sanasad, National Peacebuilding: Global Initiatives

Legislature Conference, Walk for Peace, Yoga for Peace, and World Peace Prayer, alongside student-led initiatives such as various cultural clubs, fostering a comprehensive approach to promoting peace, human rights, and democracy within and beyond the university campus.

MIT World Peace University (MIT WPU) houses a plethora of student-led social and co-curricular activities that align with the values promoted by its UNESCO Chair for Peace, Human Rights, and Democracy. The university fosters a vibrant atmosphere for community engagement through initiatives such as the Robinhood Army, Science and Spirituality Forum, NSS (National Service Scheme), NCC (National Cadet Corps), and the Youth Red Cross/Blood Donation Camp Club. These groups actively contribute to social welfare and awareness, engaging in activities ranging from blood donation drives to rural immersion programs aimed at water conservation. Furthermore, the Sarpanch Parishad and Green Campus Initiative promote sustainable practices and community development.

In addition to social activities, MIT WPU encourages holistic personal development through a diverse array of co-curricular clubs. These encompass cultural pursuits like drama clubs such as Purushottam and Firodiya Karandak, as well as platforms for expression like the Abhivyakti eloquence club. The university also supports students in exploring their interests and talents through clubs such as the Photography Club, Environmental Club, and Sustainability Club, which raise awareness about conservation and sustainability issues. Moreover, co-curricular clubs like GitHub & GNU, Technocrat'18, and the Entrepreneurship Club provide avenues for students to develop technical skills, highlight projects, and foster innovation. With a wide range of activities spanning social service, cultural expression, personal development, and technical exploration, MIT WPU's vibrant campus community embodies the principles of peace, human rights, and democracy espoused by its UNESCO Chair.

15

United Nations Development Programme (UNDP)

The United Nations Development Programme (UNDP) is one of the principal entities within the United Nations system dedicated to promoting sustainable development worldwide. Established in 1965, UNDP operates in over 170 countries and territories, working to eradicate poverty, reduce inequality, and address the challenges of climate change and environmental degradation. UNDP's mandate encompasses a wide range of areas, including democratic governance, crisis prevention and recovery, sustainable development, and gender Peacebuilding: Global Initiatives

equality.

UNDP supports countries in achieving the Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs) by providing technical assistance, policy advice, and capacity-building support. It works closely with national governments, civil society organizations, and other partners to design and implement development projects tailored to the specific needs and priorities of each country. UNDP's initiatives often focus on areas such as poverty reduction, inclusive economic growth, environmental sustainability, and resilience-building.

In the context of peacebuilding, UNDP plays a crucial role in supporting countries emerging from conflict and transitioning to peace and stability. It assists in the reconstruction of infrastructure, revitalization of local economies, and strengthening of governance institutions. UNDP also promotes reconciliation, social cohesion, and respect for human rights as essential components of sustainable peace. Through its peacebuilding efforts, UNDP contributes to fostering inclusive and resilient societies that are better equipped to withstand future conflicts and crises.

It emphasises on capacity Building: UNDP places a strong emphasis on capacity building, helping countries strengthen their institutional and human capacities to implement sustainable development strategies. This includes training government officials, civil society organizations, and community leaders in areas such as governance, economic development, environmental management, and social inclusion.

Innovation and Technology: UNDP leverages innovation and technology to address development challenges more effectively. It supports initiatives such as digital innovation labs, open data platforms, and technology-driven solutions to promote inclusive development, improve service delivery, and enhance transparency and accountability.

Climate Change: UNDP is actively involved in climate change mitigation and adaptation efforts, working to build resilience in vulnerable communities and support countries in transitioning to low-carbon, climate-resilient development pathways. It supports climate finance mechanisms, renewable energy projects, and climate-smart agriculture initiatives to reduce greenhouse gas emissions and enhance adaptation to climate impacts.

Gender Equality: UNDP is committed to advancing gender equality and women's empowerment as fundamental elements of sustainable development. It supports initiatives to promote women's political participation, economic empowerment, access to education and healthcare, and protection from gender-based violence. UNDP also mainstreams gender considerations across its programs and policies to ensure that they are inclusive and

responsive to the needs and priorities of both women and men.

Humanitarian Response: In addition to its development work, UNDP plays a role in humanitarian response efforts, particularly in crisis and conflict-affected contexts. It provides support for early recovery, livelihood restoration, and community resilience-building in the aftermath of disasters and conflicts, helping affected populations rebuild their lives and communities.

Some Facts:

Global Reach: UNDP operates in 170 countries and territories, making it one of the largest development organizations in the world. Its extensive presence allows UNDP to work closely with national governments, local communities, and other stakeholders to address development challenges at both the global and local levels.

Funding: UNDP receives funding from various sources, including voluntary contributions from member states, multilateral institutions, private sector partners, and philanthropic organizations. These funds support UNDP's diverse range of programs and initiatives across different thematic areas and regions.

Human Development Reports: UNDP publishes the Human Development Report (HDR) annually, which provides in-depth analysis of global development trends, challenges, and opportunities. The HDR ranks countries based on the Human Development Index (HDI), which measures progress in terms of life expectancy, education, and income levels.

Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs): UNDP plays a key role in supporting countries in achieving the Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs) adopted by the United Nations in 2015. It provides technical assistance, policy advice, and financial support to help countries integrate the SDGs into their national development plans and policies.

Partnerships: UNDP collaborates with a wide range of partners, including governments, civil society organizations, academia, and the private sector, to leverage expertise, resources, and networks for sustainable development. These partnerships enhance UNDP's effectiveness and impact in addressing complex development challenges.

Response to COVID-19: During the COVID-19 pandemic, UNDP has been actively involved in supporting countries' response and recovery efforts. It has provided technical assistance, policy advice, and financial support for health systems strengthening social protection measures, economic recovery, and resilience-building in the face of the pandemic's socio-economic impacts.

Humanitarian Awards: UNDP has received numerous awards and accolades for its contributions to development and humanitarian efforts. These include the Nobel Peace Prize, which was awarded jointly to the United Nations and its Secretary-General, Kofi Annan, in 2001, recognizing their work in promoting peace, development, and human rights globally.

16

United Nations High Commissioner for Refugees UNHCR

UNHCR, the Office of the United Nations High Commissioner for Refugees, stands as a cornerstone institution in addressing the multifaceted challenges faced by refugees, forcibly displaced communities, and stateless individuals worldwide. Established in 1950 in response to the aftermath of World War II, UNHCR's mandate has evolved over time, expanding beyond its original focus on European refugees to encompass global crises triggered by conflicts, decolonization, and inter-ethnic tensions. Its role gained prominence with the ratification of the 1951 Refugee Convention and the subsequent 1967 Protocol, which broadened the scope of its assistance to refugees irrespective of their geographical origins.

The agency's mission involves providing protection, shelter, healthcare, and emergency relief to those in need, as well as advocating for policies that uphold the rights and dignity of refugees. Over the years, UNHCR's operations have extended to encompass not only refugees but also internally displaced persons (IDPs), reflecting its commitment to address broader humanitarian crises beyond traditional refugee scenarios. With a budget that has grown exponentially over the decades, largely sourced from voluntary contributions by member states, UNHCR has become one of the largest UN agencies by expenditure, evidencing the global recognition of the importance of its work.

UNHCR's effectiveness is underscored by its operational presence in over 138 countries, where it aids and services to millions of individuals in refugee camps and urban settings. Its efforts have been instrumental in mitigating the impact of conflicts and displacement on vulnerable populations, despite facing challenges such as restrictive refugee policies and inadequate resources. Notably, UNHCR's engagement extends beyond humanitarian assistance, as it collaborates with other UN agencies and international organizations to address the root causes of displacement and promote durable solutions.

The agency's commitment to innovation is evident through initiatives such as the ProGres database, which utilizes biometric data to enhance aid distribution and combat fraud. Additionally, UNHCR employs various strategies to raise public awareness and mobilize support for refugees, including media campaigns, public events, and advocacy efforts. Its role in fostering cooperation within the United Nations system, as demonstrated by its participation in high-level summits and partnerships with other agencies, underscores the collective responsibility to uphold the rights and well-being of refugees on a global scale.

UNHCR's journey reflects a steadfast dedication to its mandate of providing protection and assistance to refugees worldwide. As it continues to navigate complex humanitarian challenges and adapt to evolving crises, UNHCR remains a beacon of hope for millions of individuals fleeing persecution, conflict, and human rights abuses, embodying the principles of solidarity, compassion, and human dignity upheld by the United Nations.

Since its inception in 1954, the UNHCR Nansen Refugee Award has served as an esteemed recognition of individuals or organizations demonstrating exceptional dedication and service to refugees, displaced persons, or stateless individuals. This prestigious award underscores the profound impact made by recipients in advancing the cause of humanitarianism and promoting the rights and well-being of vulnerable populations worldwide.

In addition to the Nansen Refugee Award, the UNHCR itself has been honoured with several prestigious accolades in acknowledgment of its pivotal role in addressing global refugee crises. Notably, the agency was awarded the Nobel Peace Prize twice, in 1954 and 1981, for its relentless efforts to provide protection, assistance, and advocacy for refugees across the globe. These Nobel Peace Prizes stand as testament to the unwavering commitment of UNHCR and its staff to uphold the principles of peace, solidarity, and human rights in the face of adversity.

Furthermore, the UNHCR's significant contributions to international cooperation and humanitarian assistance have been recognized through various other awards and honors. In 1991, the agency was bestowed with the prestigious Prince of Asturias Award for International Cooperation, further highlighting its indispensable role in fostering solidarity and collaboration on a global scale. Additionally, in 2015, the UNHCR was honoured with the Indira Gandhi Prize, underscoring its enduring legacy of service and dedication to the cause of refugees and displaced persons.

These accolades not only reflect the exceptional achievements of the UNHCR and its partners

but also serve to inspire continued efforts towards alleviating the suffering of those affected by displacement and advocating for their rights and dignity. As the global refugee crisis persists, these honors serve as reminders of the collective responsibility to stand in solidarity with the most vulnerable members of society and work towards a more inclusive and compassionate world.

17

UN Women

United Nations Entity for Gender Equality and the Empowerment of Women

UN Women is the UN organization dedicated to gender equality and the empowerment of women. A global champion for women and girls, UN Women was established to accelerate progress on meeting their needs worldwide.

Headquartered at the United Nations in New York, UN Women promotes women's empowerment, rights and gender equality globally, as well as within and among individual countries through a network of regional, country and liaison offices.

Fifteen years ago, UN Women was created with a bold mission: to become the United Nation's powerhouse for gender equality and women's empowerment. Rooted in the energy and vision of women's movements and governments, shaped by the realities of our time, UN Women was born not just to exist – but to spark real and lasting change for all women and girls.

In 2025, UN Women, the youngest UN organization, proudly celebrates its 15th year. Today we are a global force **for women's rights and gender equality**, driving change in 109 countries, delivering for four billion women and girls.

The provision of mediation and other skills training is vital for the successful implementation of UN Security Council Resolution 1325 on Women Peace and Security (WPS) and successive resolutions calling for women's engagement in conflict prevention and peacebuilding, and their protection from sexual and other human rights violations. Because of the deepening focus on women in conflict, peace and security, this has been an area of rapid development for UN Women with growing demands for capacity-building, technical

expertise and programming to implement the WPS agenda. UN Women raises awareness among mediators and parties to conflict of the strategic importance of including women in peace negotiations. Through a partnership with the Peacebuilding Commission and the Peace Building Support Office (PBSO), UN Women also works to ensure that an agreed minimum of 15 per cent of funds for post-conflict recovery is spent on projects that enhance gender equality. UN Women also supports gender-sensitive security sector reform and demobilization and reintegration of ex-combatants, as well as efforts to increase the numbers of women in post-conflict governance institutions.

In its normative work with Member States, UN Women has provided technical support to approximately half of the WPS National Action Plans (NAPs) drafted thus far, ensuring that they have concrete targets, resources for implementation and monitoring plans. More than two-dozen countries are currently drafting and negotiating NAPs. UN Women is also coordinating a new network of national WPS focal points that were established in response to the findings of the high-level review on the implementation of Resolution 1325. In February 2016, the UN launched a pooled funding mechanism called the Women's Peace and Humanitarian Fund (WPHF) that aims to stimulate a significant increase in the financing of women's participation, leadership and empowerment in humanitarian response and peace and security settings. UN Women serves as its secretariat. UN Women is also responsible for the Annual Report of the Secretary-General on Women, Peace and Security to the UN Security Council and chairs the Inter-Agency Standing Committee on Women, Peace and Security. It also acts as the secretariat for the Security Council's Informal Expert Group (IEG) on Women, Peace and Security, which was established in response to Resolution 2242 (2015).

In the first half of 2016, the IEG briefed the Council about the situation of women in Afghanistan, Central African Republic, Iraq and Mali. The Executive Director of UN Women also regularly briefs the UN Security Council, while the Peace and Security section provides technical briefings to new Security Council members. Today, UN Women supports governments and civil society in over fifty countries to help implement the women, peace and security agenda through country programming and partnerships with a broad range of stakeholders.

18

Regional Organisations and Peacebuilding

Regional organizations play a pivotal role in peacebuilding efforts, leveraging their proximity, cultural understanding, and regional expertise to address conflict dynamics effectively. These organizations serve as crucial platforms for dialogue, cooperation, and conflict resolution among neighbouring states, fostering trust and confidence-building measures that are essential for sustainable peace. With their in-depth knowledge of local contexts and dynamics, regional organizations can tailor peacebuilding strategies to the specific needs and challenges of their respective regions, ensuring that interventions are contextually relevant and culturally sensitive. Moreover, regional organizations often possess unique resources and capabilities that complement those of international actors, enabling them to respond swiftly and effectively to emerging conflicts and crises. By promoting regional cooperation, economic integration, and political dialogue, regional organizations contribute to the prevention of conflict, the management of disputes, and the consolidation of peace across borders. Examples of such organizations include the African Union (AU), the European Union (EU), the Organization of American States (OAS), and the Association of Southeast Asian Nations (ASEAN), each playing a vital role in advancing peace and stability within their respective regions. Through collaboration with national governments, civil society organizations, and international partners, regional organizations continue to be instrumental in shaping regional security architectures and promoting inclusive and sustainable peacebuilding efforts.

Regional organizations serve as essential mechanisms for conflict prevention, management, and resolution due to their deep-rooted understanding of regional dynamics and their ability to mobilize resources and political will. By fostering dialogue and cooperation among member states, regional organizations create platforms for peaceful negotiation and consensus-building, reducing the likelihood of violent conflicts. Moreover, these organizations often facilitate the implementation of peace agreements and provide ongoing support for post-conflict reconstruction and development efforts. Through their mediation and peacebuilding initiatives, regional organizations contribute to building trust and confidence among neighbouring states, laying the groundwork for enduring peace and stability in volatile regions.

Regional organizations play a critical role in addressing transnational security threats, such as

Peacebuilding: Global Initiatives

terrorism, organized crime, and illicit trafficking, which can undermine peace and stability across borders. By coordinating joint actions and pooling resources, regional organizations enhance the effectiveness of counterterrorism and law enforcement efforts, mitigating the spread of violence and instability. Additionally, regional cooperation mechanisms enable member states to address common challenges related to environmental degradation, public health crises, and economic disparities, which can exacerbate tensions and trigger conflicts. Through their multi-dimensional approach to security, regional organizations contribute to comprehensive peacebuilding efforts that address the root causes of conflict and promote sustainable development and prosperity in the region.

19

Organisation of African Union and Organisation of American States

Organisation of African Union

The Organization of African Union (OAU), established on May 25, 1963, marked a significant milestone in Africa's quest for unity, independence, and self-determination. Founded in Addis Ababa, Ethiopia, the OAU emerged amidst the wave of decolonization sweeping across the African continent, with the primary objective of promoting unity and solidarity among African states and supporting the struggle against colonialism, apartheid, and racial discrimination. The Organization of African Union (OAU) had various member states throughout its existence. At its peak, it had 53 member states, encompassing almost all African countries. However, the specific list of member states changed over time due to factors such as independence movements, political changes, and regional conflicts. Some of the member states of the OAU included Algeria, Angola, Egypt, Ethiopia, Ghana, Kenya, Nigeria, South Africa, Sudan, Tanzania, Uganda, Zambia, and Zimbabwe, among others. It had provided a platform for African leaders to coordinate their efforts, amplify their voices on the global stage, and address common challenges facing the continent. The headquarters of the Organization of African Union (OAU), now known as the African Union (AU), is in Addis Ababa, Ethiopia.

One of the pivotal achievements of the OAU was the adoption of the OAU Liberation Committee, which provided material, diplomatic, and moral support to liberation movements fighting against colonial rule and apartheid in Africa. This solidarity extended to the liberation struggles in countries such as South Africa, Namibia, Zimbabwe, and Angola, Peacebuilding: Global Initiatives

where the OAU played a crucial role in mobilizing international support and solidarity for the oppressed peoples of Africa. Additionally, the OAU played a pivotal role in mediating conflicts and promoting peace and stability on the continent, including in countries such as Congo, Nigeria, and Somalia.

In 2002, the OAU was succeeded by the African Union (AU), which builds on the OAU's legacy while expanding its scope to address new challenges and opportunities in Africa. The AU's Constitutive Act, adopted in Durban, South Africa, in July 2000, outlines the organization's principles, objectives, and structures, including the establishment of the Peace and Security Council (PSC) to promote peace, security, and stability in Africa. Since its inception, the AU has been actively engaged in conflict prevention, mediation, and peacekeeping efforts, deploying peace support operations in countries such as Burundi, Darfur, Somalia, and Mali, to address complex security challenges and promote inclusive and sustainable peace.

The AU plays a vital role in advancing the continent's development agenda, with a focus on promoting economic integration, infrastructure development, and sustainable growth through initiatives such as the African Continental Free Trade Area (AfCFTA) and the Agenda 2063 framework for Africa's socio-economic transformation. By fostering continental unity, solidarity, and cooperation, the AU aims to realize Africa's vision of a prosperous, peaceful, and united continent, where all people can live in dignity, freedom, and prosperity.

The AU is committed to addressing the root causes of conflict and instability in Africa, including poverty, inequality, and underdevelopment. Through its Agenda 2063 framework for Africa's socio-economic transformation, the AU aims to accelerate inclusive and sustainable development, promote economic diversification, and harness Africa's natural resources for the benefit of its people. The AU also champions initiatives such as the New Partnership for Africa's Development (NEPAD) and the Programme for Infrastructure Development in Africa (PIDA), which aim to enhance infrastructure connectivity, facilitate trade and investment, and promote regional integration and cooperation for shared prosperity.

Organisation of American States

The Organization of American States (OAS), founded in 1948, stands as the premier multilateral organization in the Western Hemisphere, encompassing 35 member states from North, Central, and South America, as well as the Caribbean. These member states include Argentina, Bahamas, Barbados, Belize, Bolivia, Brazil, Canada, Chile, Colombia, Costa Rica,

Cuba, Dominica, Dominican Republic, Ecuador, El Salvador, Grenada, Guatemala, Guyana, Haiti, Honduras, Jamaica, Mexico, Nicaragua, Panama, Paraguay, Peru, Saint Kitts and Nevis, Saint Lucia, Saint Vincent and the Grenadines, Suriname, Trinidad and Tobago, United States of America, Uruguay, and Venezuela. The headquarters of the Organization of American States (OAS) is in Washington, D.C., United States.

The OAS serves as a forum for political dialogue, cooperation, and collaboration on a wide range of issues, including democracy, human rights, security, development, and sustainable economic growth. It operates through various bodies and mechanisms, including the General Assembly, the Permanent Council, and specialized agencies, such as the Inter-American Commission on Human Rights and the Inter-American Drug Abuse Control Commission.

One of the core missions of the OAS is to promote and defend democracy across the Americas. The organization played a critical role in developing the Inter-American Democratic Charter, adopted in 2001, which outlines principles and mechanisms for the defence of democracy, including collective action in response to threats to democratic governance. The OAS has also been involved in monitoring elections, promoting good governance, and supporting democratic institutions in member states. Additionally, the OAS has facilitated conflict resolution and mediation efforts in the region, including in countries such as Venezuela, Haiti, and Nicaragua, where political crises have arisen.

The OAS is also engaged in addressing security challenges in the Americas, including transnational threats such as drug trafficking, organized crime, and corruption. Through initiatives such as the Inter-American Convention against Corruption and the Inter-American Drug Abuse Control Commission, the OAS supports member states in strengthening their legal frameworks, enhancing law enforcement capacities, and promoting regional cooperation to combat these challenges. Furthermore, the OAS plays a key role in promoting human rights and social justice across the Western Hemisphere, through its Inter-American Commission on Human Rights, which monitors human rights situations, investigates abuses, and advocates for the protection of fundamental rights and freedoms.

In recent years, the OAS has faced challenges in addressing political polarization, economic inequality, and social unrest in the region. However, the organization remains committed to its founding principles of peace, democracy, and solidarity, working collaboratively with member states and regional partners to promote inclusive development, advance human rights, and strengthen democracy in the Americas.

The Organization of American States (OAS) has made significant contributions to advancing

social and economic development in the Americas through various programs and initiatives. One notable example is the Inter-American Development Bank (IDB), which operates as an autonomous specialized agency of the OAS. The IDB provides financing, technical assistance, and policy advice to support projects and programs aimed at reducing poverty, promoting sustainable development, and fostering inclusive growth across the region. Through its partnership with the OAS, the IDB plays a critical role in addressing key development challenges, such as infrastructure development, education, healthcare, and environmental sustainability.

The OAS has been at the forefront of efforts to address environmental issues and promote sustainable development in the Americas. The organization established the Inter-American Committee on Natural Disaster Reduction (IACNDR) to coordinate regional efforts to mitigate the impact of natural disasters and build resilience in vulnerable communities. Additionally, the OAS promotes cooperation on environmental conservation, climate change mitigation, and biodiversity preservation through initiatives such as the Inter-American Biodiversity Information Network (IABIN) and the Inter-American Commission on Sustainable Development (CIDS). By facilitating dialogue and cooperation among member states, the OAS contributes to the protection of the region's natural resources and the promotion of sustainable development practices.

The OAS plays a critical role in promoting cultural exchange and preserving the rich diversity of cultures and traditions in the Americas. The organization supports initiatives to promote intercultural dialogue, cultural heritage preservation, and artistic expression, recognizing the important role of culture in fostering social cohesion, identity, and belonging. Through programs such as the Inter-American Cultural Council (CIC) and the Inter-American Program for the Promotion and Protection of the Rights of Indigenous Peoples (IACHR), the OAS promotes cultural diversity and celebrates the unique contributions of indigenous peoples, Afro-descendants, and other marginalized communities to the cultural richness of the region.

20

European Union

The European Union (EU) stands as one of the most significant regional organizations globally, comprising 27 member states across Europe. These member states are Austria, Belgium, Bulgaria, Croatia, Cyprus, Czech Republic, Denmark, Estonia, Finland, France, Germany, Greece, Hungary, Ireland, Italy, Latvia, Lithuania, Luxembourg, Malta, Netherlands, Poland, Portugal, Romania, Slovakia, Slovenia, Spain, and Sweden. Each member state participates in the EU's decision-making processes, contributing to the development and implementation of common policies and objectives aimed at fostering cooperation, economic integration, and peace among European nations.

Established in the aftermath of World War II, the EU was founded on the principles of peace, prosperity, and cooperation, with the primary goal of preventing future conflicts and promoting economic integration among European nations. The European Union (EU) has its main administrative headquarters in Brussels, Belgium. This complex is commonly referred to as the European Quarter and houses most EU institutions, including the European Commission, the Council of the European Union, and the European Parliament. Additionally, the European Central Bank (ECB) is in Frankfurt, Germany, and the European Court of Justice (ECJ) is situated in Luxembourg City, Luxembourg. These institutions play critical roles in shaping EU policies, legislation, and governance across member states. While Brussels serves as the central hub for EU administration, various other EU agencies and bodies are dispersed across different member states, focusing on specific areas such as education, environment, health, and safety.

The EU's precursor, the European Coal, and Steel Community (ECSC), laid the groundwork for European integration by pooling coal and steel resources to ensure economic interdependence and prevent the reemergence of war. Over the decades, the EU has evolved into a complex political and economic union, characterized by shared sovereignty, common policies, and supranational institutions, such as the European Commission, the European Parliament, and the European Court of Justice.

One of the EU's key achievements is the establishment of the European Single Market, which allows for the free movement of goods, services, capital, and people across member states. By breaking down trade barriers and harmonizing regulations, the Single Market has facilitated economic growth, fostered competition, and enhanced consumer choice, benefiting both businesses and citizens throughout Europe. Additionally, the EU has played a pivotal role in promoting peace and stability in Europe through its enlargement process, which has welcomed new member states from Central and Eastern Europe since the end of the Cold

War. By integrating former Eastern Bloc countries into the EU, the organization has helped consolidate democracy, promote respect for human rights, and strengthen the rule of law across the continent.

The EU has emerged as a global leader in addressing transnational challenges such as climate change, migration, and terrorism through its common policies and collective action. The EU's commitment to environmental sustainability is evidenced by initiatives such as the European Green Deal, which aims to achieve climate neutrality by 2050 and transition to a more sustainable and circular economy. In response to the migration crisis, the EU has implemented measures to manage migration flows, enhance border security, and support countries on the frontlines of migration routes. Additionally, the EU has intensified cooperation on counterterrorism, intelligence-sharing, and law enforcement to combat the threat posed by extremist groups and terrorist organizations operating within and beyond its borders.

The European Union (EU) has been instrumental in fostering cultural exchange, social cohesion, and cross-border cooperation among its member states. Programs such as Erasmus+, which provides opportunities for students, teachers, and young professionals to study, work, and volunteer abroad, have facilitated intercultural dialogue, promoted linguistic diversity, and fostered a sense of European identity among citizens. Additionally, the EU has supported initiatives to preserve cultural heritage, promote artistic expression, and celebrate the cultural richness and diversity of Europe through programs such as the European Capitals of Culture and the Creative Europe framework. By investing in cultural exchange and cooperation, the EU strengthens social bonds, enhances mutual understanding, and promotes solidarity among its diverse member states and citizens.

The EU has also played a crucial role in promoting human rights, democracy, and the rule of law both within its borders and beyond. The EU's Charter of Fundamental Rights enshrines key civil, political, economic, and social rights for EU citizens, while the European Court of Human Rights ensures their protection through judicial oversight. Through its external action, the EU supports democracy promotion, human rights defenders, and civil society organizations around the world, advocating for democratic governance, electoral integrity, and respect for human rights in partner countries. The EU has also established mechanisms such as the European Instrument for Democracy and Human Rights (EIDHR) to provide financial and technical support for democracy-building efforts and the protection of human rights worldwide.

The EU is committed to promoting sustainable development and addressing global challenges such as poverty, inequality, and climate change through its external cooperation policies and programs. The EU is the world's largest donor of development assistance, providing support to partner countries in areas such as education, healthcare, infrastructure, and environmental protection. Through initiatives such as the European Development Fund (EDF) and the Instrument for Pre-accession Assistance (IPA), the EU supports the economic and social development of neighbouring countries and regions, contributing to poverty reduction, social inclusion, and sustainable growth. Additionally, the EU is a leading advocate for multilateralism and global cooperation, working with international partners to advance the implementation of the United Nations Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs) and address pressing global challenges through collective action.

Select Cases and Approach of EU

In addressing various challenges, the European Union (EU) has employed a multifaceted approach that combines diplomatic efforts, economic incentives, and political engagement. One such case is the EU's approach to the conflict in the Western Balkans. Through initiatives such as the Stabilization and Association Process (SAP) and the European Integration Agenda, the EU has encouraged reforms, reconciliation, and regional cooperation among countries in the region. By offering the prospect of EU membership and financial assistance, the EU has incentivized political elites to undertake necessary reforms, including democratization, rule of law, and minority rights protection. Furthermore, the EU has played a mediation role in resolving disputes and promoting dialogue between conflicting parties, facilitating confidence-building measures and peacebuilding efforts in the region.

Another case where the EU has employed its approach effectively is in its response to the migration crisis. Facing unprecedented levels of irregular migration and refugee flows, the EU has adopted a comprehensive approach that combines border management, asylum policy reform, and cooperation with third countries. Through initiatives such as the European Agenda on Migration and the EU-Turkey Statement, the EU has sought to address the root causes of migration, strengthen external borders, and enhance cooperation with transit and origin countries. Additionally, the EU has provided financial and technical assistance to frontline states and supported efforts to improve reception conditions, asylum procedures, and integration policies for refugees and migrants.

The EU has demonstrated its commitment to promoting peace and stability in conflict-affected regions through its crisis management and peacebuilding efforts. In cases such as the

conflict in Ukraine, the EU has deployed civilian missions, provided financial assistance, and facilitated diplomatic negotiations to support conflict resolution and reconciliation efforts. Through initiatives such as the European Neighbourhood Policy and the Eastern Partnership, the EU has offered political and economic support to countries in the Eastern European region, promoting reforms, democratic governance, and sustainable development. Additionally, the EU has leveraged its influence and diplomatic channels to facilitate dialogue and negotiation processes, working closely with international partners such as the United Nations and the Organization for Security and Co-operation in Europe (OSCE) to advance peace and stability in the region.

Another case where the European Union (EU) has implemented its approach effectively is in its response to climate change and environmental sustainability. Recognizing the urgency of addressing climate change, the EU has adopted ambitious targets and policies to reduce greenhouse gas emissions, transition to renewable energy sources, and promote sustainable development practices. Through initiatives such as the European Green Deal and the Paris Agreement, the EU has committed to becoming carbon-neutral by 2050 and leading the global effort to combat climate change. Furthermore, the EU provides financial support and technical assistance to developing countries to help them adapt to the impacts of climate change and transition to low-carbon economies. By championing climate action and promoting international cooperation, the EU seeks to mitigate the effects of climate change, protect the environment, and ensure a sustainable future for generations to come.

The EU has employed its approach in promoting democracy, human rights, and good governance in partner countries around the world. Through its external action policies and instruments, such as the European Neighbourhood Policy (ENP) and the European Instrument for Democracy and Human Rights (EIDHR), the EU supports civil society organizations, human rights defenders, and democratic institutions in countries facing political repression, authoritarianism, and human rights violations. By providing financial assistance, capacity-building support, and political advocacy, the EU helps to strengthen democratic governance, promote respect for human rights, and advance the rule of law in partner countries. Furthermore, the EU engages in political dialogue and diplomatic efforts to address electoral integrity, civic participation, and institutional reforms, fostering democratic transitions and democratic consolidation in regions facing political challenges.

The EU has demonstrated its approach in addressing global health challenges, such as the COVID-19 pandemic. In response to the pandemic, the EU has coordinated a collective

response, mobilizing resources, sharing expertise, and facilitating cooperation among member states to combat the spread of the virus, mitigate its impact, and accelerate vaccine development and distribution. Through initiatives such as the EU Vaccines Strategy and the European Health Union, the EU has secured vaccine doses, invested in research and development, and supported vaccination campaigns to ensure equitable access to vaccines for all EU citizens. Additionally, the EU has provided financial assistance and technical support to partner countries to strengthen healthcare systems, enhance pandemic preparedness, and address the socio- economic consequences of the pandemic. By promoting solidarity, cooperation, and multilateralism, the EU contributes to global efforts to overcome the COVID-19 crisis and build back better for a more resilient and sustainable future.

21

South Asian Association for Regional Cooperation (SAARC)

The South Asian Association for Regional Cooperation (SAARC) is a vital intergovernmental organization consisting of eight member states in South Asia. These member countries include Afghanistan, Bangladesh, Bhutan, India, Maldives, Nepal, Pakistan, and Sri Lanka. SAARC aims to promote regional cooperation and development among its members through various initiatives and programs covering areas such as trade, economic growth, social progress, cultural development, and environmental protection. The head office of SAARC is the SAARC Secretariat. Located in Kathmandu, Nepal, the Secretariat serves as the administrative center of the organization. It is responsible for coordinating the implementation of decisions made by the member states, organizing meetings and summits, managing the day-to-day operations of SAARC, and facilitating communication and collaboration among member countries. The Secretariat plays a crucial role in advancing regional cooperation and addressing common challenges faced by the South Asian region. Through regular summits and collaborative efforts, SAARC strives to address common challenges and foster closer ties among South Asian nations for the betterment of the region.

South Asian Association for Regional Cooperation, despite its potential, has struggled to fully

realize its objectives due to various factors. One such challenge lies in the persistent bilateral disputes among member states, which have hindered effective regional cooperation and integration. The longstanding tensions between India and Pakistan, for instance, have often resulted in stalled initiatives and limited progress within SAARC. Additionally, geopolitical rivalries and security concerns have further complicated efforts to foster meaningful dialogue and collaboration among member states. These challenges underscore the need for greater political will, diplomatic engagement, and conflict resolution mechanisms to overcome bilateral disputes and unlock the region's potential for cooperation.

Socioeconomic disparities and development gaps among SAARC member states pose significant challenges to achieving inclusive and sustainable growth in the region. While some countries, such as India and Sri Lanka, have experienced rapid economic growth and development, others, including Afghanistan and Nepal, continue to grapple with poverty, inequality, and underdevelopment. Addressing these disparities requires concerted efforts to promote inclusive development, enhance social welfare, and bridge infrastructure gaps across the region. Additionally, promoting trade, investment, and economic cooperation through initiatives such as SAFTA and the SAARC Development Fund can help stimulate growth, create employment opportunities, and alleviate poverty in South Asia.

The COVID-19 pandemic has highlighted the importance of regional cooperation and solidarity in addressing common challenges and crises. The pandemic has severely impacted the South Asian region, disrupting economies, straining healthcare systems, and exacerbating social vulnerabilities. In response, SAARC member states have sought to enhance cooperation and coordination to combat the spread of the virus, share medical supplies, and support each other's pandemic response efforts. However, the pandemic has also underscored the need for greater resilience, preparedness, and collaboration in addressing future health emergencies and other transnational threats in the region.

The South Asian Association for Regional Cooperation (SAARC) plays a significant role in mitigating conflict in South Asia through various mechanisms and initiatives aimed at fostering dialogue, cooperation, and confidence-building among member states. One key aspect of SAARC's conflict mitigation efforts is its promotion of dialogue and diplomacy as a means of resolving disputes and addressing contentious issues. Through platforms such as SAARC summits and ministerial meetings, member states can engage in constructive dialogue, exchange views, and explore potential solutions to longstanding conflicts and tensions in the region.

SAARC facilitates regional cooperation and collaboration in areas such as trade, economic development, and people-to-people exchanges, which can help build trust and confidence among member states and contribute to conflict prevention and resolution. Initiatives such as the South Asian Free Trade Area (SAFTA) and the SAARC Development Fund (SDF) promote economic interdependence and mutual benefits, thereby reducing incentives for conflict and fostering a conducive environment for peace and stability in the region. Additionally, SAARC supports cultural exchanges, educational programs, and youth initiatives that promote understanding, tolerance, and cooperation among diverse communities in South Asia.

SAARC serves as a platform for addressing common challenges and threats facing the region, including terrorism, extremism, and organized crime. Through mechanisms such as the SAARC Convention on Suppression of Terrorism and the SAARC Regional Convention on Narcotic Drugs and Psychotropic Substances, member states collaborate on enhancing security cooperation, intelligence-sharing, and law enforcement efforts to combat transnational threats and uphold regional peace and security. By fostering collaboration and coordination among member states, SAARC contributes to building resilience against security threats and promoting a culture of peace and cooperation in South Asia.

It has established a university which known as SAARC situated in New Delhi to promote collaboration in higher education and research among its member countries. Established in 1998, the university aims to facilitate academic exchange, foster regional integration, and address common challenges through education and research. Offering undergraduate, postgraduate, and doctoral programs across diverse disciplines, SAARC University provides students and scholars from SAARC nations with opportunities for cross-cultural learning and research collaboration. Despite facing challenges in its establishment and operation, efforts persist to fully realize SAARC University's potential as a leading institution for advancing education, innovation, and regional cooperation in South Asia.

While SAARC faces numerous challenges, including bilateral disputes, development disparities, the impact of the COVID-19 pandemic, and effectively addressing conflicts and tensions in South Asia, the organization remains a crucial forum for promoting regional cooperation, dialogue, and development. By addressing these challenges and leveraging collective strengths, SAARC member states can unlock the region's potential for inclusive and sustainable growth, peace, and prosperity. Strengthening institutional mechanisms, enhancing political dialogue, and promoting people-to-people exchanges will be essential to

realizing SAARC's vision of a more integrated, prosperous, and peaceful South Asia. Despite the obstacles, SAARC plays a crucial role in promoting dialogue, cooperation, and confidence- building among member states. By facilitating diplomatic engagement, fostering regional cooperation, and addressing common challenges, SAARC contributes to conflict mitigation efforts and promotes peace and stability in the region. Enhancing institutional capacity, strengthening political dialogue, and promoting inclusive development will be essential to realizing SAARC's potential as a catalyst for peace and cooperation in South Asia.

22

ASEAN

The Association of Southeast Asian Nations (ASEAN) stands as a regional organization fostering cooperation, economic integration, and political dialogue among its ten member states. Established in 1967, ASEAN comprises Brunei, Cambodia, Indonesia, Laos, Malaysia, Myanmar, the Philippines, Singapore, Thailand, and Vietnam. The head office of ASEAN, the Association of Southeast Asian Nations, is known as the ASEAN Secretariat. It is located in Jakarta, Indonesia. The ASEAN Secretariat serves as the administrative center and coordinating body for the organization. It facilitates communication and collaboration among ASEAN member states, implements decisions and policies set forth by the ASEAN leaders, and oversees the organization's various initiatives and programs aimed at promoting regional cooperation and integration. The ASEAN Secretariat plays a pivotal role in advancing ASEAN's objectives of peace, stability, economic growth, and prosperity in the Southeast Asian region.

Throughout its history, ASEAN has played a pivotal role in promoting peace, stability, and prosperity in Southeast Asia. One of ASEAN's key achievements is the establishment of the ASEAN Economic Community (AEC), which aims to create a single market and production base, facilitating the free flow of goods, services, and skilled labour across member states. Since its inception, ASEAN has become a dynamic economic powerhouse, with a combined GDP exceeding \$3 trillion and a population of over 650 million people.

ASEAN has been instrumental in promoting regional security and stability through dialogue, confidence-building measures, and cooperative frameworks. The organization's commitment to the principles of non-interference, consensus-building, and peaceful dispute resolution has helped prevent conflicts and tensions from escalating in Southeast Asia. Moreover, ASEAN has established mechanisms such as the ASEAN Regional Forum (ARF) and the East Asia

Summit (EAS) to foster dialogue and cooperation on security issues among ASEAN member states and their external partners. These platforms provide opportunities for ASEAN to engage with major powers, including the United States, China, and Japan, on regional security challenges such as maritime disputes, terrorism, and non-proliferation.

ASEAN has been at the forefront of promoting environmental sustainability and addressing climate change in Southeast Asia. Through initiatives such as the ASEAN Agreement on Transboundary Haze Pollution and the ASEAN Framework Agreement on Climate Change, member states collaborate on mitigating environmental degradation, preserving biodiversity, and promoting sustainable development in the region. ASEAN also plays a leading role in coordinating disaster management efforts, humanitarian assistance, and emergency response mechanisms to address natural disasters and climate-related hazards, such as typhoons, floods, and droughts, which frequently affect Southeast Asia.

ASEAN remains a key driver of regional integration, cooperation, and development in Southeast Asia. With its focus on economic integration, regional security, environmental sustainability, and disaster management, ASEAN continues to contribute to the stability, prosperity, and resilience of the region. As Southeast Asia's geopolitical importance grows and global challenges intensify, ASEAN's role as a strategic forum for dialogue, cooperation, and partnership will become increasingly crucial in shaping the region's future and fostering a peaceful and prosperous Southeast Asia.

ASEAN's success in promoting regional peace and stability is evident in its efforts to manage and resolve territorial disputes among member states. The organization has facilitated diplomatic negotiations and encouraged dialogue to peacefully address competing territorial claims in the South China Sea, a strategically significant waterway rich in natural resources. While disputes persist, ASEAN has played a crucial role in preventing conflicts and maintaining stability in the region by advocating for the peaceful resolution of disputes based on international law, including the United Nations Convention on the Law of the Sea (UNCLOS). Additionally, ASEAN has promoted the adoption of the Code of Conduct in the South China Sea (COC) to manage tensions and prevent the escalation of conflicts, demonstrating the organization's commitment to regional peace and security.

ASEAN has prioritized cooperation in addressing transnational challenges such as terrorism, trafficking, and cybercrime. Recognizing the interconnected nature of security threats, ASEAN member states have established mechanisms such as the ASEAN Convention on Counter-Terrorism and the ASEAN Plan of Action to Combat Transnational Crime to

enhance coordination and cooperation in combating these threats. Through joint exercises, capacity-building programs, and information-sharing initiatives, ASEAN strengthens regional resilience against security risks and promotes collective responses to emerging challenges. Additionally, ASEAN fosters dialogue and cooperation with external partners, including the United Nations and regional organizations, to address shared security concerns and promote peace and stability in Southeast Asia.

Furthermore, ASEAN has made significant strides in promoting social and cultural cooperation among its member states. The organization's commitment to people-centered development is reflected in initiatives such as the ASEAN Socio-Cultural Community Blueprint and the ASEAN Strategic Framework on Social Welfare and Development. These initiatives aim to enhance cooperation in areas such as education, healthcare, gender equality, and cultural preservation, promoting social inclusion, human development, and community resilience in Southeast Asia. Additionally, ASEAN promotes cultural exchange, tourism, and intercultural dialogue through programs such as the ASEAN Cultural Heritage Award and the ASEAN Youth Exchange Program, fostering greater understanding and appreciation among the diverse peoples of the region.

In conclusion, ASEAN's multifaceted approach to promoting peace, stability, and prosperity in Southeast Asia has yielded significant benefits for member states and the region. Through its commitment to dialogue, cooperation, and consensus-building, ASEAN has become a driving force for regional integration and development, facilitating economic growth, social progress, and cultural exchange among its member states. As Southeast Asia continues to navigate geopolitical challenges and global uncertainties, ASEAN's role as a strategic forum for cooperation, dialogue, and partnership will remain crucial in shaping the region's future and fostering a peaceful and prosperous Southeast Asia.

23

G-20

The Group of Twenty (G-20) represents a premier forum for international economic cooperation and dialogue among the world's major economies. Established in 1999 in response to the financial crises of the late 1990s, the G-20 comprises 19 individual countries

and the European Union, representing over 80% of global GDP and two-thirds of the world's population. Its membership includes Argentina, Australia, Brazil, Canada, China, France, Germany, India, Indonesia, Italy, Japan, Mexico, Russia, Saudi Arabia, South Africa, South Korea, Turkey, the United Kingdom, the United States, the European Union, and, as of the 2023 summit, the African Union. The primary objective of the G-20 is to promote global economic stability, sustainable development, and inclusive growth through policy coordination and cooperation among its members. Since its inception, the G-20 has evolved into a key platform for addressing pressing global challenges, including financial regulation, trade, climate change, and pandemic response.

One of the G-20's key achievements lies in its role as a crisis response mechanism during times of economic uncertainty and instability. During the global financial crisis of 2008-2009, the G-20 played a crucial role in coordinating policy responses and preventing a deeper economic downturn. Through initiatives such as the Pittsburgh Summit in 2009, G-20 leaders committed to implementing fiscal stimulus measures, strengthening financial regulation, and reforming international financial institutions to safeguard the global economy from future crises. Subsequent G-20 summits have continued to address emerging challenges and promote cooperation on issues such as financial stability, trade liberalization, and sustainable development.

It serves as a platform for advancing international cooperation on climate change and environmental sustainability. While not initially focused on environmental issues, the G-20 has increasingly recognized the importance of addressing climate change and promoting sustainable development as integral to achieving long-term economic prosperity. G-20 members have committed to implementing the Paris Agreement on climate change and have pledged to enhance their efforts to reduce greenhouse gas emissions, transition to clean energy sources, and build climate-resilient economies. Additionally, the G-20 has established working groups and initiatives to promote sustainable development goals, including initiatives to address marine pollution, deforestation, and biodiversity loss.

The G-20 has also emerged as a key player in global health governance, particularly in response to the COVID-19 pandemic. In the face of the unprecedented health crisis, G-20 leaders have convened special summits and initiatives to coordinate international efforts to combat the pandemic and mitigate its socio-economic impacts. G-20 countries have committed to enhancing global health infrastructure, ensuring equitable access to vaccines, and supporting vulnerable countries in their response to the pandemic. Additionally, the G-20

has mobilized financial resources and technical assistance to strengthen healthcare systems, accelerate vaccine distribution, and mitigate the socio-economic consequences of the pandemic, demonstrating its commitment to collective action and solidarity in times of crisis. The G-20 plays a vital role in promoting global trade and economic cooperation through initiatives aimed at fostering open, transparent, and inclusive trade policies. G-20 members have reaffirmed their commitment to upholding the rules-based multilateral trading system and have pledged to resist protectionist measures that could undermine global economic growth and stability. Additionally, the G-20 has advocated for reforms to the World Trade Organization (WTO) to address issues such as unfair trade practices, market distortions, and barriers to trade. By promoting dialogue, cooperation, and consensus-building among its members, the G-20 continues to play a crucial role in shaping the global economic agenda and advancing collective efforts to address shared challenges and opportunities.

The G-20 plays a crucial role in promoting financial inclusion and sustainable development globally. Through initiatives such as the G-20 Financial Inclusion Action Plan and the G-20 Development Working Group, member countries collaborate on strategies to expand access to financial services, promote inclusive growth, and reduce poverty worldwide. Additionally, the G-20 has prioritized efforts to address infrastructure gaps, promote investment in sustainable development projects, and enhance cooperation with international financial institutions and development agencies. By fostering dialogue and cooperation on development issues, the G-20 contributes to advancing the global agenda for sustainable development and poverty eradication.

It serves as a platform for addressing emerging challenges and opportunities in the digital economy. As technology continues to reshape the global economic landscape, G-20 members have recognized the importance of harnessing digital innovation to promote economic growth, job creation, and social inclusion. The G-20 Digital Economy Ministerial Declaration emphasizes the need for policies that support digital infrastructure development, data governance, cybersecurity, and digital skills training. Additionally, the G-20 has established working groups and task forces to address issues such as digital trade, e-commerce, and digital taxation, reflecting its commitment to promoting a fair, inclusive, and sustainable digital economy.

International Governmental Organizations (IGO)

International Governmental Organizations (IGOs) play a pivotal role in facilitating cooperation, coordination, and collaboration among sovereign states on various global challenges. Comprising member states, these organizations serve as platforms for dialogue, negotiation, and decision-making, offering mechanisms for addressing shared issues and advancing mutual interests. Notable IGOs such as the United Nations (UN), the World Bank, the International Monetary Fund (IMF), and the World Trade Organization (WTO) exemplify this collaborative effort. Through their mandates, structures, and activities, IGOs contribute significantly to shaping global governance and promoting international peace, security, and prosperity.

One primary function of IGOs is to provide a forum for multilateral diplomacy and conflict resolution. By convening meetings, summits, and conferences, IGOs facilitate dialogue and negotiation among member states, thereby helping to prevent conflicts, manage disputes, and resolve tensions through peaceful means. For instance, the United Nations Security Council (UNSC) serves as a pivotal platform for addressing threats to international peace and security, while the International Court of Justice (ICJ) resolves disputes between states based on international law. Additionally, regional IGOs like the African Union (AU) and the European Union (EU) play crucial roles in promoting peace, security, and stability within their respective regions through conflict prevention, mediation, and peacekeeping efforts.

IGOs play a crucial role in fostering economic integration, trade liberalization, and sustainable development globally and regionally. Organizations such as the World Trade Organization (WTO) and regional economic blocs like the Association of Southeast Asian Nations (ASEAN) and the Common Market of the South (Mercosur) facilitate trade negotiations, dispute resolution, and capacity-building initiatives to promote open, fair, and rules-based international trade. Additionally, multilateral development banks like the World Bank and the Asian Development Bank (ADB) offer financial assistance, technical expertise, and policy advice to support economic growth, poverty reduction, and infrastructure development in developing countries.

Intergovernmental organizations (IGOs) exhibit diversity in functions, memberships, and membership criteria, often outlined in treaties or charters. While some serve as neutral platforms for debate and conflict resolution, others pursue specific objectives such as peacekeeping, environmental protection, human rights advocacy, social development,

humanitarian aid, and economic growth. These IGOs encompass various types, including global organizations, cultural, linguistic, ethnic, religious, or historical organizations, economic organizations, educational organizations, health and population organizations, and regional organizations, each contributing uniquely to the global landscape of governance and cooperation.

There are several types of IGOs:

1. **Global Organizations:** These are open to nations worldwide, subject to certain criteria. Examples include the United Nations (UN), World Health Organization (WHO), International Telecommunication Union (ITU), World Bank, International Monetary Fund (IMF), Hague Conference on Private International Law, International Criminal Court, and CGIAR.
2. **Cultural, Linguistic, Ethnic, Religious, or Historical Organizations:** Membership is based on cultural, linguistic, ethnic, religious, or historical ties. Examples include the Commonwealth of Nations, Arab League, Organisation internationale de la Francophonie, Community of Portuguese Language Countries, Organization of Turkic States, International Organization of Turkic Culture, Organisation of Islamic Cooperation, and Commonwealth of Independent States (CIS).
3. **Economic Organizations:** These focus on macro-economic policy goals, including free trade, reduction of trade barriers, and international development. Examples include the World Trade Organization (WTO), International Monetary Fund (IMF), Organisation for Economic Co-operation and Development (OECD), and organizations like OPEC.
4. **Educational Organizations:** These institutions focus on tertiary-level study and research. Examples include EUCLID University, United Nations University, University for Peace, and the United Nations Institute for Training and Research (UNITAR).
5. **Health and Population Organizations:** These IGOs address common health and population goals collectively. Examples include Partners in Population and Development.
6. **Regional Organizations:** These are open to members from specific continents or regions. Examples include the European Union (EU), African Union (AU), North Atlantic Treaty Organization (NATO), Association of Southeast Asian Nations (ASEAN), Economic Community of West African States (ECOWAS), and Organization of American States (OAS), among others.

Through their activities, IGOs contribute to advancing economic prosperity, social progress,

and sustainable development worldwide. Some more information about

1. The **United Nations (UN)** is one of the most prominent IGOs, established in 1945 with the goal of maintaining international peace and security, promoting human rights, fostering social and economic development, and providing humanitarian assistance. With 193 member states, the UN serves as a global forum for multilateral diplomacy, cooperation, and collective action. It operates through various specialized agencies, programs, and bodies, including the General Assembly, Security Council, Economic and Social Council, and Secretariat, which work together to address a wide range of global challenges and opportunities.

2. The **World Bank Group** is another significant IGO, established in 1944 with the mission of reducing poverty, promoting sustainable development, and building shared prosperity in developing countries. Comprising five institutions, including the International Bank for Reconstruction and Development (IBRD) and the International Development Association (IDA), the World Bank provides financial assistance, technical expertise, and policy advice to support projects and programs in areas such as education, healthcare, infrastructure, and governance. It works closely with governments, civil society organizations, and the private sector to address complex development issues and achieve measurable impact on the ground.

3. The **International Monetary Fund (IMF)** is a key IGO tasked with promoting international monetary cooperation, exchange rate stability, and balanced economic growth. Established in 1944, the IMF provides financial assistance, policy advice, and technical assistance to member countries facing balance of payments problems and macroeconomic challenges. It also conducts economic surveillance, monitors global economic developments, and provides analysis and research on key policy issues. Through its programs and initiatives, the IMF aims to strengthen the stability and resilience of the international financial system and support sustainable economic development worldwide.

4. The **World Trade Organization (WTO)** is a vital IGO that serves as the global forum for trade negotiations, dispute resolution, and the enforcement of international trade rules. Established in 1995, the WTO administers multilateral trade agreements and provides a platform for member countries to negotiate trade liberalization measures, reduce tariffs and non-tariff barriers, and address trade-related disputes. With 164 member countries, the WTO plays a central role in promoting open, fair, and predictable international trade, fostering economic growth, job creation, and consumer welfare globally. Additionally, the WTO

provides technical assistance and capacity-building support to developing countries to help them integrate into the global trading system and benefit from international trade opportunities.

5. The **North Atlantic Treaty Organization (NATO)** is a military alliance formed in 1949 to provide collective defence against external aggression and promote security and stability in the North Atlantic region. With 30 member countries from North America and Europe, NATO operates through various bodies, including the North Atlantic Council, the Military Committee, and the NATO Parliamentary Assembly. NATO conducts joint military exercises, shares intelligence, and coordinates defence planning among its members to deter potential threats and respond effectively to security challenges, including terrorism, cyberattacks, and hybrid warfare.

6. The **International Atomic Energy Agency (IAEA)** is an IGO established in 1957 to promote the peaceful use of nuclear energy, prevent the proliferation of nuclear weapons, and verify compliance with international nuclear safeguards agreements. With 171 member states, the IAEA conducts inspections, safeguards, and verification activities to ensure the safe and secure use of nuclear materials and facilities worldwide. The IAEA also provides technical assistance and expertise to countries seeking to develop nuclear energy programs for peaceful purposes and assists in nuclear security and emergency preparedness efforts.

7. The **Organization for Security and Co-operation in Europe (OSCE)** is a regional IGO established in 1975 to promote security, stability, and cooperation in Europe through dialogue, conflict prevention, and confidence-building measures. With 57 participating states from Europe, North America, and Asia, the OSCE operates through various institutions, including the Permanent Council, the Secretariat, and field missions, which work together to address a wide range of security challenges, including arms control, human rights, and democratic governance. The OSCE also conducts election monitoring, conflict mediation, and post-conflict reconstruction efforts to support peace and stability in the region.

8. The **World Health Organization (WHO)** is a specialized agency of the United Nations established in 1948 to promote global health, prevent the spread of infectious diseases, and provide leadership on public health issues. With 194 member states, the WHO coordinates international efforts to combat health emergencies, such as pandemics and epidemics, and provides technical assistance, guidelines, and support to countries in strengthening their healthcare systems and improving health outcomes. The WHO also conducts research, monitors health trends, and advocates for policies to address key health

challenges, including non-communicable diseases, maternal and child health, and access to essential medicines and vaccines.

9. The **International Criminal Court (ICC)** is an independent judicial institution established in 2002 to prosecute individuals for the most serious crimes of international concern, including genocide, war crimes, crimes against humanity, and aggression. With 123 member states, the ICC operates under the Rome Statute and complements national legal systems by stepping in when countries are unwilling or unable to prosecute perpetrators of grave crimes. The ICC conducts investigations, gathers evidence, and holds trials to ensure accountability for those responsible for atrocities, promoting justice, deterrence, and the prevention of future crimes.

10. The **International Labor Organization (ILO)** is a specialized agency of the United Nations founded in 1919 to promote social justice and decent work for all. With 187 member states, the ILO sets international labor standards, conducts research, and provides technical assistance to countries in areas such as labor rights, occupational safety and health, and employment promotion. The ILO fosters dialogue between governments, employers, and workers to address labor-related challenges and promote inclusive and sustainable development, including the elimination of child labor, forced labor, and discrimination in the workplace.

11. The **International Maritime Organization (IMO)** is a specialized agency of the United Nations established in 1948 to regulate shipping and maritime activities worldwide. With 174 member states, the IMO sets international standards for ship safety, environmental protection, and maritime security to ensure the safe, secure, and efficient movement of goods and passengers by sea. The IMO also addresses emerging issues such as piracy, maritime pollution, and climate change adaptation in the maritime sector, promoting sustainable shipping practices and protecting marine ecosystems and coastal communities.

12. The **International Telecommunication Union (ITU)** is a specialized agency of the United Nations founded in 1865 to coordinate global telecommunications networks and services. With 193 member states, the ITU develops technical standards, allocates radio spectrum, and fosters international cooperation on issues such as broadband connectivity, digital inclusion, and cybersecurity. The ITU works to bridge the digital divide, promote affordable and universal access to information and communication technologies (ICTs), and harness the potential of ICTs for sustainable development, economic growth, and social

progress worldwide.

13. The **World Meteorological Organization (WMO)** is a specialized agency of the United Nations established in 1950 to facilitate international cooperation in weather, climate, and water-related issues. With 193 member states and territories, the WMO promotes the exchange of meteorological data and information, develops standards and guidelines for weather forecasting and climate monitoring, and provides technical assistance to countries in improving their meteorological and hydrological services. The WMO also coordinates global initiatives to address climate change, extreme weather events, and natural disasters, supporting efforts to enhance resilience and adapt to a changing climate.

14. The **Food and Agriculture Organization (FAO)** is a specialized agency of the United Nations founded in 1945 to eradicate hunger, improve nutrition, and promote sustainable agriculture. With 194 member states, the FAO works to address food insecurity, rural poverty, and agricultural development challenges through policy advice, technical assistance, and capacity-building initiatives. The FAO supports smallholder farmers, promotes sustainable farming practices, and advocates for policies that ensure access to nutritious food for all. Additionally, the FAO plays a key role in coordinating global efforts to achieve food security and sustainable development goals, including the eradication of hunger by 2030.

15. The **International Atomic Energy Agency (IAEA)** is a specialized agency of the United Nations established in 1957 to promote the peaceful use of nuclear energy and prevent the proliferation of nuclear weapons. With 171 member states, the IAEA conducts inspections, safeguards, and verification activities to ensure the safe and secure use of nuclear materials and facilities worldwide. The IAEA also provides technical assistance and expertise to countries seeking to develop nuclear energy programs for peaceful purposes and assists in nuclear security and emergency preparedness efforts. Additionally, the IAEA supports global efforts to address nuclear safety, radiation protection, and nuclear waste management issues.

16. The **International Civil Aviation Organization (ICAO)** is a specialized agency of the United Nations founded in 1944 to promote safe, efficient, and environmentally sustainable aviation worldwide. With 193 member states, the ICAO develops international standards and regulations for aviation safety, security, and environmental protection, and provides technical assistance and training to countries in implementing these standards. The ICAO also facilitates cooperation among governments, airlines, and other stakeholders to address emerging challenges such as airspace congestion, aircraft noise, and greenhouse gas

emissions, promoting a safe and sustainable global aviation system.

17. The **International Fund for Agricultural Development (IFAD)** is a specialized agency of the United Nations established in 1977 to invest in rural people and enable them to overcome poverty. With 177 member states, IFAD provides grants and low-interest loans to finance projects and programs that empower rural communities, improve food security, and enhance agricultural productivity. IFAD focuses on marginalized and vulnerable populations, including smallholder farmers, indigenous peoples, and rural women, and works to strengthen their resilience to climate change, market shocks, and other challenges. By investing in sustainable agriculture, rural infrastructure, and social services, IFAD contributes to poverty reduction and sustainable development in rural areas worldwide.

18. The **World Intellectual Property Organization (WIPO)** is a specialized agency of the United Nations established in 1967 to promote the protection of intellectual property rights and encourage innovation and creativity. With 193 member states, WIPO administers international treaties and agreements on patents, trademarks, copyrights, and other forms of intellectual property, providing a framework for the protection and enforcement of intellectual property rights across borders. WIPO also provides technical assistance, capacity-building, and policy advice to countries in developing and implementing effective intellectual property systems, fostering a conducive environment for innovation, technology transfer, and economic development.

19. The **United Nations Educational, Scientific and Cultural Organization (UNESCO)** is a specialized agency of the United Nations founded in 1945 to promote international cooperation in education, science, culture, and communication. With 193 member states, UNESCO works to advance quality education, protect cultural heritage, foster scientific research, and promote freedom of expression and access to information. UNESCO operates through various programs and initiatives, including the World Heritage Center, the Education for All Global Monitoring Report, and the Intergovernmental Oceanographic Commission, which address global challenges and opportunities in areas such as literacy, cultural diversity, environmental conservation, and the advancement of knowledge societies.

20. The **International Labour Organization (ILO)** is a specialized agency of the United Nations founded in 1919 to promote social justice and decent work for all. With 187 member states, the ILO sets international labour standards, conducts research, and provides technical assistance to countries in areas such as labour rights, occupational safety and health, and employment promotion. The ILO fosters dialogue between governments, employers, and

workers to address labour-related challenges and promote inclusive and sustainable development, including the elimination of child labour, forced labour, and discrimination in the workplace. Through its activities, the ILO contributes to advancing social justice, promoting decent work, and achieving sustainable development goals worldwide.

21. **Commonwealth of Nations:** The Commonwealth of Nations, comprising 54 member states, is a voluntary association of countries primarily comprising former territories of the British Empire. Founded on principles of democracy, human rights, and the rule of law, the Commonwealth promotes cooperation and development among its diverse member states through various programs and initiatives, spanning areas such as education, trade, governance, and cultural exchange.

22. **Arab League:** Established in 1945, the Arab League is a regional organization consisting of 22 member states from the Arab world. It aims to promote economic, cultural, and political cooperation among its members, fostering solidarity and joint action on issues of common concern. The Arab League addresses regional challenges, including conflicts, economic development, and cultural preservation, while also serving as a forum for diplomatic dialogue and coordination.

23. **Organisation Internationale de la Francophonie (OIF):** The Organisation Internationale de la Francophonie, comprising 88 member states and governments, is a global organization dedicated to promoting the French language and Francophone cultures worldwide. It advocates for linguistic diversity, cultural exchange, and multilateral cooperation among French-speaking countries, emphasizing values such as democracy, human rights, and sustainable development.

24. **Community of Portuguese Language Countries (CPLP):** The Community of Portuguese Language Countries, consisting of nine member states with Portuguese as an official language, aims to enhance cooperation and solidarity among Portuguese-speaking nations. Established in 1996, the CPLP focuses on areas such as language promotion, education, culture, economic development, and political dialogue, fostering mutual understanding and collaboration among its member states.

25. **Organization of Turkic States:** Founded in 2009, the Organization of Turkic States is an intergovernmental organization comprising Azerbaijan, Kazakhstan, Kyrgyzstan, and Turkey. It aims to deepen cooperation and coordination among Turkic-speaking countries, fostering economic integration, cultural exchange, and political dialogue within the Turkic world, while also addressing shared challenges and opportunities.

26. **International Organization of Turkic Culture (TURKSOY):** TURKSOY, established in 1993, is dedicated to promoting the cultural heritage and traditions of Turkic-speaking peoples. It organizes various cultural events, festivals, and programs to celebrate and preserve Turkic culture, language, and art, fostering mutual understanding and appreciation among member states and beyond.
27. **Organisation of Islamic Cooperation (OIC):** The Organisation of Islamic Cooperation, comprising 57 member states, is the second-largest intergovernmental organization after the United Nations. It aims to safeguard and promote the interests of the Muslim world, addressing political, economic, social, and cultural issues affecting Muslim-majority countries. The OIC works to enhance solidarity and cooperation among its member states while also advocating for Muslim causes on the global stage.
28. **Commonwealth of Independent States (CIS):** Formed in 1991 following the dissolution of the Soviet Union, the Commonwealth of Independent States consists of 12 member states, primarily former Soviet republics. The CIS facilitates economic, political, and military cooperation among its members, aiming to address common challenges, promote stability, and foster integration in the post-Soviet space through various agreements and joint initiatives.
29. **North Atlantic Treaty Organization (NATO):** Established in 1949, NATO is an intergovernmental military alliance comprising 30 member countries from North America and Europe. Its primary purpose is to guarantee the collective defence of its members against aggression, ensuring the security and stability of the North Atlantic region. NATO operates on the principle of collective security, whereby an attack on one member is considered an attack on all, obliging member states to come to each other's defence. In addition to its defence mandate, NATO also promotes cooperation and dialogue on a wide range of security-related issues, including counterterrorism, cyber defence, and crisis management. The alliance serves as a cornerstone of transatlantic security cooperation, fostering interoperability among its members' armed forces and promoting democratic values and principles.
30. **Economic Community of West African States (ECOWAS):** Founded in 1975, ECOWAS is a regional economic union comprising 15 West African countries. Its primary objective is to promote economic integration and cooperation among its member states to foster sustainable development and regional stability. ECOWAS facilitates trade

liberalization, economic diversification, and infrastructure development within the region, aiming to create a common market and customs union to enhance intra-regional trade and investment. Additionally, the organization works to address common challenges such as poverty, unemployment, and food insecurity through collaborative initiatives in areas such as agriculture, energy, and transportation. ECOWAS also plays a crucial role in promoting peace and security in West Africa through conflict prevention, mediation, and peacekeeping efforts, contributing to the overall stability and prosperity of the region.

31. **EUCLID University:** EUCLID University, chartered in 2008 as an international intergovernmental organization, specializes in higher education programs dedicated to sustainable development. Accredited under international law, EUCLID offers distance and online learning opportunities to students from around the world, with a focus on areas such as international public health, diplomacy, and global governance. The university's mission is to provide affordable, high-quality education to promote human development and capacity-building in its member states, contributing to the advancement of sustainable development goals globally.

32. **United Nations University (UNU):** Established in 1973 as an autonomous UN agency, the United Nations University serves as a global think tank and postgraduate teaching organization, focusing on interdisciplinary research and education on pressing global issues. With headquarters in Tokyo, Japan, and additional institutes and programs worldwide, UNU conducts research and capacity-building initiatives in areas such as sustainable development, peace and governance, climate change, and technology innovation. Through its collaborative approach and partnerships with governments, academic institutions, and civil society organizations, UNU seeks to generate knowledge and policy solutions to address complex challenges facing humanity.

33. **University for Peace (UPEACE):** Founded in 1980 by the United Nations General Assembly, the University for Peace is dedicated to promoting peace and conflict resolution through education, research, and capacity-building initiatives. Located in Costa Rica, UPEACE offers graduate programs and specialized courses in areas such as peace studies, international law, human rights, and environmental sustainability. The university's interdisciplinary approach emphasizes the interconnectedness of peacebuilding efforts, fostering dialogue, understanding, and cooperation among diverse cultures and societies. UPEACE also engages in research and advocacy to advance the global peace agenda and empower individuals and communities to contribute to building a more peaceful and just

world.

34. **United Nations Institute for Training and Research (UNITAR):** Established in 1965, the United Nations Institute for Training and Research serves as the UN's training arm, specializing in capacity-building and knowledge dissemination for sustainable development and international cooperation. UNITAR offers customized training programs, workshops, and e-learning courses to government officials, diplomats, and civil society actors, focusing on topics such as diplomacy, peacekeeping, environmental management, and public administration. Through its global network of offices and partnerships, UNITAR facilitates skills development and knowledge transfer to empower individuals and institutions to address complex global challenges effectively.

25

International Non-Governmental Organizations (INGO)

International Non-Governmental Organizations (INGOs) are private organizations that operate across national borders to address various social, humanitarian, environmental, and developmental issues. Unlike governmental or intergovernmental organizations, INGOs are independent entities that are often founded by individuals or groups motivated by specific causes or concerns. These organizations work in diverse fields such as human rights, healthcare, education, environmental conservation, and disaster relief, operating through partnerships, advocacy campaigns, and direct service provision to address the needs of vulnerable populations and promote positive social change.

One of the key roles of INGOs is to provide humanitarian assistance and relief in response to emergencies, disasters, and crises worldwide. INGOs deploy teams of professionals, volunteers, and resources to deliver emergency aid, including food, shelter, medical supplies, and psychosocial support, to affected communities. Organizations such as Médecins Sans Frontières (Doctors Without Borders), the International Rescue Committee, and Oxfam respond to conflicts, natural disasters, and other emergencies, providing life-saving assistance and helping communities recover and rebuild in the aftermath of crises.

INGOs also play a critical role in advocating for human rights, social justice, and environmental sustainability on the global stage. Through research, campaigns, and lobbying efforts, INGOs raise awareness about issues such as poverty, inequality, discrimination, and environmental degradation, and mobilize public support for policy changes and reforms. Organizations such as Amnesty International, Human Rights Watch, and Greenpeace work to

hold governments and corporations accountable for their actions, promote respect for human rights and environmental protection, and empower marginalized communities to advocate for their rights and interests.

INGOs contribute to development efforts by implementing projects and programs aimed at improving education, healthcare, livelihoods, and infrastructure in communities around the world. Organizations such as CARE, Save the Children, and World Vision undertake long-term development projects focused on areas such as education access, maternal and child health, agricultural development, and clean water and sanitation. By working in partnership with local communities, governments, and other stakeholders, INGOs help build capacity, promote sustainable development practices, and empower individuals and communities to create positive change and improve their quality of life.

1. INGOs often operate in complex and challenging environments, including conflict zones, post-conflict settings, and areas affected by natural disasters. They face numerous obstacles, including security risks, logistical challenges, and political barriers, which can hinder their ability to deliver aid and assistance effectively. Despite these challenges, INGOs remain committed to their mission of helping those in need and advocating for positive change, often working alongside local communities and partners to overcome obstacles and achieve their goals.
2. INGOs rely on a variety of funding sources to support their operations, including government grants, private donations, corporate sponsorships, and multilateral funding mechanisms. They often face pressure to demonstrate accountability, transparency, and effectiveness in their use of resources, as donors and supporters expect tangible results and impact from their contributions. INGOs must adhere to rigorous financial management and reporting standards to maintain the trust and confidence of their stakeholders and ensure the sustainability of their programs and initiatives.
3. Collaboration and partnership are essential aspects of INGOs' work, as they often lack the resources, expertise, and capacity to address complex issues on their own. INGOs frequently collaborate with other organizations, including local NGOs, government agencies, international institutions, and private sector entities, to leverage their strengths, share resources, and maximize impact. By working together, INGOs can pool their knowledge and resources, coordinate their efforts, and achieve greater results in addressing global challenges and advancing common goals.
4. INGOs play a crucial role in promoting accountability, transparency, and good

governance within the humanitarian and development sectors. Many INGOs adhere to codes of conduct, ethical principles, and standards of practice that govern their operations and guide their interactions with stakeholders. They also participate in monitoring and evaluation processes, peer reviews, and external audits to assess their performance, learn from their experiences, and improve their effectiveness over time. Through these mechanisms, INGOs strive to uphold high standards of integrity, professionalism, and accountability in their work, ensuring that they remain accountable to the communities they serve and the donors who support them.

List of Some INGOs

1. **Médecins Sans Frontières (MSF)**, also known as Doctors Without Borders, is an international medical humanitarian organization founded in 1971. MSF provides emergency medical care to people affected by armed conflict, epidemics, natural disasters, and healthcare exclusion in more than 70 countries. The organization operates independently of political, religious, or economic interests, providing impartial assistance based on medical need alone. MSF teams consist of doctors, nurses, logisticians, and other medical professionals who deliver medical care, conduct vaccination campaigns, and provide mental health support in some of the world's most challenging environments.
2. **Amnesty International** is a global movement of more than 10 million people in over 150 countries and territories who campaign to end abuses of human rights. Founded in 1961, Amnesty International conducts research, advocates for policy change, and mobilizes public action to address human rights violations such as torture, extrajudicial killings, and arbitrary detention. The organization works to hold governments, corporations, and other actors accountable for their actions and to ensure justice, freedom, and dignity for all individuals. Amnesty International's campaigns have led to the release of political prisoners, the abolition of the death penalty, and the enactment of laws protecting human rights around the world.
3. **Oxfam** is a global organization working to end the injustice of poverty since its inception in 1942. Operating in over 90 countries, Oxfam addresses the root causes of poverty and inequality by advocating for policy change, supporting sustainable development projects, and providing humanitarian assistance in emergencies. Oxfam focuses on issues such as food security, gender equality, and access to essential services, working with local communities, governments, and partners to create lasting solutions to poverty and injustice. Oxfam also campaigns for fair trade, corporate accountability, and climate justice to address systemic barriers to development and promote a more equitable and sustainable world.

4. **Greenpeace** is an international environmental organization founded in 1971 to protect the planet and promote peace. Greenpeace campaigns on a wide range of environmental issues, including climate change, deforestation, ocean pollution, and nuclear disarmament. The organization uses peaceful direct action, investigative research, and public awareness campaigns to expose environmental threats, advocate for solutions, and mobilize grassroots support for environmental protection. Greenpeace operates independently of governments and corporate interests, relying on the contributions of individual supporters and volunteers to advance its mission of creating a greener, more peaceful world for future generations.
5. **Save the Children** is a leading international organization dedicated to improving the lives of children worldwide. Founded in 1919, Save the Children operates in over 100 countries, providing lifesaving healthcare, nutrition, education, and protection services to vulnerable children and families. The organization responds to emergencies such as natural disasters, conflicts, and pandemics, delivering immediate aid and long-term support to communities in need. Save the Children also advocates for children's rights, works to strengthen child protection systems, and empowers young people to reach their full potential.
6. **CARE International** is a global humanitarian organization committed to fighting poverty and social injustice. Established in 1945, CARE operates in more than 100 countries, delivering emergency relief, sustainable development programs, and advocacy initiatives to address the underlying causes of poverty and inequality. The organization focuses on empowering women and girls, promoting inclusive governance, and building resilient communities to create lasting change. CARE's programs address a wide range of issues, including food security, maternal and child health, education, and economic empowerment, aiming to create a world where everyone can thrive.
7. **Mercy Corps** is a leading global organization working to alleviate suffering, poverty, and oppression in more than 40 countries. Founded in 1979, Mercy Corps provides humanitarian assistance, economic opportunity, and community resilience-building programs to help people recover from crisis, build better lives, and transform their communities. The organization focuses on areas such as conflict resolution, economic development, climate resilience, and youth empowerment, working with local partners and communities to implement innovative solutions to complex challenges. Mercy Corps also conducts research and advocacy to inform policies and practices that promote peace, prosperity, and social justice worldwide.
8. **International Rescue Committee (IRC)** is a global humanitarian organization

dedicated to responding to the world's worst humanitarian crises. Founded in 1933 at the request of Albert Einstein, IRC delivers lifesaving aid, protection, and empowerment programs to people affected by conflict and disaster in over 40 countries. IRC provides health care, education, protection, and economic support to refugees and displaced populations, helping them to rebuild their lives and regain their independence. The organization also advocates for policies that protect the rights and dignity of refugees and displaced persons, working to ensure that all people can live in safety and with dignity.

9. **International Federation of Red Cross and Red Crescent Societies (IFRC)** is the world's largest humanitarian network, comprising 192-member National Red Cross and Red Crescent Societies. Founded in 1919, IFRC works to alleviate human suffering, protect lives, and promote dignity during emergencies and disasters. IFRC aids in areas such as health, water and sanitation, shelter, and livelihoods, supporting communities to recover and build resilience. The organization also advocates for the protection of human rights, promotes disaster preparedness and risk reduction, and strengthens the capacity of local Red Cross and Red Crescent Societies to respond effectively to crises.

10. **International Committee of the Red Cross (ICRC)** is an impartial, neutral, and independent organization that works to protect and assist victims of armed conflict and other situations of violence. Established in 1863, ICRC operates in over 90 countries, providing humanitarian aid, medical assistance, and support for detainees and their families. ICRC also promotes respect for international humanitarian law, facilitates dialogue between parties to conflicts, and seeks to prevent and alleviate human suffering. The organization's work is guided by the principles of humanity, impartiality, neutrality, independence, voluntary service, unity, and universality.

11. **Plan International** is a global organization working to advance children's rights and equality for girls. Founded in 1937, Plan International operates in over 75 countries, implementing programs focused on education, health, child protection, and youth empowerment. The organization works with children, families, communities, and governments to promote gender equality, eliminate child marriage, improve access to education, and ensure that every child can reach their full potential. Plan International also advocates for policies and investments that prioritize the needs and rights of children and young people, working towards a world where all children can live free from discrimination and violence.

13. **Human Rights Watch (HRW)** is a leading international human rights organization

that conducts research and advocacy to promote and protect human rights worldwide. Founded in 1978, HRW investigates and exposes human rights abuses, publishes reports and documentation, and advocates for policy changes to hold governments and other actors accountable for their actions. The organization focuses on a wide range of issues, including freedom of expression, women's rights, refugee rights, and the rights of marginalized and vulnerable populations. HRW works to ensure that perpetrators of human rights violations are held accountable and that victims receive justice and redress.

14. **Action Against Hunger** (Action Contre la Faim, or ACF) is an international humanitarian organization committed to ending hunger and malnutrition worldwide. Founded in 1979, ACF operates in over 45 countries, providing emergency food assistance, nutrition programs, water and sanitation services, and livelihood support to communities affected by conflict, natural disasters, and food insecurity. The organization also conducts research, advocacy, and capacity- building initiatives to address the root causes of hunger and malnutrition and promote sustainable solutions to food insecurity and poverty.

15. **Transparency International (TI)** is a global civil society organization dedicated to combating corruption and promoting transparency, accountability, and integrity in government and business. Founded in 1993, TI works with governments, businesses, civil society organizations, and individuals to raise awareness about the impact of corruption, advocate for policy reforms, and develop tools and initiatives to prevent and combat corruption at all levels. The organization publishes the Corruption Perceptions Index (CPI) annually, ranking countries based on perceived levels of corruption, and advocates for stronger legal frameworks, institutions, and enforcement mechanisms to promote good governance and combat corruption.

16. **Peace Direct** is an international organization dedicated to supporting local peacebuilders in conflict-affected areas around the world. Founded in 2004, Peace Direct works to empower grassroots organizations and individuals to prevent violence, resolve conflicts, and build sustainable peace within their communities. The organization provides funding, training, and networking opportunities to local peacebuilders, enabling them to implement peacebuilding initiatives tailored to their contexts and priorities. Peace Direct also advocates for greater recognition and support for local peacebuilding efforts, emphasizing the importance of community-led approaches to building peace.

17. **Search for Common Ground** is an international non-profit organization that works to transform conflict and build peace in communities worldwide. Founded in 1982, Search

for Common Ground employs a multi-track approach to peacebuilding, combining dialogue, media, training, and community engagement to foster understanding, reconciliation, and cooperation among diverse groups. The organization operates in over 30 countries, working with local partners and stakeholders to address root causes of conflict, promote dialogue and mediation, and strengthen social cohesion and resilience. Search for Common Ground also conducts research and advocacy to promote effective peacebuilding practices and policies at local, national, and international levels.

18. **International Alert** is a peacebuilding organization that works with people affected by conflict to build sustainable peace. Established in 1986, International Alert focuses on conflict prevention, conflict resolution, and peacebuilding in over 25 countries around the world. The organization works with governments, civil society organizations, and communities to address the root causes of conflict, promote dialogue and reconciliation, and build inclusive and resilient societies. International Alert also conducts research and advocacy to inform policy and practice on peace and security issues, advocating for approaches that prioritize human security, social justice, and sustainable peace.

19. **The Carter Centre**, founded by former U.S. President Jimmy Carter and his wife Rosalynn Carter in 1982, is a non-profit organization committed to advancing peace and resolving conflicts worldwide. The centre works to prevent and resolve conflicts through diplomacy, mediation, and dialogue, and promotes human rights, democracy, and good governance. The Carter Centre has been involved in peacebuilding efforts in countries such as Liberia, Sudan, and Colombia, facilitating negotiations, supporting democratic transitions, and monitoring elections to promote peace, stability, and respect for human rights. Additionally, the centre conducts research and provides training and technical assistance to strengthen peacebuilding capacities and promote sustainable peace and development.

20. **Interpeace** is an international peacebuilding organization that works to build lasting peace in conflict-affected countries and regions around the world. Founded in 1994, Interpeace collaborates with local partners to facilitate inclusive dialogue, strengthen social cohesion, and support locally led peacebuilding initiatives. The organization employs a participatory approach to peacebuilding, engaging communities, civil society organizations, and government authorities in the design and implementation of peacebuilding programs. Interpeace also conducts research and analysis to identify drivers of conflict and opportunities for peace, and advocates for policies and interventions that address root causes and promote sustainable peace.

21. **The Centre for Humanitarian Dialogue (HD Centre)** is a private diplomacy organization dedicated to preventing and resolving armed conflicts through dialogue and mediation. Established in 1999, the HD Centre works discreetly and confidentially to facilitate dialogue between conflict parties, support peace processes, and build the capacity of mediators and negotiators. The organization operates in conflict-affected regions worldwide, including Africa, Asia, and the Middle East, providing impartial and trusted mediation services to help parties reach negotiated settlements and agreements. The HD Centre also conducts research and analysis on conflict dynamics and mediation processes, and shares its expertise and lessons learned with the broader peacebuilding community.
22. **The International Peace Institute (IPI)** is an independent, non-profit think tank dedicated to promoting peace, security, and sustainable development around the world. Established in 1970, IPI conducts research, analysis, and convenes dialogues and workshops on key peace and security challenges facing the international community. The institute focuses on issues such as conflict prevention, peacekeeping, and peacebuilding, and works to develop innovative policy solutions and recommendations to address these challenges. Through its work, IPI aims to inform and influence policymakers, practitioners, and scholars, and contribute to the advancement of peace and security globally.
23. **Nonviolent Peace force** is an international non-governmental organization that works to protect civilians and prevent violence in conflict-affected areas. Founded in 2002, Nonviolent Peace force deploys unarmed civilian peacekeepers to areas experiencing or at risk of violence, where they work alongside local communities to promote nonviolent conflict resolution, protect civilians, and build peace. The organization operates in countries such as South Sudan, Myanmar, and the Philippines, providing direct protection to civilians, facilitating dialogue between conflict parties, and supporting local peacebuilding efforts. Nonviolent Peace force also advocates for the use of nonviolent strategies and approaches to conflict resolution and conducts research and training to strengthen the practice of unarmed civilian protection.
24. **Initiatives of Change (IofC)** is an international movement dedicated to building trust, reconciliation, and ethical leadership to address the root causes of conflict and promote sustainable peace. Founded in 1928, IofC works with individuals, communities, and institutions to foster dialogue, understanding, and cooperation across divides of religion, ethnicity, and nationality. The organization operates through a network of volunteers and partners in over 50 countries, implementing programs focused on peacebuilding, ethical

leadership, and sustainable development. Initiatives of Change also conducts conferences, workshops, and training sessions to empower individuals and communities to act for positive change and contribute to building a more peaceful and just world.

25. **Women's International League for Peace and Freedom (WILPF)** is the oldest women's peace organization in the world, founded in 1915 to promote disarmament, demilitarization, and women's participation in peace processes. WILPF advocates for gender equality, human rights, and nonviolent conflict resolution, and works to address the root causes of war and violence through grassroots activism, advocacy campaigns, and international networking. The organization operates through a global network of chapters and sections, engaging women and men from diverse backgrounds in efforts to prevent and resolve conflicts, advance disarmament and arms control, and promote women's leadership in peacebuilding and decision-making. WILPF also conducts research, organizes conferences, and publishes reports and resources to raise awareness about peace and security issues and mobilize support for peaceful solutions to global challenges.

26. **The Institute for Economics and Peace (IEP)** is an independent, non-partisan research institute dedicated to understanding the drivers of peace, violence, and conflict around the world. Founded in 2007, IEP produces the Global Peace Index (GPI), an annual report that ranks countries based on their levels of peacefulness and identifies trends in global peace and conflict. The institute conducts research on topics such as peacebuilding, conflict resolution, terrorism, and the economic costs of violence, and provides data and analysis to policymakers, researchers, and the public to inform efforts to build and sustain peace.

27. **Friends Committee on National Legislation (FCNL)** is a non-partisan Quaker organization based in the United States that advocates for peace, justice, and sustainable security policies. Founded in 1943, FCNL works to influence U.S. national policy through lobbying, grassroots organizing, and public education on issues such as nuclear disarmament, diplomacy, human rights, and conflict prevention. The organization engages with members of Congress, the administration, and the public to promote policies that advance peace and security, and to challenge those that contribute to violence, militarism, and injustice.

28. **The United Network of Young Peacebuilders (UNOY Peacebuilders)** is a global network of youth-led organizations and individuals working to build peace and promote human rights around the world. Founded in 1999, UNOY Peacebuilders provides a platform for young people to connect, share experiences, and collaborate on peacebuilding initiatives. The network supports youth-led projects, campaigns, and advocacy efforts, and provides

training and capacity-building opportunities to empower young peacebuilders to act for positive change in their communities. UNOY Peacebuilders also advocates for the inclusion of young people in decision-making processes related to peace and security and promotes the meaningful participation of youth in efforts to prevent and resolve conflicts.

For Interreligious Dialogue

1. **The Interfaith Dialogue for Peace and Reconciliation (IDP)** is an international non- governmental organization dedicated to promoting interreligious dialogue and collaboration for peacebuilding and conflict resolution. Founded in 2005, IDP works with religious leaders, faith-based organizations, and grassroots communities to foster mutual understanding, respect, and cooperation among people of different faith traditions. The organization facilitates dialogue sessions, workshops, and interfaith initiatives to address religious tensions, prevent conflicts, and build bridges of trust and solidarity across religious divides. IDP also advocates for the inclusion of religious perspectives in peace processes and policymaking, recognizing the role of faith communities as important stakeholders in promoting peace and reconciliation.

2. **Religions for Peace (RfP)** is the world's largest and most representative multi-religious coalition dedicated to advancing peace through interfaith dialogue, cooperation, and action. Founded in 1970, RfP brings together religious leaders, communities, and organizations from diverse faith traditions to promote understanding, respect, and cooperation across religious lines. The organization works to address root causes of conflict, promote reconciliation and peacebuilding, and mobilize religious resources for humanitarian assistance and development.

RfP operates through regional and national chapters around the world, engaging in dialogue, advocacy, and grassroots initiatives to build peace and promote justice, human rights, and sustainable development.

3. **The International Network of Engaged Buddhists (INEB)** is a global network of Buddhists and Buddhist-inspired organizations committed to promoting peace, social justice, and ecological sustainability through dialogue and collaboration. Founded in 1989, INEB facilitates exchanges, conferences, and educational programs to deepen understanding of Buddhist teachings and values, and to explore their relevance to contemporary issues and challenges. The network engages in interfaith dialogue and cooperation, as well as partnerships with secular organizations and civil society groups, to address root causes of

conflict, promote nonviolence and compassion, and advance peacebuilding efforts at local, national, and global levels.

4. The Tanenbaum Centre for Interreligious Understanding is a non-profit organization dedicated to combating religious prejudice and hatred through education, dialogue, and advocacy. Founded in 1992, Tanenbaum works to promote respect for religious diversity and to foster understanding and cooperation among people of different faiths and beliefs. The center develops educational resources, training programs, and curricula for schools, workplaces, and communities to promote religious literacy, interreligious dialogue, and conflict resolution skills. Tanenbaum also engages in research and advocacy to address religious discrimination and violence, and to promote policies and practices that uphold religious freedom, human rights, and social inclusion.

5. The Elijah Interfaith Institute is an international organization dedicated to fostering interfaith understanding and cooperation through education, research, and dialogue. Founded in 1997, The Elijah Interfaith Institute conducts interreligious research projects, organizes conferences and seminars, and publishes educational materials to promote dialogue and collaboration among people of different faith traditions. The institute's initiatives include the "Elijah Interfaith Academy," which brings together religious leaders and scholars for academic study and dialogue, and the "Elijah Board of World Religious Leaders," which seeks to harness the collective wisdom of religious leaders to address pressing global challenges and promote peace and reconciliation.

6. The Interfaith Centre of New York is a non-profit organization that works to build bridges of understanding and cooperation among the religiously diverse communities of New York City. Founded in 1997, the Interfaith Centre of New York facilitates interreligious dialogue, collaboration, and civic engagement through programs such as interfaith workshops, community forums, and leadership development initiatives. The centre also provides training and resources to religious leaders, educators, and community organizers to promote interfaith understanding and peacebuilding skills. It also advocates for policies and practices that uphold religious freedom, pluralism, and social justice in the city and beyond.

7. The United Religions Initiative (URI) is a global grassroots interfaith network that works to promote peace, justice, and healing through cooperation and collaboration among people of

different religions, spiritual expressions, and indigenous traditions. Founded in 2000, URI

supports the creation of "Cooperation Circles" – local interfaith groups that undertake projects and initiatives to address social, environmental, and humanitarian challenges in their communities. The network also organizes regional and global gatherings, youth programs, and interfaith dialogues to foster understanding, respect, and friendship among people of diverse beliefs. URI advocates for interfaith cooperation as a means of building bridges across divides, promoting reconciliation, and creating a culture of peace and solidarity.

8. The International Association for Religious Freedom (IARF) is an international organization dedicated to promoting religious freedom, tolerance, and understanding among people of different faiths and beliefs. Founded in 1900, the IARF brings together individuals, organizations, and communities from diverse religious traditions to work towards a world where everyone can practice their religion or belief without fear or discrimination. The organization advocates for policies and practices that uphold religious freedom and human rights, and supports interfaith dialogue, education, and cooperation as essential tools for promoting peace, justice, and reconciliation.

9. The Interfaith Youth Core (IFYC) is a non-profit organization that works to empower young people to build bridges of understanding and cooperation across religious and cultural divides. Founded in 1998, IFYC trains and supports college students, educators, and religious leaders to engage in interfaith dialogue, service, and leadership development initiatives on campuses and in communities across the United States and around the world. The organization's programs and resources promote religious pluralism, social cohesion, and civic engagement, and aim to foster a generation of leaders who are committed to promoting peace, justice, and respect for all people.

10. The World Conference of Religions for Peace (WCRP) is an international organization that brings together religious leaders, practitioners, and scholars from different faith traditions to promote peace, interfaith understanding, and cooperation. Founded in 1970, WCRP works through its global network of national and regional branches to address pressing social, political, and environmental issues through dialogue, advocacy, and community action. The organization's initiatives include interfaith conferences, peacebuilding projects, and campaigns to promote human rights, environmental sustainability, and social justice. WCRP also engages with governments, international organizations, and civil society groups to advance policies and practices that support interfaith cooperation and contribute to a more peaceful and harmonious world.

11. The Institute for Jewish-Muslim Action (IJMA) is an organization dedicated to

fostering dialogue, cooperation, and understanding between Jewish and Muslim communities in North America and beyond. Founded in 2011, IJMA creates opportunities for Jews and Muslims to come together for dialogue sessions, joint projects, and cultural exchanges that promote mutual respect and solidarity. The institute also provides resources and training to empower individuals and organizations to address issues of religious prejudice, discrimination, and social injustice within their communities. Through its initiatives, IJMA seeks to build bridges of trust and cooperation that contribute to greater understanding and reconciliation between Jewish and Muslim communities, and to promote a culture of peace and coexistence.

For Further Reading

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